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EYE

A DIWALI OF DIFFERENT LAMPS

Is it about Ram returning? Or about Krishna killing Narakasura? Diwali can be all of these, depending on which part of India you are from

SCREEN

Vinod Kapri on putting a love story at the centre of his film *Pyre*



THE INDIAN EXPRESS WISHES ITS READERS
A VERY HAPPY DIWALI

We are closed today. There will be no edition of the newspaper on Monday, November 9, 2026. Our coverage and news updates 24x7 will be available on INDIANEXPRESS.COM

INSIDE PAGES 6, 13

CELEBRATING L K ADVANI'S 100TH BIRTHDAY



PM NARENDRA MODI

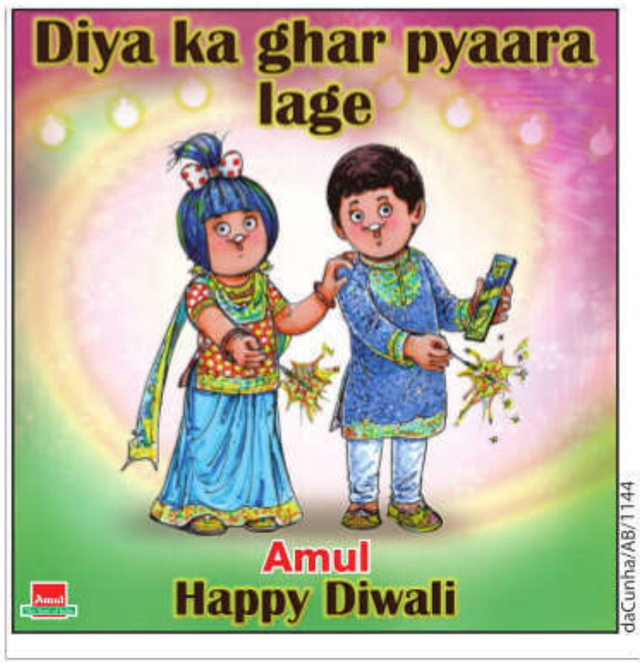
'HE GAVE PARTY A FOUNDATION ROOTED IN NATION FIRST'

'A MENTOR WHOSE IDEALS ENDURE' BY M VENKAIAH NAIDU



All lit up for Diwali

Ayodhya illuminated as part of the 10th edition of Deepotsav along the banks of the Saryu, Saturday. Over 36 lakh lamps were lit along the river on Diwali eve. ANI



NEW U.S. STRIKES ON IRAN

Trump, Qatar emir in talks over West Asia de-escalation

Mediator Qatar flags safe maritime passage and energy security

Associated Press
Washington, November 7

US PRESIDENT Donald Trump discussed efforts to de-escalate tensions in the Middle East in a telephone call with Qatar's emir, the Gulf state leader's office said, as the US military launched new targeted strikes on Iran and the region remained on edge.

Iran is reviewing proposals presented by chief mediator Qatar aimed at addressing differences with the US about Tehran's nuclear programme, two Middle East government officials said.

The development is raising hopes that the two sides could be inching toward indirect talks on one of the thorniest issues that Trump says must be resolved as part of any deal meant to end the more than 8-month-old war.

But one of the officials stressed that the Iranians, at least at the moment, remain unwilling to engage in negotiations with the Trump administration over its atomic activities until the US agrees to several core conditions that Iran has been demanding be part of any ceasefire agreement.

The telephone call between Trump and Qatar's Emir Sheikh Tamim bin Hamad al Thani centered on international efforts to end tensions, according to a statement from the Qatari ruler's media office. The two discussed in particular Qatar's mediation efforts aimed at reaching "a comprehensive agreement that ends the crisis and achieves security and stability in the region."

Qatar has been mediating between the US and Iran to end the war. Qatar and other US-allied Gulf Arab countries came under heavy fire by Iran earlier in the US-Iran war and have been anxious to avoid a new escalation that could leave them

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

• US task force to hit Iran land trade

Washington: Building on a months-long naval blockade on Iran, the US military said Saturday that it is launching a task force to help crack down on Tehran's movement of advanced weapons and other sanctioned material over its land borders and through the Caspian Sea. Task Force Iron Gate will also focus on stemming what US calls illegal revenue streams. REUTERS

Home for a wedding, Singapore-based tech executive shot dead in Faridabad

Parking dispute led to killing, neighbour arrested

Abhimanyu Hazarika
Faridabad, November 7



Paramjith Dhankhar, 42

A 42-YEAR-OLD Singapore-based corporate executive was shot dead, allegedly by his neighbour following a parking dispute at a residential building in Faridabad's Sector 21C Friday night.

The prime accused was arrested near DLF Chowk in Ballabgarh Saturday evening by the police Crime Branch.

The man killed in the incident was identified as Paramjith Dhankhar who worked as senior vice-president of a Vietnam-based IT firm in Singapore.

Hailing from Hisar, he worked earlier as the Asia Pacific regional business head for Tech Mahindra in Australia.

He had arrived in Faridabad on November 5 to attend his nephew's wedding scheduled for later this month.

According to investigators, the incident took place around 8.30 pm Friday outside house number 641 in Sector 21C.

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

EXPRESS special

Why is ghee costing more? Indian dairies have a big fat problem

From El Niño effect to a decline in growth of milk production, FSSAI raids to GST cuts, there is a fats crisis

Harish Damodaran
New Delhi, November 7

THE GUJARAT Cooperative Milk Marketing Federation (GCMMF) hiking the price of its Amul cow ghee by Rs 40 per one-litre pouch, and the Karnataka Milk Federation by as much as Rs 135, is telling. India is seeing a growth slowdown in milk production. But the real problem is not of milk as much as fat.

Between 2016 and 2025, India's milk production increased from 165.1 million tonnes (mt) to 216.5 mt, translating into a compound average annual growth of about 3%, according to the US Department of Agriculture. That rate of growth is

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

• WEIGHTED AVERAGE EX-DAIRY PRICE

	BUTTER		SKIMMED MILK POWDER	
Month	2026-27 (₹/kg)	% growth over 2023-24	2026-27 (₹/kg)	% growth over 2023-24
Apr	486	20	267	-10.40
May	515	35.53	275	3.77
Jun	505	38.74	278	0.36
Jul	512	47.98	277	4.92
Aug	515	50.58	279	11.60
Sep	528	53.04	291	11.92
Oct	537	54.31	295	18

SOURCE:INDUSTRY

EXPLAINED

Supply-demand mismatch

Demand for milk fat-based products has gone up especially after GST rate cuts on ice-cream, ghee, butter and paneer. But supply is not keeping pace, leading to higher inflation in milk fat than milk per se.

NATION PAGE 8

UTTARAKHAND MINISTER'S HUSBAND HELD FOR ASSAULT

Jantar Mantar off map, Capital's other protests have nowhere to go

Pragynesh
New Delhi, November 7

PROTESTS AGAINST the violence in Manipur, demands for reservation for Jaats in central government jobs and opposition to piped natural gas were among at least 15 demonstrations planned at Delhi's Jantar Mantar between October and December.

But on October 9, the site was taken off the list of designated protest spaces, with the Delhi Police naming three alternatives — Burari Ground, Ramlila Ground and CBD Ground. For several groups, however, moving their demonstrations to these venues proved far from straightforward. Some protests never took place.

The Naga Students' Union was among them; it had planned a demonstration against the violence in Manipur

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



The Naga Students' Union held a press conference at the Press Club of India on October 22 instead of a protest

Lawrence aide Harry Boxer who ran gang's India ops held in US

Mahender Singh Manral & Parul Kulshrestha
New Delhi, Jaipur, November 7



Hari Chand Jaat, aka Harry Boxer

DAYS AFTER they nabbed absconding gangster Himanshu Bhau, law enforcement agencies (LEAs) in the United States have arrested Hari Chand Jaat, alias Harry Boxer — a close aide of jailed gangster Lawrence Bishnoi — after India's central agencies alerted them to his location in California.

Boxer, described by police as a "main mastermind" of the gang who ran its India operations while abroad, was detained by the US Immigration and Customs Enforcement (ICE) agency on Friday.

This followed a joint operation by the Anti-Terrorism Squad (ATS), the Rajasthan police's Anti-Gangster Task Force (AGTF), and the National Investigation Agency (NIA).

Boxer allegedly issued threats to Bollywood actor Ranveer Singh and director

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 10

Happening today

• INDIA FACE Pakistan at the U-19 one-day Asia Cup Group A match in Oman. For India, much of the batting interest will centre around Aaryavir Sehwag, son of ex-opener Virender Sehwag.

• DEFENCE MINISTER Rajnath Singh will visit the Sherathang War Memorial in Sikkim. The minister will also interact with the soldiers who are deployed in the region.

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• GOVT DISCOVERS NETWORK WHERE MEDICAL INTERNS USE WHATSAPP GROUPS TO BUY AND SELL HOSPITAL SHIFTS

Who's on call at your Emergency Room? In Bengal, intern may be a paid stand-in

Sweety Kumari
Kolkata, November 7

WHATSAPP MESSAGES all hours of night and day come with the job at medical colleges. In West Bengal, there is a difference. Many such chats across medical colleges in the state involve monetary transactions over hospital shifts and emergency room duties, which are bought and sold for fixed rates per hour.

PAGE 1 anchor

Officials said that what started as informal peer adjustments among medical interns has turned into a cash-for-duty network that operates across medical colleges in Kolkata and other parts of the state, allowing interns to trade mandatory rotatory shifts for amounts ranging between Rs 200 and Rs 600 per hour.

One such group, named 'Internship Replacement', contains more than 255 members who regularly broadcast shift availability and the money expected in return.

The state Health Department has rolled out a biometric attendance system now to check the practice. Health Minister Sharadwat Mukhopadhyay, who says he came across a dental college intern performing duties on behalf of an MBBS intern during a surprise inspection at Murshidabad Medical College, held a meeting this month with principals and vice-presidents of medical colleges where this issue was discussed.

Sources said principals of three medical colleges – one based in Kolkata and two in North Bengal — said they had no idea about this "network" under their roofs.

Giving the example of one such WhatsApp transaction, an official said a message could be put up on the group asking if anyone was willing to take up an emergency room (ER) shift, with timings specified, such as an "ER evening from 3 pm today" and a "Night ER from 10 pm to 8 am today", followed by the money on offer.

Minister Mukhopadhyay told *The Indian Express* that the practice has been found to be widespread, across "almost all" government hospitals. "We have identified many interns involved, warned them and now we are making biometric attendance mandatory."

Officials said that, on an average, a medical college and hospital in Bengal has around 250 interns, who must put in minimum hours for an MBBS degree, performing duties such as taking down case histories of patients for a monthly stipend of Rs 40,000 to Rs 50,000. Only on health grounds or an emergency is an intern allowed exemption from duty, which can stretch from 6 hours to 24, with the requirement that the missed hours be completed later. "There is no attendance system as such... No one checks, honestly," a Medical Officer at one of the medical colleges and hospitals in Kolkata said.

Informally, interns are known to swap duties or ask someone else to cover for them, but that this was being done for money was something officials say they were not aware of. "It is extremely unethical to see interns bargaining over rates to swap duties as if they are grocery shopping," a resident doctor at a government hospital said, on the condition of anonymity.

On the ethical aspect, Tapas Pramanick, Medical Officer in the Emergency Department at R G Kar Medical College and Hospital, told *The Indian Express*: "There are 10 Medical Officers at R G Kar, so everyone knows us by face. If someone wants to swap, it is always with one of the other nine Medical Officers. But interns have been known to get Ayurveda students and even non-medical friends to step in for them."

Health Department officials said that in districts, they have found situations where junior doctors who have to put in long hours also roping in interns to perform some of their minor duties.

Pramanick said: "Rotatory internship is an integral part of the MBBS curriculum... meant to develop clinical skills, professional responsibility and competence for patient care. Duty adjustment may be permitted

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 10

• CASH-FOR-DUTY NETWORK

₹200-600/hr
mandatory rotatory shifts bought and sold, with some paying Rs 30,000 monthly

255 members
in one WhatsApp group where interns post availability and the money offered in return



Some use the arrangement to carve out time for higher studies. Others simply point to long working hours

Home for a wedding, Singapore-based tech executive shot dead



At the site of the shooting in Sector 21C, Faridabad, Saturday. ANI

Dhankhar lived on the ground floor with his family, while the accused, Mohan Sharma, lived on the second floor.

Referring to the complaint lodged by the victim's son, Shaurya Dhankhar, Faridabad Police spokesperson Sub-Inspector Yashpal Yadav said: "Around 8.30 pm on November 6, Sharma rang their doorbell and called Paramjith downstairs to the parking area to move his vehicle. When the complainant accompanied his father downstairs, Sharma picked an argument with Paramjith and escalated the dispute."

"Sharma pulled out a pistol and fired multiple rounds at Paramjith. He also opened fire at the complainant, who managed to save his life by taking cover behind vehicles. Paramjith succumbed to bullet wounds, and the accused fled the spot in his car," SI Yadav said.

Investigators said around 15-16 rounds were fired in total, with eight-nine bullets striking Dhankhar in the chest and torso. He was declared dead on arrival at the hospital.

Following the incident, Surajkund police registered an FIR under charges of murder, attempt to murder, criminal conspiracy, and relevant sections of the Arms Act, officials said. Senior officers directed crime units to trace the assailant.

A team from the Sector-30 Crime Branch, led by Inspector Anil Kumar, arrested Sharma on Saturday.

"During preliminary questioning, it emerged that the accused and the victim frequently quarrelled over minor matters," SI Yadav said. "The accused will be produced before the court where police will seek his remand for in-depth interrogation and recovery of evidence."

Surajkund Police SHO Inspector Prahlad Kumar said the autopsy was completed Saturday.

"The family of the deceased is grieving and is not in a position to speak until the last rites are performed. The family members of the arrested accused had also fled the spot," Inspector Kumar told The Indian Express. "The complaint names Sharma's wife, two children and brother, and they are absconding."

Investigators said the two families had a history of disputes over shared ground-floor space of their building. Arguments had also broken out four-five days prior to the shooting after Sharma's son brought their pet dog to the common parking area, to which the Dhankhar family had objected.

Police searches are underway to trace the absconding Sharma family members.

[FROM PAGE 1 | FULL REPORTS ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM]

Trump, Qatar emir

vulnerable to attacks.

During the call, Sheik Tamim "stressed the importance of continuing dialogue and adopting diplomatic means to resolve disputes, sparing the region further escalation, and ensuring freedom of maritime navigation and the security of energy supplies," according to the statement.

Meanwhile, Trump said that the US military carried out new limited strikes on Iran, targeting its air defence systems. In an exchange with reporters, he described the military action as "minor."

Iranian state media reported the sound of two explosions in the Suza area of Qeshm Island, which is in the crucial waterway for oil shipments.

The US Central Command, which oversees US military operations in West Asia, announced in a post on X late Friday that the US was offering "a reward of up to USD 20 million and possible relocation for information about Iran's nuclear programme, including its facilities, equipment, and associated personnel, such as those in the scientific community, or the movement of any of the above. The post included a link to the State Department's Rewards for Justice programme.

Iran's Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi held separate phone calls with his Iraqi and Tunisian counterparts to outline diplomatic progress aimed at easing tensions in the region.

Araghchi outlined in his call with Iraq's Foreign Minister Fuad Hussein the Islamic Republic's vision to resume negotiations with the US, according to Iraq's News Agency.

Araghchi said Iran's vision, which he said was presented to the US before the midterm elections, includes reopening the Strait of Hormuz, setting a timetable for the start of negotiations, and adding issues related to Iran's nuclear programme, Iraq's state media said.

Earlier this week, he talked with Turkey and Gulf leaders about regional developments and securing freedom of maritime navigation. Egyptian Foreign Minister Badr Abdelatty stressed the need to prioritize diplomatic solutions during a call with Araghchi.

Ghee

expected to fall to 2.5% (for a total of 222 mt of milk) in 2026 and 2% (226.5 mt) in 2027.

The US Department attributes the growth slowdown to "tightening feed and fodder supplies and animal productivity" due to El Niño-induced drought in states key to milk production.

However, it's milk fats where India is struggling.

Milk has two primary solids components: fat, and SNF or solids-not-fat. The latter mainly consists of lactose (milk sugar), proteins (casein and whey) and minerals (calcium, phosphorus, potassium, sodium, magnesium and various trace elements).

The accompanying tables show average monthly price realisations for Indian dairies from butter and skimmed milk powder sales. Butter has 82% fat content, while skimmed milk powder has 95-97% SNF by weight.

Between October 2023 and October 2026, the average ex-dairy price of butter has risen by 54.3%, from Rs 348 to Rs 537 per kg. The same period has seen skimmed milk powder prices go up by just 18%, from Rs 250 to Rs 295 per kg.

Dairies are currently selling yellow (cow) butter at Rs 550-555 per kg. The equivalent price for cow ghee, having 99.5% milk fat, comes to Rs 670-677 per kg or Rs 610-616 per litre (1 litre=910 grams). Expenses on processing (heating and melting Rs 5), packaging (Rs 10), transport and trade margins (15%), and 5% GST (goods and services tax) would take the maximum retail price (MRP) of pure ghee to Rs 755-762 per litre.

As per prices effective November 2, Amul's one-litre ghee pouch costs Rs 735, up from Rs 695, and 500-gm pack of table butter Rs 325, up from Rs 310. GCMMF offers lower distributor and retail margins compared to other dairy and FMCG players.

What explains the rise?

One reason is the consumer demand for high-fat dairy products. "The cut in GST rates since September 22, 2025 – from 18% to 5% on ice-cream; 12% to 5% on ghee, butter and cheese; and 5% to nil on paneer — has further fuelled the demand for these products," R S Sodhi, former managing director of the GCMFF, told *The Indian Express*.

The second reason is the actions of the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India and state departments. It started with the crackdowns on adulterated ghee suppliers, especially after the Tirupati laddu scam came to light in September 2024. Subsequently, there have been bans on sale of analogue paneer (made using vegetable oils instead of full-fat / whole milk) and interceptions of tankers carrying substandard milk.

"All this has led to genuine milk with high total solids content supplied by farmers fetching a premium," said Ganesan Palaniappan, a Chennai-based dairy commodities trader.

A third explanation has to do with exports of milk fat. During 2024-25 and 2025-26, India exported 56,578.64 tonnes and 37,167.33 tonnes of ghee, butter and anhydrous milk fat, valued at Rs 2,663.05 crore and Rs 2,034.78 crore, respectively. Those record shipments – when global fat prices ruled at $6,500-7,500 per tonne, as against $5,300-5,500 now – have depleted fat stocks with dairies, exacerbating domestic shortages.

The fact that milk production growth itself has slowed down has worsened matters. This is the fourth factor cited by Sodhi, also reflected in dairies struggling to procure enough milk.

The Karnataka Milk Federation has been forced to raise the base purchase price for standard cow milk containing 3.5% fat and 8.5% SNF from Rs 35 to Rs 42 per litre. Adding the existing Rs 5 incentive under the state government's Ksheeradhare scheme, farmers are effectively receiving Rs 47 per litre.

The cooperative has simultaneously revised upwards the MRP of its 'Nandini' toned milk (3% fat and 8.5% SNF) from Rs 46 to Rs 54 per litre, and that of ghee packed in one-litre sachets from Rs 715 to Rs 850.

Sodhi said: "The price inflation in fat is also due to the falling contribution of buffaloes to national milk production. In 2000-01, around 57% of India's total milk was from buffaloes. That share is hardly 45% today." Buffalo milk has higher fat content.

In Uttar Pradesh, dairies are paying farmers Rs 62-63 per litre for buffalo milk with 6.5% fat and 9% SNF.

Going forward

In the near term, prices may not rise further because the demand for milk products, particularly sweets, would ebb post-Diwali. Also, the winter and spring months coincide with the 'flush' season, when animals usually calve and produce more milk with a drop in temperatures.

Even with regard to El Niño, the impact on milk output is probably not going to be immediate. "In low-rainfall years, farmers tend to focus more on rearing animals than cultivating crops. Milk brings in much-needed cash, which means it makes sense to use scarce water for growing fodder instead of regular crops on their land," Palaniappan noted.

While El Niño could hit fodder and feed availability, the effects of that may also not be felt in the short run. Since the cows and buffaloes already giving milk are unlikely to be deprived of fodder, the brunt would be borne by pregnant animals, young heifers and calves. As their reproduction-cum-lactation cycles get disrupted, it might show up in lower production only a year or so from now.

Jantar Mantar

on October 12. Its president, Chipika Zhimo, a 25-year-old Delhi University law graduate, submitted an application at Parliament Street police station on September 29. It was to have around 250 participants.

"But on the day of our planned protest, we got to know that Jantar Mantar had been de-notified," he said.

The Union's application was among 15 submitted at Parliament Street police station since September 5; none was accepted by the Delhi Police, a police officer said.

Eleven of these protests were scheduled for October 12 or later. The other protest applications included that of the LPG Distributors' Association (LDAI), Jaat Mahasabha, Citizen Vote Vigilance Committee among others.

Alternative venues out of reach

After learning about the de-notification, Zhimo said, members of the Union approached Parliament Street police station to ask how they could proceed. "They recommended that we go to Burari Ground. We were directed to Ashok Vihar police station for permission."

At Ashok Vihar, Zhimo got to know that the Burari Ground belongs to the Delhi Development Authority (DDA). "We then went to the DDA office. We were told we will have to fill out an online application. When I went to the website, Burari ground was not listed among the options," he said.

The Union finally held a press conference at the Press Club of India on October 22 instead of a protest.

"We are not the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP). We don't have a pan-India presence. We can't just go to a place without permission and start protesting. We can gather a maximum of 500 people. If our students get involved in cases like Saurav Das (CJP's co-convenor), it will be very difficult for me to handle that. We were not giving permission so we decided to not protest at all," Zhimo said.

The LPG distributors, meanwhile, had sought permission to protest on October 26. B S Sharma, national president of LDAI, said the association approached the DDA for permission to hold its demonstration at CBD Ground.

"Since there was no option on the DDA site to book it for a protest, we booked it under the 'social cause' section as we are also a NGO," said Sharma.

The DDA granted them permission to use part of the ground, he said. However, on the night of October 25, the Delhi Police removed all their tents from the venue. "They said we had sought permission under the wrong criteria. So, I couldn't protest at the CBD ground," said Sharma.

The following day, around 5,000 distributors staged a protest on the road opposite the CBD Ground instead. "They let us protest on the road," he said.

"That's why Jantar Mantar shouldn't be de-notified. What's the point of protesting at a place where you are not even visible?" he asked.

The Rashtriya OBC Mahasangh, which plans to demonstrate on December 14 seeking the inclusion of the OBC column in the caste census, sought permission to hold its protest at Ramlila Maidan after learning that Jantar Mantar was no longer available.

"I received a message from the SHO saying that no protest is allowed at Jantar Mantar. We had demanded a space for a mere 500 people. But since we knew about the de-notification, we sought permission to protest at Ramlila Maidan," said general secretary Sachin Bhaurao Rajurkar.

"Protesting is a right. We also have a right to protest as much as the CJP does in New Delhi," he added.

Jantar Mantar had been the site of massive protests and hunger strikes organised by the CJP and other outfits in June-July demanding accountability over alleged exam irregularities, which finally ended with the resignation of then Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan. Police said it had modified its standing order which had laid down guidelines for protests at Jantar Mantar, declaring that the site now stands denotified.



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Smog enveloped the Capital on the eve of Diwali amid deteriorating air quality; (right) Festive season rush at Sadar Bazar in New Delhi. PRAVEEN KHANNA, GAJENDRA YADAV

54% of Delhi's industrial units monitored online breach emission norms

AQI at 369, in 'Very Poor' category a day before Diwali

Sophiya Mathew
New Delhi, November 7

MORE THAN half of Delhi's industrial units whose emissions are monitored online have been found exceeding pollution limits, while nearly half of the installed air-emission monitoring systems are offline, *The Indian Express* has learnt, raising questions over how effectively industrial pollution is being tracked in the Capital.

According to Delhi Pollution Control Committee (DPCC) officials, of the 87 Online Continuous Emission Monitoring Systems (OCEMS) installed in Delhi's industrial areas, 39 were offline as of Saturday. Of the remaining 48 transmitting data, at least 26 or 54% had been flagged for exceeding permissible emission limits.

The findings come as Delhi recorded an Air Quality Index (AQI) of 369 in the 'Very Poor' category on Saturday, a day before Diwali. Several areas recorded AQI levels above 400. The Air Quality Early Warning System has forecast 'severe' air quality for November 8 and 9.

The contribution of industry to Delhi's air pollution burden is significant throughout the year.

A 2018 TERI-ARAI source apportionment study had estimated that industrial emissions can account for up to 26% of the city's annual air pollution load and play a major role in the formation of secondary particulate matter (PM).

The delay

Delhi has 30,672 industrial units in conforming industrial areas. Of these, 128 highly-polluting units are required to install OCEMS to allow authorities to monitor their emissions in real-time. However, only 87 have installed the systems.

A senior Commission for Air Quality Management in National Capital Region and Adjoining Areas (CAQM) official said several industries had cited financial difficulties for the delay. "They told us that the conflict in West Asia had disrupted supply chains and pushed up the cost of raw materials and equipment. So, this was an additional financial pressure on them," the official added.

In a direction issued last month, the CAQM said industrial emissions were a major source of pollution in NCR. "Besides directly increasing PM concentrations, industrial emissions also contribute to the formation of secondary PM, adversely affecting ambient air quality. The impact of such emissions becomes prominent during the winter months, when adverse meteorological conditions restrict the dispersion of pollutants."

Reiterating the need for tighter surveillance, the CAQM directed industries covered under its order to operationalise OCEMS and enable real-time transmission of feeds from pan-tilt-zoom cameras. It has set a November 30 deadline to ensure the systems are fully operational.

Among other NCR states, meanwhile, Haryana has achieved near-complete coverage, with 907 units required to install or procure monitoring systems. Uttar Pradesh needs 648 such units, while it is 255 for Rajasthan.

Metal industries among major violators

Most of the flagged units in Delhi are involved in metal-processing activities, said officials. Of the 16 operational units engaged in metal-working, alloy manufacturing, foundry operations, brazing and die-casting, nine have been flagged for exceeding emission limits, they added.

These units are clustered across industrial hubs in Badli, New Mandoli, Narela, and Mayapuri. Smaller number of defaulting or flagged polluters are located in Bawana, Wazirpur, Gulabi Bagh, Mangolpuri, and North East Delhi's Lawrence Road. Among these, Narela, Bawana, Wazirpur and Mayapuri are among the pollution hotspots identified by Environment department.

Badli and adjoining Samaipur Badli recorded the highest proportion of violations, with six of the seven operational OCEMS-equipped units transmitting data exceeding emission limits, said officials.

New Mandoli, meanwhile, had the highest number of operational monitoring systems, accounting for 14 of Delhi's 48 online units. Six were flagged for violations. In Narela, two of the three online units exceeded emission limits, they added.

Individual flagged units were also reported from Wazirpur, Gulabi Bagh, Mangolpuri and Lawrence Road.

High PM

According to the officials, PM or suspended particulate matter (SPM), was the most common pollutant found exceeding limits in these industrial units. Of the 26 flagged units, 24 had breached limits for PM. In 23 of these units, PM was the only pollutant being monitored.

Also, monitoring of gaseous pollutants was considerably more limited, they said.

Among the 48 online air-emission entries, only two industrial facilities, apart from waste-processing plants, were monitoring pollutants such as sulphur dioxide, nitrogen oxides and hydrogen chloride.

The CAQM, which monitors OCEMS data from NCR states in real time, has also found problems with the data being transmitted by some industries, the officials added.

"We are monitoring the nature of the graphs emerging from these industries. Some show straight lines and no variations, which is unusual. This is how we are trying to identify if any manipulations have taken place," a senior CAQM official said.

"Issues have been reported in many cases where OCEMS have been installed, including prolonged offline status, flat-line data transmission, and technical contradictions like recording of pollutants continuing even when there was no flow of emissions."

• Skywatch

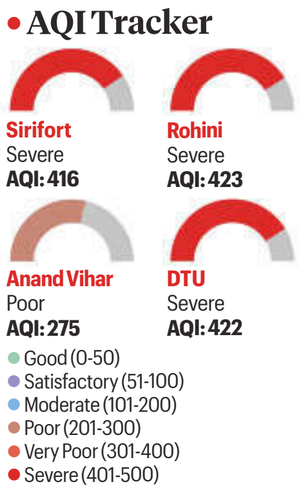
Forecast: November 8, 2026
Mainly clear sky. No rain.
Shallow to moderate fog

MAX: 28-30
0.5°C below normal

MIN: 14-16
1.7°C above normal

- *Sunrise: 6:39 AM (November 9)*
- *Sunset: 5:31 PM (November 8)*
- *Moonrise: 6:35 AM (November 9)*
- *Moonset: 4:39 PM (November 8)*

• AQI Tracker





Gurugram construction halts, workers stare at a bleak Diwali: 'How will people eat?'

Abhimanyu Hazarika
Gurugram, November 7

FOR 55-YEAR-OLD Virender Kumar, winter in the National Capital Region (NCR) brings more than toxic air and smog. It also means days without work, no wages and the struggle to make ends meet.

With dust-generating construction activities halted across Delhi-NCR since November 5 under the Commission for Air Quality Management in National Capital Region and Adjoining Areas' (CAQM) 15-day restrictions, Kumar, a daily-wage earner and small labour contractor working across Gurugram and Manesar, has found himself without work just ahead of Diwali. "Labourers have no work, their livelihood is gone," he said. "The question now is how will people eat? It has become a black Diwali."

Kumar estimates that 60-70% of construction labourers in the Gurugram-Manesar belt are currently without work. "They are giving no work. They just tell the workers: go home to your villages, or stay inside your jhuggis," Kumar said.

Many labourers are awaiting wages that remain unpaid for work completed before the restrictions came into force. Kumar claimed that it has been over a month and he is yet to be paid Rs 25,000 from a college construction project in Farrukhnagar.

"The owner keeps telling us to come back tomorrow," he said. "When workers approach the labour department, there is no hearing. They simply tell us to go to the High Court or Chandigarh." Kumar also questioned whether the restrictions were addressing other major sources of dust pollution.

"While construction sites have shut down, passing vehicles continue to kick up dust from unpaved roads. The government sprays water once in the middle of the road at noon, leaving the edges dry. By evening, when traffic peaks, dust blows everywhere," he said.

For developers, however, the restrictions have become an annual disruption that can be planned around.

Several builders in Gurugram said they have stopped dust-generating activities such as excavation, brickwork, plastering and RCC casting, while shifting workers to indoor jobs such as electrical work, plumbing, tiling and false ceiling installation.

Rajan Yadav, Director at Roots Developers, said, "The ban affects dust-generating work, so activities like excavation, RCC casting, brickwork and plastering slow down on our sites. But it isn't a complete stop for the project... We see this as a short pause in particular activities, not a halt."

Developers are also using the period to service heavy machinery – including cranes, piling rigs, and batching plants – and regulate material deliveries. While orders for ready-mix concrete have been frozen, incoming consignments of steel and cement are being stored.

Some said they are providing accommodation and food to retain their core workforce and plan to introduce additional shifts once restrictions are lifted.

Santosh Agarwal, Executive Director and CFO at Alpha Corp Development Limited, said the disruption could be managed through advance planning. He called for a balanced approach that protects public health without bringing economic activity to a halt, pointing to Gurugram's sustained real estate demand. Developers like Mohit Kalia, senior vice president at HCBS Developments, and Amit Modi, director at County Group, noted that structured site practices, dust-suppression systems, and better waste management must become standard industry operations.

According to industry insiders, bodies such as CREDAI and NAREDCO are also pushing for differentiated restrictions that would allow work at sites using advanced dust-control measures and technologies such as precast slabs and steel structures.

However, such discussions offer little comfort to informal labourers who depend on daily work. "Diwali has arrived, and labourers have to be paid, but no money is being released by construction sites," he said.

"People are just waiting while contractors say 'come tomorrow, come day after tomorrow.' If a man doesn't get paid, how is he even supposed to go home?"



A construction site at Nirvana Country in Sector 50 where work has stopped in the wake of anti-air pollution curbs. ABHIMANYU HAZARIKA

16-yr-old burnt with hot rod, kept hungry, rescued from Shaheen Bagh

Express News Service
New Delhi, November 7

A 16-YEAR-OLD girl, who was allegedly forced to work for nearly 20 hours a day, denied food and burnt with hot iron, was rescued from a house in Shaheen Bagh, police said on Saturday. The girl was employed as a domestic help at a house in Abul Fazal Enclave-II. The employer, Sadaf, has been arrested and sent to judicial custody.

The matter came to light after child rights organisation Bachpan Bachao Andolan filed a police complaint alleging that a minor was being employed as a child labourer in Kalkaji sub-division. Subsequently, a rescue operation was conducted by the Labour department, Delhi Police and NGO representatives on November 3 and 4. During the operation, the 16-year-old was rescued from the house.

On November 4, following directions from the Kalkaji subdivisional magistrate, a case was registered at Shaheen Bagh police station under Juvenile Justice (Care and Protection of Children) Act, 2015 and Child and Adolescent Labour (Prohibition and Regulation) Act, 1986. No arrest has been made so far.

In her statement to the police, the girl said that she was made to work from 6 am to 2 am, doing household chores. She alleged she was given tea around 11 am and often served leftover food. She also said her employer repeatedly burnt her with a hot iron on her back, hands and hips and wounded her with a heated knife. Several injuries and old scars, including burn marks across her back and deep wounds on her head, were found on her body, as per the NGO. The girl also told authorities that she was once deprived of food and water for three days and was beaten over minor mistakes.

According to the police, the girl was allegedly prevented from meeting her parents, who were allowed to speak to her over the phone only two or three times in nearly a year.

MCD expects new road-cleaning machines by mid-November

Press Trust of India
New Delhi, November 7

THE MUNICIPAL Corporation of Delhi (MCD) expects to receive the first batch of additional mechanised road-sweeping machines (MRSMs) by mid-November, followed by 55 more machines in phases from the first week of December till the month-end, civic body commissioner Sanjeev Khirwar said.

As per the commissioner, the civic body has stepped up efforts to reduce road dust and tackle pollution in Delhi.

The machines will expand road-cleaning coverage across the city, while the MCD is also using water sprinklers, anti-smog guns and jetting machines for deep cleaning of roads, Khirwar said.

• ACCORDING TO THE DELHI STATE HEALTH MISSION, 112,977 TB CASES WERE NOTIFIED LAST YEAR

Rs 57 crore unspent: Delhi used less than half of its tuberculosis budget in 2025

Tabshir Shams
New Delhi, November 7

DELHI SPENT only 47.4% of the total funds allocated under the National Tuberculosis Elimination Programme (NTEP) last year, underlining significant underutilisation of funds.

According to the Directorate General of Health Services (DGHS) report of 2025-26, only Rs 51.32 crore of the Rs 108.27 crore approved under the NTEP was utilised, leaving Rs 56.95 crore unspent. This underspending comes even as 112,977 TB cases were notified in 2025 in Delhi, according to the Delhi State Health Mission (DSHS).

On the reasons behind this gap in expenditure, a Ministry of Health official told *The Indian Express*, "Funds allocated under the programme are distributed across several expenditure heads, with a significant proportion going towards Direct Benefit Transfers to TB patients. Earlier, a number of beneficiaries did not have their Aadhaar numbers linked to their bank accounts, which affected the timely transfer of benefits. Gaps in digitisation and beneficiary identification contributed to this shortfall in fund utilisation. Similarly, some TB centres and research institutions have recorded lower expenditure due to delays in procurement and infrastructure development."

Under the Ni-kshay Poshan Yojana (NPY), TB patients receive Rs 1,000 per month through DBT for nutritional support during treatment. The amount was doubled from Rs 500 in November 2024.

A doctor from the National Institute of Tuberculosis and Respiratory Diseases (NITRD), Mehrauli, said, "There could be multiple causes behind the unspent funds. These can include delayed releases in funds, administrative bottlenecks and lower utilisation by implementing agencies. Also, many DOT centers, and TB hospitals are poorly equipped."

The mismatch between allocation and spending in the Capital's TB budget is, however, a reflection of a national trend. According to the Union Health Ministry, the NTEP spent Rs 1,179.68 crore of an approved Rs 1,888.82 crore in 2023-24, or about 62.5 per cent. Likewise, in 2022-23, it spent Rs 910.83 crore against Rs 1,666.33 crore, or about 54.7 per cent.

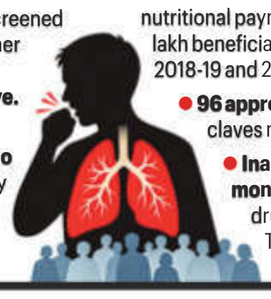
The DGHS report highlights that, under TB Mukt Bharat Abhiyaan 2.0, 3.45 lakh people were screened in slums, shelters and other high-risk settings. This included 2.20 lakh chest X-rays and 76,590 NAAT tests carried out last year. Of those screened in vulnerable settings, 29,361 tested positive, which is approximately one in 12. In addition, since March 24 this year, healthcare and community efforts have provided preventive treatment to 12,467 household contacts, secured support from 3,842 Ni-kshay Mitras (patient mentors) and distributed 17,127 food baskets to patients.

• DELHI'S TUBERCULOSIS BURDEN

- Only **Rs 51.32 crore** of the **Rs 108.27 crore** approved under NTEP in 2025-26 was spent, leaving **Rs 56.95 crore unused.**
- Of **3.45 lakh people** screened in slums, shelters and other high-risk areas in **2025, 29,361 tested TB positive.**
- **In 2022, over 48% of Delhi's TB patients got no nutritional support.** Only 51.8% received even one Ni-kshay Poshan Yojana installment.

CAG AUDIT REPORT OF 2024 HIGHLIGHTED IMPLEMENTATION GAPS

- **Rs 72.94 crore** in pending nutritional payments to 2.60 lakh beneficiaries between 2018-19 and 2022-23.
- **96 approved** autoclaves not procured.
- **Inadequate monitoring** of drug-resistant TB patients.



Shortcomings flagged

Earlier, the Comptroller and Auditor General (CAG) report of 2024 had also highlighted several deficiencies in the implementation of the NTEP in Delhi.

The report had pointed out that the government failed to run public awareness and education campaigns even though it was given Rs 6.42 crore for the purpose. Instead, it spent only a tiny fraction, Rs 16.10 lakh, over a five-year period (2016-21).

The audit also found that five of 25 chest clinics had not constituted district Drug-Resistant Tuberculosis (DR-TB) committees, only 13 of 32 prescribed evaluation visits were conducted, and supervisory visits were not carried out. Further, Rs 72.94 crore in nutritional support was pending for 2.60 lakh beneficiaries, 96 approved autoclaves had not been procured, and 2,587 drug-resistant TB patients had not received the prescribed post-treatment follow-up and feedback. In addition, the audit flagged staff shortages, lapses in drug storage monitoring and the absence of formal death audits in three selected chest clinics.

On shortcomings in Delhi's TB management plan, the CAG audit had said, "The audit observed that payment of Rs 72.94 crore to 2.60 lakh beneficiaries was pending for the period 2018-19 to 2022-23 (as of November 2022). Further, at the NDMC chest clinic, New Delhi, of the 22,793 beneficiaries eligible for incentives for nutritional support, payments were made to only 13,241, and Rs 1.48 crore remained due to 9,552 beneficiaries. Similarly, in MCD chest clinic and hospital, Nehru Nagar, payments were made to 38,890 beneficiaries and payment of Rs 4.22 crore was still to be paid to the 38,272 beneficiaries (as of May 2022)."

A 2024 study in BMC Public Health examined the delivery of NPY support, drawing on National TB Programme data for 3.7 million patients in nine states between 2018 and 2022. It found that in Delhi, only 51.8 per cent of notified patients received even one installment in 2022.

Despite the gaps in implementation, NTEP, had pledged to end TB in India by 2025, five years ahead of the global target of 2030.

After unknown group claims responsibility, anti-terror units probe Ghaziabad explosion

Sakshi Chand
New Delhi, November 7



Officers inspect the site of the blast at Vasundhara police outpost on Saturday. PRAVEEN KHANNA

A LITTLE-KNOWN outfit has purportedly claimed responsibility for an explosion at a police outpost in Ghaziabad on Friday night, prompting intelligence and anti-terror agencies to investigate whether it was an attack or an accidental blast.

The blast took place at the Vasundhara police outpost around 9 pm. A food delivery worker, who had arrived with a parcel for an officer, was injured in the explosion, which also damaged a part of the outpost. Several police personnel were away on patrol duty in connection with Dhanteras festivities at the time.

Teams from the National Investigation Agency, Delhi Police Special Cell, Uttar Pradesh Anti-Terrorism Squad (ATS), Special Task Force, Intelligence Bureau and local intelligence units visited the site on Saturday. Around 4 pm, UP (ATS) DIG Abhishek Yadav was seen visiting the outpost.

Hours after the explosion, an X account allegedly linked to an outfit calling itself Tehreek-ul-Mujahideen Hindustan (TMH) claimed responsibility for the incident.

Police, however, have not verified the claim or established any terror link.

According to sources, the claim surfaced around 2.30 am on Saturday, when an X account named 'Ghazi 2' allegedly circulated audio and video messages along with a statement bearing the name and insignia of TMH.

The statement purportedly identified Ghaziabad Police as the target and described the blast as an operation against the government. It also levelled allegations against the police, armed forces and judiciary and warned of further attacks.

Investigators said they are examining the messages to establish who circulated them and whether the outfit had any role in the explosion. The identity of those behind the account and the group's operational presence remain unverified.

At the outpost, investigators spent Saturday examining physical evidence to determine how the explosion occurred.

Ghaziabad Police Commissioner J Ravinder Goud said the exact cause of the explosion was yet to be established and all possible angles were being examined.

Police said the food delivery executive, Ishan, a resident of Arthala in Ghaziabad, had arrived with a meal ordered by Sub-Inspector Vikas Singh and was standing near him when the explosion took place.

Shattered glass struck Ishan on his face and head. He was taken to a nearby hospital, where his condition was reported to be stable. Kumar escaped unhurt.

The impact of the explosion caused cracks in a wall and shattered windowpanes.

Based on a complaint filed by Singh, a case has been registered at Indirapuram police station under Explosives Act, Prevention of Damage to Public Property Act as well as Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita sections.

Investigators are examining whether firecrackers reportedly stored at the outpost or a malfunctioning air-conditioning unit could have caused the explosion. Neither possibility has been confirmed.

Police are also looking into an unattended scooter found abandoned around 1.5 km from the blast site. The owner of the scooter has joined the investigation, police said.

"According to Momin, the owner, when his scooter broke down, he parked it on the elevated road and returned to his home in Mayur Vihar," said an officer. Investigators said no link between Momin and the blast has been established so far.

Along with UP ATS DIG, officers from intelligence agencies also inspected the site but declined to comment on their findings.

So far, police have not officially named any outfit as the one behind the blast.

Toll in Chawri Bazar collapse rises to six, building owner held

Sakshi Chand
New Delhi, November 7



The building collapsed on Thursday morning in Chawri Bazar area. FILE

AS RESCUE operations continued for the third consecutive day, four more persons were pulled out from the debris of the collapsed building in Old Delhi's Chawri Bazar area on Saturday, taking the total death toll to six.

The Delhi Police also arrested the building owner in connection with the incident on Saturday.

The building owner has been identified as Saimullah alias Ayub, a resident of Gali Shish Mahal near Ajmeri Gate. His arrest comes a day after three contractors — Siraj, Tajuddin and Furkan — were arrested from Sirohi village in Haryana's Faridabad district. All three contractors are also residents of the Ajmeri Gate area, police said.

The latest victims have been identified as Pankaj Sharma, resident of village Bhosawaha in Bihar's Khagaria district; Vipin Ram, resident of Saket Block in Mandawali, Delhi; Shantu, son of Shankar Mukhiya, resident of Hanuman Nagar village in Khagaria district; and Dinesh Sah, resident of Tola Hanuman Nagar in Bihar's Khagaria district.

The rescue operation continued late into Saturday, with police suspecting that more bodies could be recovered from beneath the debris.

On the challenges to rescue efforts, DCP (Central) Rohit Rajbir Singh said the narrow lane leading to the building, which is barely four to five feet wide, has made the operation difficult. He said the debris was being removed carefully to ensure that no further damage was caused to surrounding structures and that the safety of anyone who might still be trapped beneath the rubble was not compromised.

He added that the process was time-consuming, with multiple agencies continuing to work at the site, and the rescue operation was likely to continue until late Sunday night.

The three-storey under-construction building collapsed on Thursday morning at around 9:48 am in Gali Sheesh Mahal, near Chawri Bazar Metro station. The incident triggered a massive rescue operation involving the Delhi Police, Delhi Fire Services, National Disaster Response Force and the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD).

Police have registered a case under Section 105 of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, which deals with culpable homicide not amounting to murder. Investigators are examining the circumstances under which construction work was being carried out at the property and whether violations of building norms or negligence led to the collapse.

In June, the Delhi Police had written to MCD highlighting that the building was being constructed illegally. Following the collapse, the civic body has suspended two engineers, an assistant engineer and a junior engineer, pending an inquiry into alleged lapses.

Meanwhile, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta also directed officials to conduct a detailed investigation into the incident and take strict action against those found responsible.



TATA

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Corporate Identification Number: L27100MH1907PLC000260

NOTICE

Extract of Standalone Financial Results for the quarter/six months ended on 30th September 2026

₹ Crore

Particulars	Quarter ended on 30.09.2026	Quarter ended on 30.06.2026	Quarter ended on 30.09.2025	Six months ended on 30.09.2026	Six months ended on 30.09.2025	Financial year ended on 31.03.2026
	Audited	Audited	Audited	Audited	Audited	Audited
Total revenue from operations	42,535.28	36,896.55	34,679.54	79,431.83	65,693.90	1,39,720.21
Net Profit / (Loss) for the period (before tax and exceptional items)	6,766.39	6,111.67	5,803.23	12,878.06	10,580.41	22,453.36
Net Profit / (Loss) for the period before tax (after exceptional items)	6,695.58	5,820.17	5,403.72	12,515.75	9,961.82	21,354.50
Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after tax	5,053.64	4,535.15	4,060.42	9,588.79	7,583.91	16,066.10
Total comprehensive income for the period [Comprising Profit / (Loss) for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax)]	(5,269.58)	3,480.90	4,102.33	(1,788.68)	10,840.25	13,253.45
Paid-up equity share capital [Face value ₹ 1 per share]	1,247.43	1,247.43	1,247.43	1,247.43	1,247.43	1,247.43
Reserves excluding revaluation reserves						1,34,080.60
Securities premium reserve	31,290.24	31,290.24	31,290.24	31,290.24	31,290.24	31,290.24
Net Worth	1,25,362.62	1,35,621.10	1,29,726.84	1,25,362.62	1,29,726.84	1,32,140.03
Paid-up Debt Capital	15,160.70	15,159.95	15,157.74	15,160.70	15,157.74	15,159.21
Debt Equity Ratio	0.55	0.49	0.51	0.55	0.52	0.50
Earnings per equity share:						
Basic earnings per share of ₹ 1 each (not annualised) - in Rupees (after exceptional items)	4.05	3.64	3.26	7.69	6.08	12.88
Diluted earnings per share of ₹ 1 each (not annualised) - in Rupees (after exceptional items)	4.05	3.64	3.25	7.69	6.08	12.88
Debenture Redemption Reserve	1,328.75	1,328.75	1,328.75	1,328.75	1,328.75	1,328.75
Debt Service Coverage Ratio	5.43	4.27	2.51	4.81	1.80	2.86
Interest Service Coverage Ratio	7.51	7.67	7.96	7.59	7.45	8.09

Extract of Consolidated Financial Results for the quarter/six months ended on 30th September 2026

₹ Crore

Particulars	Quarter ended on 30.09.2026	Quarter ended on 30.06.2026	Quarter ended on 30.09.2025	Six months ended on 30.09.2026	Six months ended on 30.09.2025	Financial year ended on 31.03.2026
	Unaudited	Unaudited	Unaudited	Unaudited	Unaudited	Audited
Total revenue from operations	65,436.24	60,794.29	58,689.29	1,26,230.53	1,11,867.41	2,32,139.94
Net Profit / (Loss) for the period (before tax and exceptional items)	5,106.47	4,183.01	4,642.88	9,289.48	7,842.08	17,001.15
Net Profit / (Loss) for the period before tax (after exceptional items)	5,455.15	3,837.53	4,222.47	9,292.68	7,289.55	15,968.69
Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after tax	3,699.59	2,385.24	3,183.09	6,084.83	5,190.45	10,885.82
Total comprehensive income for the period [Comprising Profit / (Loss) for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax)]	4,354.05	2,336.83	4,673.88	6,690.88	9,025.40	16,377.93
Paid-up equity share capital [Face value ₹ 1 per share]	1,247.43	1,247.43	1,247.43	1,247.43	1,247.43	1,247.43
Reserves (excluding revaluation reserves) and Non controlling interest						1,02,533.02
Net Worth	1,00,337.40	1,01,054.51	91,548.11	1,00,337.40	91,548.11	98,768.46
Debt Equity Ratio	0.86	0.80	0.91	0.87	0.93	0.82
Earnings per equity share:						
Basic earnings per share of ₹ 1 each (not annualised) - in Rupees (after exceptional items)	2.94	1.86	2.49	4.80	4.15	8.65
Diluted earnings per share of ₹ 1 each (not annualised) - in Rupees (after exceptional items)	2.94	1.86	2.49	4.80	4.15	8.65
Debenture Redemption Reserve	1,328.75	1,328.75	1,328.75	1,328.75	1,328.75	1,328.75
Debt Service Coverage Ratio	0.83	1.03	0.65	0.91	0.76	0.98
Interest Service Coverage Ratio	4.60	4.53	4.80	4.57	4.25	4.72

Note:

The above is an extract of the detailed format of Standalone and Consolidated financial results of Tata Steel Limited for the quarter/six months ended on 30th September 2026 filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 and Regulation 52 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulation, 2015. The full format of the Standalone and Consolidated financial results of Tata Steel Limited for the quarter/six months ended on 30th September 2026 are available on the websites of the Stock Exchanges (www.nseindia.com/www.bseindia.com) and the Company's website (www.tatasteel.com).

Sd/-
T V Narendran
Chief Executive Officer &
Managing Director

Sd/-
Koushik Chatterjee
Executive Director &
Chief Financial Officer

Mumbai,November 7, 2026

TATA STEEL

BHARAT RATNA L K ADVANI AT 100

'He gave the party a clear foundation rooted in the principle of Nation First'



SPECIAL TO EXPRESS
BY NARENDRA MODI



As Deputy Prime Minister and one of India's longest-serving Home Ministers, L K Advani was instrumental in strengthening India's security apparatus: Prime Minister Narendra Modi

SHRI LAL Krishna Advani Ji enters the hundredth year of his life today, 8th November. This year, his birthday fittingly coincides with Diwali, a festival associated with Prabhu Shri Ram and the Diya, at a time when we are marking 75 years since the inception of the Jana Sangh, 125th Jayanti of Dr Syama Prasad Mookerjee and recently celebrated a hundred years of the RSS.

There are very few people whose lives have touched so many different chapters of modern India. Advani Ji was born on 8th November 1927, on Dev Deepawali. As a youngster in 1947, he experienced the pain of leaving behind his familiar world in Sindh. He rebuilt his life from scratch without bitterness. This trait of being able to build from scratch, against all odds, has stayed with him throughout. It was seen while he was strengthening the Jana Sangh and later building the BJP. His tenures as BJP president saw the Congress falling sharply from 400 to below 200 in 1989 and the BJP becoming the single largest party for the first time in 1996. Advani Ji nurtured generations of karyakartas and gave the party a clear foundation rooted in the principle of Nation First.

Two qualities always set Advani Ji apart as a leader. First, his ideological clarity and intellectual sharpness. This was reflected in his speeches and writings. The Jana Sangh and BJP resolutions he authored remain worth reading even today, while his interviews were consistently incisive and precise. Second, the manner in which he exposed the pseudo-secularism propounded by a large section of the Indian polity for many years.

Advani Ji took up every responsibility with immense diligence. As an RSS pracharak, Advani Ji first worked in different parts of Rajasthan. From there, he went to the national capital, where he started working closely with Atal Ji. History shows that it is rare for two towering political leaders to work together for several decades, cooperating with each other without becoming competitors. Advani Ji and Atal Ji set a remarkable example. Together, they changed the course of Indian politics.

The Delhi that Advani Ji came to was coming to terms with the horrors of Partition. He immersed himself in making the Jana Sangh stronger. In 1967, Advani Ji became the chairman of the Delhi Metropolitan Council, where he worked alongside the late Vijay Kumar Malhotra Ji (who became chief executive councillor).

In 1970, Advani Ji's parliamentary innings began. His interventions have won appreciation across the political spectrum. He made a mark as an MP and later, as Leader of Opposition, in both Houses and from the treasury benches too. Despite parliamentary commitments, he frequently travelled across India meeting people.

I vividly recall the 1991 Lok Sabha elections. It was decided that Advani Ji would contest the Lok Sabha elections from two seats, one of which was Gandhinagar. He had an old link with Gujarat. His father had settled in Kutch after Partition. Advani Ji had also served as a Rajya Sabha MP from Gujarat. So, it was a homecoming of sorts. Being involved in the BJP organisation, I had the honour of helping prepare his papers and assisting him throughout the campaign. The people of Gandhinagar sent him to Parliament time and again. As a voter of Gandhinagar, I also had the honour of voting for Advani Ji on numerous occasions. The care and attention he devoted to his constituency is something to learn from.

The Emergency was a watershed moment in Advani Ji's life. He was at the forefront of saving democracy and protecting the Constitution. His experiences found their way into his book, 'A Prisoner's Scrap-Book.' One part of that book, titled 'A Tale of Two Emergencies', beautifully explained the striking similarities between the events in India starting June 1975 and those in Nazi Germany in 1933.

The Emergency was a watershed moment in Advani Ji's life. He was at the forefront of saving democracy and protecting the Constitution. His experiences found their way into his book, '*A Prisoner's Scrap-Book*.' One part of that book, titled 'A Tale of Two Emergencies', beautifully explained the striking similarities between the events in India starting June 1975 and those in Nazi Germany in 1933.

Advani Ji was a fiery Opposition leader but an equally excellent administrator. When the Janata Government came to office in 1977, Advani Ji became Minister for Information and Broadcasting. It is widely accepted that his work in this department was extremely impactful. As Deputy Prime Minister and one of India's longest-serving Home Ministers, he was instrumental in strengthening India's security apparatus. His work in improving the lives of our security forces is remembered with great fondness. His unequivocal stand against terrorism ensured India got a tough anti-terror law.

Of course, an iconic moment in Advani Ji's life was the Somnath to Ayodhya Rath Yatra. It changed the course of Indian society for the better. I consider it a privilege that I got the opportunity to be involved in this yatra from the ideation stage to execution. Being present at Somnath when the yatra began was particularly special. A yatra can be very demanding, requiring long hours, constant travel, physical endurance and an ability to remain focused despite fatigue. Advani Ji embodied this endurance.

I also have memories of the saddening moments of Advani Ji's arrest in Bihar. Then, in Gujarat, the BJP withdrew support from the Chimanbhai Patel Government. With this, a simple message was given, that when it comes to our ideology and the Ram Temple, there will never be any compromise. Many of our senior leaders and karyakartas took an oath that, come what may, a Ram Temple will be built. And, years later, with the blessings of the people of India, a grand Mandir for Prabhu Shri Ram became a reality in Ayodhya.

There is so much more of Advani Ji that is outstanding. His simplicity, for example. After the Navnirman Movement, Advani Ji had come to Junagadh and stayed for a month as an ordinary karyakarta, preparing the party for the Assembly elections in which Congress was rejected. He has always shown what probity in public life is about. He is a voracious reader. Those who have spent time with him know how carefully he goes through newspapers. He is a big fan of cinema and theatre, and has been an enthusiastic film critic. His sense of history and the need to preserve it is visible in his book, '*My Country My Life*'.

Advani Ji always remained in touch with Sindhi culture. Another effort he undertook was the popularisation of Sindhu Darshan Puja near Leh. I myself had been to one puja with Advani Ji and George Fernandes Ji.

Any account of Advani Ji's remarkable journey would be incomplete without mentioning Kamla Advani Ji. She was a constant source of strength and support throughout his public life.

Growing up in Karachi, Advani Ji could hardly have imagined the path his life would take. In an expression of gratitude, the people of India conferred upon him the Bharat Ratna in 2024. As Advani Ji enters the hundredth year of his life, I pray that he be blessed with good health and that he continues to inspire us all as he has always done.

The author is the Prime Minister of India

A year since SIR began in Bengal, tribunals now count on pick-up after Diwali

Atri Mitra
Kolkata, November 7

EXACTLY A year after the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls started in West Bengal, on November 4, 2025, and with the fate of more than 35 lakh voters still pending before them, the 19 judicial tribunals headed by retired judges are hoping the promised changes in their functioning will finally kick in post-Diwali.

On Saturday, news came of a third retired judge, Justice Biswajit Basu, resigning as tribunal head, citing personal reasons.

Earlier, former chief justice of the Calcutta High Court T S Sivagananam and Justice Indrajit Chatterjee (retired) had submitted their resignations, with Justice Chatterjee agreeing to stay on after he was promised that his grievances would be addressed.

Justice Basu, who has sent his resignation to the Calcutta High Court Chief Justice, is also the chairperson of the Commission on Institutional Corruption, appointed to the post in May 2026.

Sources close to the retired judge said he was unhappy over the infrastructure provided for the tribunal, with the move to make Aadhaar identification mandatory for logging into the Election Commission of India (ECI) portal coming as the last straw.

The Aadhaar condition for uploading orders was one of the main demands raised by a committee representing the 19 tribunal chiefs with the ECI recently.

The other demands included a provision to generate notice for a hearing on the ECI portal, and shifting of the tribunals to a central location in Kolkata from Joka, which is situated on the outskirts.

While the ECI agreed to all the demands, these are yet to be implemented on the ground. A source said that the new ECI guidelines would also allow "electors to download orders after the tribunal chiefs have uploaded them".

A source said: "The tribunals continue to function from a room about 12X10 sq ft in size, including the ex-judges and their staff, comprising seven-eight members each, working from 10 am to 5 pm daily. There are few breaks, and no separate toilets for the ex-judges. The judges don't expect the situation to change in a day or two, but they are happy that the ECI has at least agreed to their demands, particularly to shift the location of the tribunals."

Justice Chatterjee (retd) had cited the daily long commute and bad roads for his resignation.

The Indian Express reported last month that the tribunal work had come to a virtual halt as their chiefs had refused to use Aadhaar to log into the ECI portal, over privacy concerns. The ex-judges wrote to the West Bengal Additional Chief Electoral Officer on September 24, asking for the Aadhaar authentication to be withdrawn, just three days after the feature was added.

On October 28, the state Chief Electoral Officer got back saying the tribunal chiefs could set up digital signature certificates via their PAN card and a government ID card.

Sources said that while they wait for the changes to be implemented, the tribunals are going about the process of checking the applications, and maintaining physical records of notings, to be uploaded when the new portal log-ins are allowed.

The setting up of judicial tribunals as part of the SIR is unique to Bengal, with the Supreme Court ordering the same in March this year. The tribunals took up the cases of 27.18 lakh voters, struck off the rolls just before the Assembly polls in April, out of the 60.06 lakh originally flagged by the ECI's centralised software for "logical discrepancies". The flagging of "logical discrepancies" was also a first.

The ECI has given scant details of the tribunal functioning. On September 18, it told the Supreme Court that 38.31 lakh appeals had been filed, of which 22.21 lakh were filed by the deleted voters and 16.10 lakh appeals were against inclusions. Only 1.26 lakh appeals had been disposed of till September 10, the ECI said.

Another former judge heading a tribunal resigns, cites personal reasons



Bengal tribunals were set up in March this year following an order by the Supreme Court. EXPRESS

Akhilesh to visit Ram temple in Dec; Yogi: Apologise to Ram bhakts first

Lalmani Verma
Lucknow, November 7

NEARLY THREE years after the consecration ceremony of the Ram Mandir in Ayodhya, the SP Saturday announced that party president Akhilesh Yadav will visit the temple for the first time on December 12, three months ahead of the UP elections.

The BJP has frequently accused Akhilesh of indulging in appeasement politics.

SP spokesperson Pawan Pandey told *The Indian Express* that Akhilesh will go to Hanuman Garhi with his MP wife Dimple Yadav and other family members before visiting the Ram Temple.

In July this year, Akhilesh had said he would visit the Ram Mandir once the Kedareshwar Dham in Etawah was complete, days after CM Yogi Adityanath asked him to visit Ayodhya for "good sense".

Pandey said the SP chief will visit the Ram temple after performing puja at Kedareshwar Dham as its construction is nearly complete.

A senior SP leader said by visiting the Ram Temple, Yadav will be trying to brush aside the allegations of appeasement of Muslims and get support from non-Yadav OBCs and the upper castes, including Brahmins and Thakurs, in UP polls.

"Now, Akhilesh will target BJP from the land of Ram Lalla over allegations of irregularities in donation management at the temple. That will be a big blow to the BJP," he added.

BJP state spokesperson Rakesh Tripathi said, "*Bahut der kar di huzur aate aate* (You took really so long to arrive). Those who considered firing on Ram bhakts as their achievement and promised to rebuild the Babri mosque, are now announcing to visit the Ram Temple only because of the growing influence of Hindutva. But they would not get any benefit of darshan because they are doing this for electoral gains."

Rejecting BJP's allegations, Pawan Pandey said Akhilesh's visit will be completely religious and it has no political link.

Speaking at the Deepotsav celebrations in Ayodhya, CM Yogi Adityanath took a veiled swipe at the SP chief's proposed Ayodhya visit. "*Jin logon ne upekshit kiya tha, apmaanit kiya tha,* Ram *bhakton par goliyan chalai thin, santon ko apmanit karke unpar* lathicharge *kiye they ve log* Ayodhya *aayen zarur lekin maafi maang kar ke aayen. Apne krityon ke liye paschatap kar len* (Those who fired on Ram bhakts, subjected saints to lathicharge and insult, and ignored Ayodhya, should visit the Ram Temple only after apologising to Ram Lalla's devotees and saints. They should repent for their actions)."

BJP state chief Pankaj Chaudhary said, "Visiting a temple only during the election season and questioning Sanatan Dharma at other times, naturally raise questions."



Dazzling Deepotsav

During the 10th Deepotsav celebrations in Ayodhya on Saturday. ANI

AYODHYA WAS illuminated with over 36 lakh earthen lamps across 56 ghats along the Saryu river.

VICE PRESIDENT C P Radhakrishnan, Uttar Pradesh Governor Anandiben Patel and Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath lit the lamps at Ram Ki Paidi as part of the celebrations.

OVER 35,000 volunteers from Dr Ram Manohar Lohia Avadh University, colleges and other organisations took part in lighting of diyas.

EPISODES FROM the Ramayana were depicted through 3D holographic projection mapping.

DRONE SHOW formations depicted Lord Ram on the night sky.

'India's first AI scam': TN minister alleges library fraud under DMK, complaint filed

Arun Janardhanan
Chennai, November 7

A RAJMOHAN, the Tamil Nadu Minister for School Education, Tamil Development, Information and Publicity, on Saturday said his department had lodged a complaint with the anti-corruption police over allegedly fraudulent, "AI-generated" books purchased for public libraries during the previous DMK government, widening a controversy at Coimbatore's Periyar Arivulagam into allegations of a statewide procurement scam.

Displaying documents that he described as original committee recommendations, purchase orders and payment proceedings, Rajmohan announced a special committee to examine library collections and said the government would seek to recover "every rupee" spent on the disputed books.

The department had requested registration of a case, he said.

The allegations follow an essay by novelist Perumal Murugan describing expensive books containing elementary errors, questionable historical claims and unfamiliar authors' names at Periyar Arivulagam.

Rajmohan said similar books from one Agalvilakku Publishing House had reached other libraries, including Connemara Library and the Kalaignar Library in Madurai. "This is not a scam that is going to end with Coimbatore's Periyar Arivulagam," he said.

He also cited procurement for libraries in Tiruchi, Salem, Cuddalore and Tirunelveli, and referred to Rs 5 crore earmarked for e-books. He did not provide a consolidated, documented figure for the alleged loss. Rajmohan said committee meetings took place in November and December last year and again in January. Of approximately 137 committee members, 112 attended the January meeting, he said. Their recommendations subsequently received approval from a higher-level committee.

He alleged that approval had been given under pressure from the DMK. He did not explain who allegedly applied that pressure or how. An order dated February 14 sought delivery of the books within seven days, he said, while March proceedings authorised the release of treasury funds to the district. Some pending payments were processed after the elections, when books were unpacked and arranged, he acknowledged.

Rajmohan held up "Naladiyar: A Guide to Life" which Murugan had criticised for treating a collection of classical Tamil verse as that of an individual poet and philosopher. Rajmohan asked what would happen if candidates absorbed such claims and reproduced them in their answers.

"Poverty is not merely about money and material possessions," he said. "Poverty of knowledge is also a great poverty." He offered a reward for finding one and a medal if Stalin produced another. Rajmohan compared the operation to printing counterfeit currency, alleging that AI had been used to combine material from different authors into new volumes. He called it "India's first AI scam," a characterisation he did not substantiate with a nationwide comparison. He instructed libraries to place books supplied by Agalvilakku in their respective boxes and preserve them as evidence.

● SANKALP AMONKAR'S INDUCTION SEEN AS FULFILLMENT OF 'PROMISE' MADE WHEN HE CROSSED OVER FROM CONG; WAS AMONG EIGHT 'TURNCOAT' MLAs

After switching sides in 2022, Mormugao MLA in Goa Cabinet

Pavneet Singh Chadha
Panaji, November 7

BJP MLA Sankalp Amonkar from Mormugao was sworn in as a minister in the Goa Cabinet on Saturday, months ahead of the Assembly elections in the coastal state.

Governor Pusapati Ashok Gajapathi Raju administered the oath of office and secrecy to the BJP legislator at Raj Bhavan in the presence of Chief Minister Pramod Sawant. One Cabinet berth became vacant after former Goa Chief Minister and Agriculture Minister Ravi Naik died in October last year.

Amonkar's induction in the Sawant-led Cabinet is seen as fulfilment of a "promise" made when he crossed over to the BJP in 2022. The Assembly election in Goa is likely to be held in early 2027. Amonkar contested the 2022 Assembly elections on a Congress ticket and defeated three-time BJP MLA Milind Naik from Mormugao. He was among the group of eight 'turncoat' MLAs who "defected" and switched over to the BJP from the Congress in September 2022.

Amonkar is the third legislator, among the group of eight former Congress MLAs who crossed over, to be inducted in the Sawant-led Cabinet.

In November 2023, BJP MLA from Curchorem Nilesh Cabral had resigned to 'accommodate' Nuvem MLA Aleixo Sequeira in the Cabinet. In August last year, Sequeira resigned from the Cabinet, citing personal reasons, paving the way for a Cabinet reshuffle. Former Goa chief minister Digambar Kamat and former Assembly Speaker Ramesh Tawadkar were sworn in as ministers in the Cabinet at the time.



Goa Governor P A Gajapathi Raju, CM Pramod Sawant and Cabinet Minister Sankalp Amonkar at Lok Bhavan in Panaji on Saturday. ANI

Ahead of the swearing-in ceremony, Amonkar thanked the BJP leaders from the state, his party colleagues and the party high command. "I am grateful to them as well as to the people of Goa. I do not believe that it's late [induction in Cabinet]. The way the party is growing stronger, I believe whatever time is there...no matter how little...I will do what I can for the people of Goa," he told the media.

"This government has built a bridge in 65 days, so I would say there is a lot of time to do things. Whatever is possible, I will fulfil the responsibilities that I have been assigned," he added.

Amonkar, a first-time MLA, was appointed the Chairperson of the Sewerage and Infrastructural Development Corporation of Goa Limited last year and continued to push for a Cabinet berth. He is a graduate of Mormugao Education Society, Zuarinagar. Before joining the BJP, he held several roles in the Congress, including as the deputy leader of the Congress Legislative Party and vice-president of the Goa Pradesh Congress Committee.

Govt. of Uttarakhand

Celebration of Service, Good Governance, and Devotion

Uttarakhand Formation Day

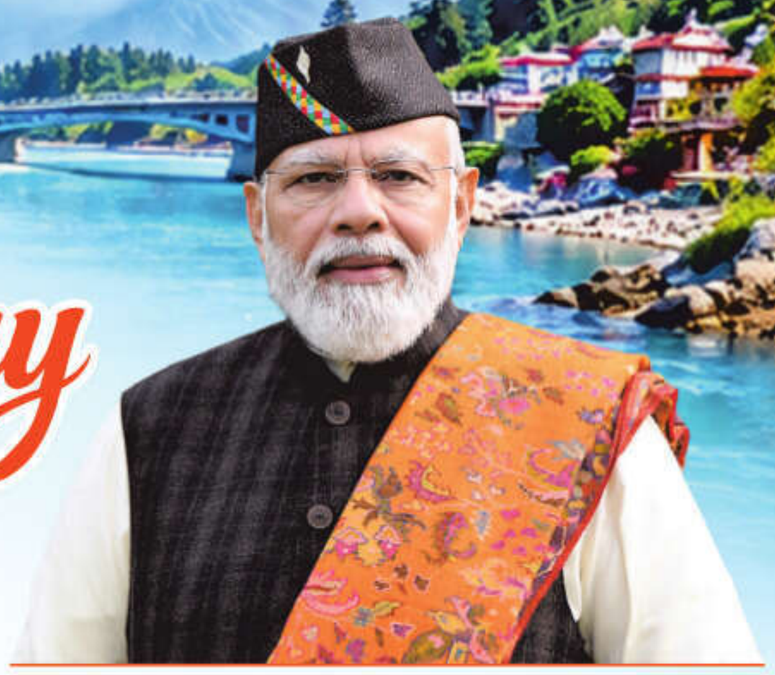
9 November



Greetings & Best Wishes

"Heartiest congratulations and best wishes to the divine people of the state on the occasion of Uttarakhand State Formation Day. Under the guidance of Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi, Uttarakhand is attaining new heights of development, prosperity, and self-reliance. Realizing the resolve of a developed Uttarakhand, we are committed to making a significant contribution to building a developed India by the year 2047. Come, let us all unite on State Formation Day and take a pledge to build the Uttarakhand of our dreams."

Pushkar Singh Dhami
Chief Minister, Uttarakhand



"The construction of a developed India in the 21st century rests on two main pillars: first, pride in our heritage, and second, making every possible effort for development. Today, Uttarakhand is continuously strengthening both these pillars. This decade is the decade of Uttarakhand"

Narendra Modi
Prime Minister

Devbhoomi Uttarakhand

PRIDE IN HERITAGE, CONFIDENCE IN DEVELOPMENT AND A RESOLVE FOR A SELF-RELIANT FUTURE

Governance and Historic Decisions

- First state in independent India to implement the Uniform Civil Code (UCC).
- Implementation of a strong land law, stringent anti-conversion law, and anti-riot law.
- Transparency in the recruitment process ensured through the anti-cheating law.
- 10% horizontal reservation in government jobs for statehood activists and 30% for women.

Health and Education

- Over 63.32 lakh Ayushman cards issued.
- More than 17.36 lakh patients provided with cashless treatment worth over ₹3,717 crore.
- First state in the country to implement the National Education Policy (NEP).
- 85% construction work of the Kichha AIIMS Satellite Center completed.

Tourism and Connectivity

- Foundation stone laid for the Sonprayag-Kedarnath and Govindghat-Hemkund Sahib ropeway projects.
- Inauguration of the Delhi-Dehradun Economic Corridor at a cost of ₹11,963 crore.
- Arrival of over 6.33 million (63 lakh) pilgrims during the Char Dham Yatra.
- Promotion of rural tourism through 6,161 homestays.

Youth Power and Employment

- Over 35,000 government jobs provided to youths in 5 years.
- More than 38,550 beneficiaries under the Chief Minister Self-Employment Scheme (Mukhyamantri Swarozgar Yojana).
- Over 3.10 lakh women became Lakhpati Didis.
- 10% horizontal reservation for Agniveers in Group-C uniformed services.

Vikas Bhi Virasat Bhi



Farmers, Women, and Rural Empowerment

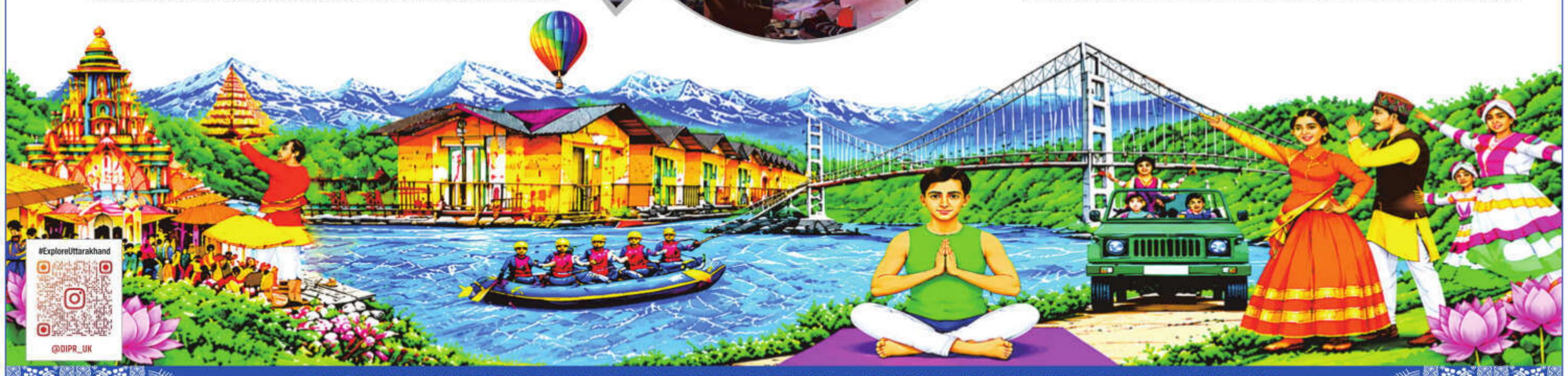
- More than 3.10 lakh Lakhpati Didis.
- Subsidies provided to farmers under the Apple and Kiwi Missions.
- Trout Promotion Scheme worth ₹170 crore.
- 1,860 villages benefited through the Pradhan Mantri Gram Sadak Yojana (PMGSY).

Investment and Economic Growth

- MoUs worth ₹3.56 lakh crores signed at the Global Investor Summit.
- Grounding of investments exceeding ₹1 lakh crore.
- Sales of "House of Himalayas" crossed ₹6 crores.
- Solar power generation exceeding 1,027 megawatts.

Sports and Youth Talent

- Uttarakhand won 103 medals at the 38th National Games.
- The state's first Sports University in Haldwani.
- Establishment of a Women's Sports College in Lohaghat.



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Satyajit Ray film institute unrest: 2 faculty members suspended, no classes till Dec 11

Sharanyo Basu
Kolkata, November 7

TENSIONS CONTINUE to brew at the Satyajit Ray Film and Television Institute (SRFTI) in Kolkata on the 40th day of student unrest on campus, this time over the suspension of two faculty members and six resource persons on November 5, the suspension of academic activities until December 11, and the closure of hostels and mess.

According to a November 5 SRFTI Student Union statement, two contractual faculty members have been suspended, and disciplinary actions have been initiated against professors "whose only apparent offence is standing beside their students".

"We will fight until every faculty member and resource person who has been removed is reinstated, until every retaliatory notice is withdrawn...," the statement said.

Speaking to *The Indian Express*, Registrar Deepak Kumar rejected the union's claims. "Contractual faculty members are governed by specific terms and conditions of engagement and applicable institutional rules...," Kumar said.

On the question of the termination of the six resource persons, Kumar said, "Since a section of students initiated and continues to sustain academic disruption, and regular classes remain suspended, there is presently no academic justification for calling resource persons... They will resume their assignments as soon as academic activities and classes recommence."

Tiger kills farmer in Maharashtra

Press Trust of India
Beed, November 7

A 38-YEAR-old farmer was killed by a tiger in Ashti tehsil of Beed district on Saturday morning, an official said.

The incident took place at around 8.30 am, said Range Forest Officer Amol Munde.

Devidas alias Pintu Manik Takale, a resident of Takale Vasti near Deolali, was cutting fodder on Sonipathar Hill near his house when the animal attacked him from behind.

The tiger dragged Takale nearly 500 metres into bushes, the official said. When Takale's son arrived to help carry the fodder back home, he saw the trail of blood.

The boy alerted others. Armed with sticks and axes, a group of villagers went to the thicket when the tiger bolted into the forest. Two days earlier, a full-grown male tiger from the Tipeshwar sanctuary had been spotted in the Ashti forest range.

History at 13,600 feet: Heavy-lift aircraft lands at Nyoma airbase

Amrita Nayak Dutta
New Delhi, November 7



Indian Air Force IL-76MD aircraft lands at Mudh-Nyoma airbase in eastern Ladakh. PTI

SCRIPTING HISTORY in aviation records, an Indian Air Force (IAF) IL-76MD 'Gajraj' has landed at Eastern Ladakh's Mudh-Nyoma airbase at 13,629 feet, marking the highest-altitude landing by the military transport aircraft anywhere in the world and underscoring India's strategic airlift capability.

The successful landing took place on Friday, it is learnt. The airbase, which lies barely 25 km from the Line of Actual Control (LAC), was inaugurated just a year ago.

The development is significant as it demonstrates that the Russian-origin four-engine turbofan heavy-lift strategic airlifter can carry men and military equipment right up to the borders — a key capability in mountain warfare.

It also comes amid tensions along the LAC and at a time when India and China are yet to achieve a full de-escalation of troops in the Ladakh region, despite achieving disengagement at the friction points and resumption of patrolling since October 2024.

The IAF announced the development in a post on X, stating it marked a "remarkable demonstration of the aircraft's enduring capability, backed by the exceptional skill, precision and professionalism of its crew," adding that it is a "milestone that reinforces India's strategic capability".

Military transport aircraft of the IAF have landed at high altitudes in the past. In 2013, a C-130J aircraft successfully landed at the airstrip in Daulat Beg Oldie in eastern Ladakh, which lies at an altitude of 16,614 ft.

What makes the IL-76 landing at Nyoma different and substantial is that it is a heavy strategic transport aircraft, and its ability to operate from Nyoma would demonstrate a different level of airlift capability and logistical reach in eastern Ladakh.

An IL-76 MD can carry 40-45 tonnes, depending on configuration and operating conditions, including heavy platforms such as tanks and BMPs. India acquired 17 of the aircraft between 1985 and 1989, making the Gajraj fleet one of the oldest strategic airlift assets. They have faced serviceability issues due to difficulty in obtaining spares after the collapse of the Soviet Union, which have been aggravated further after the onset of the ongoing Russia-Ukraine war. There were discussions on extending the technical life of a dozen of these aircraft; the IAF is pursuing the Medium Transport Aircraft programme that is intended to replace both the IL-76 and AN-32 fleets.

During the military standoff with China in eastern Ladakh, the aircraft played a critical role in carrying many of the heavier military platforms to eastern Ladakh.

However, the Nyoma runway was not equipped to handle bigger aircraft such as the IL-76. The decision to upgrade the airbase and the runway came after 2020, following the military standoff with China in eastern Ladakh, which also has airbases in Kargil, Thoise and Leh.

Under the Rs 218 crore project, the BRO had constructed a 2.7-km-long runway. The base was operationalised in November last year, after former IAF Chief Air Chief Marshal A P Singh (retd) landed a C-130J there.

The operationalisation of the base represents a major upgrade in India's ability to sustain military deployments in eastern Ladakh, with the IL-76 landing showing that Nyoma's upgraded air infrastructure can now accommodate a much heavier class of transport aircraft than the tactical transports that earlier operated from the older landing ground.

This changes the scale and flexibility of logistical support available to the Army in eastern Ladakh.

Uttarakhand minister husband booked for assaulting her, held

Vidheesha Kuntamalla
Dehradun, November 7



Girdhari Lal Sahu was nabbed from Jhansi. PTI

THE HUSBAND of Uttarakhand Cabinet Minister Rekha Arya has been arrested in Uttar Pradesh's Jhansi, more than three weeks after a case was registered against him on the minister's complaint, alleging assault, fraud, caste-based abuse, and conspiracy to murder, police said.

Girdhari Lal Sahu, 61, was arrested on Friday by a Special Investigation Team (SIT) constituted by the Dehradun Police to investigate the case, Senior Superintendent of Police (SSP) Pramendra Singh Dobal said on Saturday.

Sahu had been absconding since October 15, when an FIR was registered against him at Dehradun's Cantt police station. A non-bailable warrant was subsequently issued against him.

In her complaint, Arya alleged that Sahu concealed his previous marriage and the existence of his children from his first wife when he married her in 2004. She said she learnt about his earlier marriage only after their (Arya and Sahu's) children were born.

The minister, who holds the Women Empowerment and Child Development portfolio, also accused her husband of subjecting her to physical and verbal abuse and using caste-based slurs against her in front of staff members.

Another allegation concerned the alleged use of forged signatures and fabricated documents to remove Arya, without her knowledge or consent, from the directorship of four companies. Following the FIR, Arya posted a video on social media in which she shared an audio recording, purportedly capturing Sahu conspiring to have her killed.

Sahu, subsequently, released a video denying the allegations and asking Arya to withdraw the complaint. He also accused the minister of possessing assets worth Rs 210 crore, disproportionate to her known sources of income, and appealed to Chief Minister Pushkar Singh Dhami to order an investigation.

'I'll eat and sleep early': Last call of Telangana student missing in Boston

Nikhila Henry
Hyderabad, November 7



After she left the apartment on the night of November 2, Sreeja Reddy Koya was reportedly seen walking barefoot by patrolling police officers.

THE LAST conversation Sreeja Reddy Koya had with her mother, Swaroopa Reddy, back home in Telangana was that she would eat shortly, as there was a birthday party at her residence. The next call Swaroopa received was that her 23-year-old daughter, a student at the University of Massachusetts Boston in the US, had gone missing.

Sreeja, a native of Nalgonda district's Kanagal mandal, was last seen around 9.45 p.m. on November 2 near her residence in the Edison Green area of Dorchester, Boston.

Speaking to *The Indian Express*, her mother recalled their last conversation. "When she called me on November 2, she asked if I had eaten. I asked her if she had dinner. I could hear a lot of noise in the background, and she told me that there was a birthday party at her residence," Swaroopa said. When asked whether she would eat at home, Sreeja told her mother, "I will eat and sleep early".

Sreeja's friends told Swaroopa that she did not return after stepping out of her residence for a walk on the night of November 2. "We were surprised that she went for a walk at night. She is usually careful," Swaroopa said.

Boston police issue alert

After she left the apartment, Sreeja was reportedly seen walking barefoot by patrolling police officers.

The Boston Police Department issued a missing person alert on November 4. "The Boston Police Department is actively working to locate Sreeja Koya and urges anyone with information regarding her whereabouts to call 911 or contact District C-11 (Dorchester) Detectives at (617) 343-433," a police statement read.

Sreeja's last known location, as per her mobile phone, was in the vicinity of Carson Beach or Harbor Point, the police said in their statement.

A family waits for answers

Sreeja's father, Yadagiri Reddy Koya, a farmer, said it was his dream to see his daughter do well in studies. "She did her BCom in Hyderabad and moved to the US for her MS in Finance," he told The Indian Express.

Swaroopa said Sreeja was home in August. "She went to the US a year ago. She came home after a year in August and seemed absolutely normal and happy," she recalled. "Had we thought anything was wrong, we wouldn't have sent her back to the US," her mother said, in between tears.

On Thursday, expressing concern over her disappearance, Telangana State Roads and Buildings Minister Komatireddy Venkat Reddy urged the Consulate General of India in Boston, the External Affairs Ministry and the Boston Police Department to help trace her.

• BRIEFLY



Cab driver Indushekar's residence in Bengaluru. ANI

BENGALURU

Mass murder: Two more bodies recovered, taking toll to three

POLICE ON Saturday found bodies of two more victims, who were allegedly killed by Bengaluru cab driver S Indushekar. The bodies of his wife Sunitha and mother-in-law Rupavathi were recovered from the Yercaud forest area of Salem district in Tamil Nadu, taking the total number of bodies recovered in the case to three. Indushekar, 52, is accused of killing his wife and six of her relatives between October 16 and 31 following years of personal dispute. The body of the accused's nephew Puneeth, 7, was recovered earlier near Nandi Hills. City Police Commissioner Seemant Kumar Singh said, "The accused is the only person who knows where he disposed of the bodies. We are taking him to the locations... and recovering the bodies." ENS

Tiger found dead, electrocution suspected

THE CARCASS of an adult tiger was found in a forest in Madhya Pradesh's Balaghat district on Saturday, with preliminary findings suggesting that it may have died of electrocution, a forest official said. "During routine patrolling today, a beat guard spotted the tiger's carcass. Senior officials and a dog squad reached the spot after being informed...," Divisional Forest Officer Resham Singh Dhurve said. He added the circumstances suggested electrocution as the cause of death. Two locals have been detained and are being questioned. PTI

Family of 3 die of electrocution in Chhattisgarh

A FAMILY of three died after coming in contact with an electrified iron railing at their residence in Baloda bazar of Chhattisgarh, police said on Saturday. The incident took place on Friday morning near Nehru Chowk. The dead are Rakesh Gupta, his son Om (24) and wife Varsha, an official said. "Rakesh Gupta came in contact with the iron railing and reportedly got stuck to it. Om rushed to rescue him. Both died on the spot," the official said. Varsha, who suffered severe burns while trying to them, succumbed at the hospital, the official said. PTI

Shinde Sena leader Dhangekar opposes Gokul dairy power play

Manoj More
Pune, November 7

AMID A row over the Maharashtra government nominating directors to the board of the Kolhapur District Cooperative Milk Producers Dairy (Gokul), Shiv Sena leader Ravindra Dhangekar has urged the Mahayuti government not to try to "forcibly capture power", saying the mandate of farmers must be respected.

"There should be no attempt to forcibly capture power at Gokul. No cheating should take place. We should live up to democratic norms," Dhangekar told *The Indian Express*.

Dhangekar's remarks expose potential differences in the Mahayuti alliance over the government's handling of one of Maharashtra's most influential cooperative institutions.

In the Gokul milk cooperative elections held last month, an alliance led by Congress leader Satej Patil defeated the Mahayuti alliance, winning 13 seats to the ruling alliance's 12. This week, the state Cabinet approved a proposal, giving the government the power to appoint five directors to its board, four of them with voting rights.

Dhangekar said the verdict of Gokul's farmer-members should be honoured. "Those who have secured a majority should be allowed to claim power. All laws and regulations should be followed. Attempts should not be made to gain backdoor entry," he said.

• THE GANDHIS REMAIN CONTESTED FIGURES IN THE STATE: SYMBOLS OF HURT FOR SOME, NEGOTIATORS OF PEACE FOR OTHERS, AND LEADERS OF A PARTY THAT HAS REPEATEDLY FOUND ITS WAY BACK INTO PUNJAB

Why Punjab keeps returning to Congress despite the burden of 1984



NORTHERN LIGHTS

BY MANRAJ GREWAL SHARMA

A WEEKLY DISPATCH ON THE POLITICS AND IDEAS SHAPING NORTH INDIA

A BEARDED Rahul Gandhi at the Golden Temple, saffron turban in place, during his Bharat Jodo Yatra in January 2023. The Congress likes to flag this image every now and then. It suggests all is well. Operation Blue Star, so closely identified with the Gandhis, is not a burden borne by him. They are not far from the truth. Gandhi distanced himself from the legacy when he visited the shrine in his private capacity. He did *sewa* and soaked in the Gurbani wafting from the precincts. But these days, it is the anti-Sikh pogrom that the BJP is trying hard to pin on him.

Once again, the state is seeing the resurgence of his father Rajiv Gandhi's infamous statement: "When a big tree falls, the earth shakes." Thousands of Sikhs were killed in the days after Prime Minister Indira Gandhi's assassination on October 31, 1984.

The Congress neatly sidestepped this googly. It focused on its Insaaf rally, where speakers ridiculed the AAP government for waging a war on drugs with a "drunken" CM at the helm. They also claimed Union Home Minister Amit Shah would not be around to fulfil his 2029 promise.

The roots of mistrust

The Shiromani Akali Dal, the oldest regional party in the country, had a largely mistrustful relationship with Indira Gandhi. It stemmed from the Akali demand for more federal powers, which she viewed through a communal lens.

No surprise, then, that the party opposed the Emergency tooth and nail. It sent over 40,000 workers to jail in the 19-month "Save Democracy" morcha, from July 1975 until the Emergency was revoked in early 1977. Many saw in that the seeds of Indira's determination to show the Akalis their place.

Her son inherited both the mistrust and the possibility of repair. The July 1985 peace accord between Prime Minister Rajiv and Akali leader Sant Harchand Singh Longowal failed to deliver many of its promises, but it showed the two sides could imagine a political settlement. A lot of water has flowed under the bridge since.

Why Cong survived

It would be easy for the rest of the Opposition to pin all the blame for 1984, and the unresolved issues, on the Punjab Congress. Yet, the party has not only shrugged off the blame. It has won not once or twice but thrice since the early 1990s.

Its 1992 victory, held in the shadow of militancy and an Akali boycott, cannot be read as democratic endorsement. But the Congress did not win in 2002 and 2017 because Punjabis forgot 1984. It returned because Punjab needed a party that could restore normalcy, access the Centre, and manage a fractured state. Traditionally, the Akalis were considered well entrenched in the villages. The Congress retained its cadre in villages and towns alike. The Punjab unit was never merely an extension of the Gandhi family. It produced its own leaders, with their own caste, rural, and urban networks.



Congress leader Rahul Gandhi at the Golden Temple during his Bharat Jodo Yatra in January 2023. EXPRESS

No wonder Gandhi got a resounding roar at the Insaaf rally in Sangrur when he pointed out that unlike the AAP and the BJP governments run from the Centre, Congress governments are not. That was especially so after Indira, who was notorious for keeping leaders in check by appointing a state party president often at loggerheads with the CM.

Memory, but not a single memory

Punjabis love to flaunt one belief: they never forget or forgive. Long ago, a brother of Beant Singh, one of Indira Gandhi's assassins, told *The Indian Express* that he had not been confided in about the plan. But the assassination, he said, was a foregone conclusion. Many others echoed him.

Udham Singh's killing of Michael O'Dwyer in London in 1940 is seen through the same lens. Yet Punjab's politics cannot be reduced to that moral universe alone. How else does one explain the love that overflowed when then CM Captain Amarinder Singh opened the border for Pakistanis to watch the Indo-Pak Punjab Games in 2004? Punjabis in Chandigarh lined up to host the visitors in their homes.

The blood-soaked Partition, you would expect, would have made them abhor people across the border. Instead, nostalgia triumphed over hatred.

Punjab remembers. Its political memory reopens whenever power, identity, and grievance come into play.

The BJP's attempt

One of the strongest arguments for a possible BJP rule in Punjab goes like this: if Sikhs could re-elect the Congress after 1984, how could memories of a farm agitation stop the BJP? The argument assumes that memory fades on schedule and works the same way for everyone.

But emotions are a strange animal. They were on display in the 2024 parliamentary elections. At a mandi near Faridkot, a group of villagers, some the worse for drink, said they would vote for Sarabjit Singh Khalsa, elder son of Indira's assassin Beant Singh. "The community owes him a debt," said an elderly man as others nodded. This was despite Sarabjit having lost five elections in the intervening years. But as Panthic identity gained prominence in 2024, the relatively obscure Independent scored a surprise win. He defeated high-profile candidates such as actor Karamjit Anmol of the AAP and singer Hans Raj Hans of the BJP.

Such moments explain why Punjab's politics cannot be reduced to plain arithmetic. They also show how long-buried emotions can flare up after decades of dormancy.

Emotions ran high again at the Mansa morcha a day before the Congress rally this week. Bhim Singh, the father of late activist Parvinder Singh Jhota, said he would be grateful if relatives of Indira Gandhi and former CM Beant Singh stayed away from their agitation. Bhim Singh had welcomed Amit Shah to his house last fortnight. His caution captures the enduring complexity of the Gandhi-Punjab relationship. The Gandhis remain both present and contested in the state: symbols of hurt for some, negotiators of peace for others, and leaders of a party that has found its way back into Punjab.

(MANRAJ GREWAL SHARMA IS NATIONAL EDITOR, NORTH, THE INDIAN EXPRESS)

Centre defends E20 programme as Congress steps up attack

Press Trust of India
New Delhi, November 7

THE UNION government on Saturday defended the 20% ethanol-blended petrol programme, saying tests of 893 samples collected across 27 states and Union Territories found them compliant with prescribed quality standards.

The 983 samples, covering all three oil marketing companies (OMCs), recorded ethanol content within the prescribed 19-21% range, the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas said in a statement.

The samples also included 56 tested in Karnataka.

The development comes a day after Congress-ruled Karnataka government alleged that major OMCs — Indian Oil Corporation Limited (IOCL), Bharat Petroleum Corporation Limited (BPCL) and Hindustan Petroleum Corporation Limited (HPCL) — were supplying petrol with ethanol content exceeding the prescribed 20% limit.

Some of the tests recorded levels as high as 31.2 per cent, Karnataka Legal Metrology Minister Rizwan Arshad said in a press conference on Friday. The state government had sought action against the companies.

Meanwhile, Congress leader Rahul Gandhi, too, stepped up the attack on the Modi government over the roll-out of E20 petrol, citing test results of samples from Karnataka's October 2026 exercise.

In a post on X Saturday, he said, "E20 turned into 420 – stealing petrol from the public's cars!" The reference was to Section 420 of the erstwhile Indian Penal Code, which dealt with cheating.

"The Karnataka government collected petrol samples from 7 districts and had them tested at an accredited lab. Look at the results – 11 out of 14 samples contained more than 20% ethanol; 31.2% at IOCL, 30.5% at HPCL..."

"IOCL, HPCL, BPCL, Nayara, Shell — whether government-owned or private — all exceeded the limit," Rahul claimed. He also alleged that the companies' own laboratories had not reported the ethanol content.

Rahul claimed that excessive ethanol blending could affect vehicle performance, resulting in lower mileage and higher maintenance costs. He also questioned the absence of labels at fuel stations disclosing the ethanol content.

"Modi ji, tell us — what's being put in the country's tank? How much ethanol is actually in the petrol? When will action be taken against companies mixing in more than 20%?" he said.

The Karnataka government had collected samples from Bengaluru, Kolar, Chikkaballapura, Bengaluru Rural, Ramanagara, Mangaluru and Tumakuru, Arshad said during his press conference.

On Saturday, the minister said he will share "a detailed response with the entire nation" soon.

Meanwhile, the OMCs have issued a joint statement challenging the Karnataka government's claims of excessive ethanol content in fuel sold at some of the companies' retail outlets. They questioned the sampling and testing procedures, arguing that the reported results cannot be independently validated without compliance with prescribed statutory procedures and disclosure of the technical details of the tests.

Maoist carrying Rs 10 lakh bounty held from Thane

Manish Kumar Pathak
Mumbai, November 7

A SENIOR Maoist carrying a bounty of Rs 10 lakh on his head allegedly left the forests of Jharkhand and allegedly took up odd jobs in Thane, including working as a caretaker of five to six cows at a bungalow in Dombivli.

The Maharashtra Anti-Terrorism Squad (ATS) arrested the 45-year-old from Thakurli near Dombivli.

The accused has been identified as Sanjay Saroju Yadav, also known as Sanjay Godray and Budharam.

He is wanted in seven cases in Jharkhand, including murder, extortion and an exchange of fire with police personnel.

During interrogation, the ATS learnt that Yadav had fled from the forests in the Chhatarpur area of Jharkhand more than a month ago.

After reaching Thane with the help of his Maoist friend, he initially came in contact with a real estate contractor, who employed him for loading and unloading work.

Later, he got in touch with another person who is in the real estate business, who lives in a bungalow in the Thakurli area of Dombivli. Around a week ago, Yadav approached the businessman seeking employment.

The latter hired him to look after his five to six cows, which he would take out for grazing. The businessman was unaware of Yadav's background, a police officer said.

Yadav is a resident of Devgaon village in Jharkhand's Palamu district. He is allegedly a Zonal Committee Member of a banned Maoist organisation and joined the outfit in 2014, the officer added.

During questioning, Yadav reportedly told the police that a land dispute had prompted him to join the Maoist organisation in 2014. He is married and has three children — a 23-year-old married daughter and two sons aged 22 and 20. His father is a farmer.

Yadav allegedly had not returned home since joining the organisation in 2014 and was involved in several criminal cases, including murder, attempt to murder and exchanges of fire with police personnel, the officer said.

The ATS received specific intelligence that Yadav, against whom the Jharkhand Police had announced a reward of Rs 10 lakh, was hiding in Thakurli. Acting on the information, the Thane unit of the Maharashtra ATS verified the inputs and apprehended him.

He was brought to the ATS unit in Thane and handed over to the Jharkhand Police, which took his custody on transit remand for further investigation and legal proceedings, the officer said.

Meanwhile, investigating agencies are examining his digital devices and other evidence to ascertain his activities and the purpose of his stay in Maharashtra over the past month.

RABINDRA BHARATI UNIVERSITY
56A B. T. Road, Kolkata-700050

Ref No. RB/REG/256/2026 Dated: 06/11/2026

Press Release for Cancellation of Recruitment Notification for Non-Teaching Posts

This is for information of all concerned that the Employment Notification No. Estt./7129/2020 dated 12/02/2020, advertised for recruitment of various Non-teaching Posts is hereby cancelled and withdrawn wholly due to administrative reasons by the Executive Council of the University in its meeting held on 06/10/2026 in terms of Clause No. 10(ii) under the "General Instructions to the Applicants" in the said Recruitment Notification.
Modalities for refund of application fee will be notified on the University Website: **www.rbu.ac.in** in due course. Please visit University Website from time to time.

By **Order of the Executive Council,**
Registrar (Acting)

स्वच्छ भारत
एक कदम स्वच्छता की ओर

नगर निगम अलीगढ़

एकमुश्त समाधान योजना (OTS)

बकाया संपत्ति कर के निस्तारण का सुनहरा अवसर

नगर निगम अलीगढ़ द्वारा 15 अगस्त 2026 से 15 नवम्बर 2026 तक
एकमुश्त समाधान योजना (OTS) लागू की जा रही है।

सत्यम सेवा धर्म स्वागतं
ALIGARH NAGAR NIGAM

मात्र 7 दिन शेष

ऑनलाइन आवेदन करने के लिए QR कोड स्कैन करें।

योजना के प्रमुख लाभ

- सम्पूर्ण बकाया कर जमा करने पर समस्त ब्याज में छूट
- ऑनलाइन एवं ऑफलाइन आवेदन की सुविधा
- बकाया कर जमा करने हेतु अधिकतम तीन किश्त का विकल्प

योजना अवधि
15 अगस्त 2026 से
15 नवम्बर 2026 तक

समय पर आवेदन करें एवं योजना का अधिकतम लाभ प्राप्त करें। आपका सहयोग, नगर का विकास

आवेदन ऑनलाइन तथा ऑफलाइन, दोनों माध्यमों से किया जा सकेगा।
ऑनलाइन
ऑफलाइन
समस्त बकाया राशि जमा करने पर ब्याज में छूट

आवेदन को संपत्ति कर की समस्त बकाया धनराशि के भुगतान हेतु अधिकतम तीन किश्तों की सुविधा प्रदान की जाएगी।
पहली किश्त 1/3 → दूसरी किश्त 1/3 → तीसरी किश्त 1/3 → अधिकतम 3 किश्त

प्रेम प्रकाश मीणा I.A.S.
नगर आयुक्त

समस्त मा0पार्षद/अधिकारी/कर्मचारीगण

प्रशान्त सिंघल
महापौर, अलीगढ़

Ro.No.6553/मी0व जनसम्पर्क/NNA/26–27/दिनांक : 07.11.2026

CHIEF ELECTORAL OFFICER, HARYANA

ONE MORE CHANCE
HARYANA SIR 2026

Your name missing from the Draft Electoral Roll?

If you were marked Absent, Shifted, Dead or Duplicate (ASDD), you can still get your name included in the Final Electoral Roll.

1 Check the list

ASDD lists shall be displayed afresh at Polling Stations, Panchayat Bhawans, ULB & BDO offices and on the CEO Haryana website.

2 Get your form

Your BLO will deliver your enumeration form either physically or by WhatsApp / SMS / e-mail. Or you can download and fill it on the website or the ECINET App by entering the same EPIC number that existed before your name was deleted.

3 Submit to your ERO / AERO / BLO

AT SAME ADDRESS
Enumeration Form + Annexure-B
Mention reason why you couldn't submit enumeration form earlier. Submit yourself, through family, or online on ECINET with e-sign.

SHIFTED WITHIN HARYANA
Enumeration Form + Annexure-C
Submit to the ERO / AERO of the Assembly Constituency where you have shifted. No Form-8 needed.

ALREADY SUBMITTED FORM-6
No need to apply again
Your Form-6 submitted during SIR will be processed.

✓ **Same EPIC number** that was assigned to you prior to SIR shall be re-assigned once your enumeration form is accepted.

⌂ **Homeless**? The BLO's field verification will be accepted as residence proof.

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Organiser: India Trade Promotion Organisation

45TH INDIA INTERNATIONAL TRADE FAIR
13 – 27 November 2026
Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi

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Highlights

DATE & TIME	ARTISTE	PERFORMANCE	VENUE	ENTRY
13.11.2026 6:00 PM	Padma Shri Guru Madhavi Mudgal	Odissi Recital	Auditorium 2	Free entry; prior registration required
14.11.2026 6:00 PM	Ayana Mukherjee & Group	Kuchipudi Recital	Auditorium 1	Free entry; first come, first seated
15.11.2026 3:00 PM	Abhishek Raghuram (vocal), Kamala Kiran Vinjamuri (violin), Dr. S. Karthick (ghatam)	Carnatic Recital	Auditorium 1	Free entry; first come, first seated
17.11.2026 3:00 PM	Dr. Seema Kumari	Kathak Recital	Musical Fountain	Free entry; first come, first seated
17.11.2026 3:00 PM	NK Art & Artist Performing Art Foundation	Kalaripayattu Demonstration	Amphitheatre1	Free entry; first come, first seated
18.11.2026 6:00 PM	The Manganiyar Seduction	Rajasthani folk music	Musical Fountain	Ticketed; BookMyShow
19.11.2026 6:00 PM	Tal Fry	Percussion ensemble	Musical Fountain	Ticketed; BookMyShow
20.11.2026 6:00 PM	Eshani Aggrawal & Group	Kathak Recital	Auditorium 2	Free entry; first come, first seated
20.11.2026 3:00 PM	Kaka King	Live Performance, Rapper	Musical Fountain	Free entry; first come, first seated
21.11.2026 6:00 PM	Mohabbat Ki Pathshala Rudraksha Live Entertainment	Shayari & poetry in Hindi and Urdu	Open Amphitheatre	Ticketed; BookMyShow
21.11.2026 6:00 PM	Nizami Bandhu	Qawwali	Musical Fountain	Ticketed; BookMyShow
22.11.2026 6:00 PM	Hariharan & Prithvi Gandharva	Classical Music Recital	Auditorium 2	Ticketed; BookMyShow
22.11.2026 6:00 PM	Ruhaniyat- Ayo Adunni (Nigerian), Asha Kesar, Avadhoot Gandhi, Parvathy Baul, Mir Mukhtiyar Ali Sahil & Faisal Husain	Sufi, Ghazal Mystic Recital	Open Amphitheatre	Ticketed; BookMyShow
24.11.2026 4:00 PM	Shahzad Ali	Live Sufi Concert (Rajasthan Ratna awardee)	Plenary Hall	Ticketed; BookMyShow
25.11.2026 6:00 PM	Salim–Sulaiman	Live Music Concert	Plenary Hall	Ticketed; BookMyShow
25.11.2026 6:00 PM	Sarod Mystics Band	Indian instrumental & Indo-Western fusion	Musical Fountain	Free entry; first come, first seated
27.11.2026 6:00 PM	Rajmal Malviya	Kabir Lok Gayak	Musical Fountain	Free entry; first come, first seated

• Ticketed - available on BookMyShow • Free Entry - first come, first seated

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Google Play App Store

*For ticketed performances and booking details, visit Bharat Mahotsav on IITF website & App.

‘If people start practising asset allocation, they will view volatility as opportunity’

Before its recent surge, the Sensex had traded around the 73,000 mark for around three years. Sankaran Naren, Executive Director and Chief Investment Officer at ICICI Prudential AMC, spoke to Sandeep Singh, National Bureau Chief at *The Indian Express*, on October 27, about what was holding the markets back and how people should plan their investments. Edited excerpts:

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Sankaran Naren (left) at the Explained.Live session with Sandeep Singh.

What was holding the markets back?

Three years back, the markets were overvalued. That could be part of the explanation. But there are multiple reasons.

First, is the geopolitical problem — war in Ukraine and the Gulf, and record high crude oil prices. Second, artificial intelligence-related growth has been very high in some countries: US, South Korea, Taiwan, Japan, etc. The growth rate there has been much higher than the growth rate that India can ever give. People have moved to these markets, particularly in the last two years.

And the third reason is that after March 2023, once the money started coming into equity mutual funds, three sets of investors started to sell. One is Indian promoters who have been launching IPO after IPO because they know that the markets are overvalued. The second is private equity companies which had invested pre-2023, which had realised that you can sell these stocks to Indian investors at a good price. And the third was multinationals who had set up businesses in India over the last 20, 30, 40 years. They realised that they should list in India because here you get valuations much higher than in your home country. Despite the huge amount of money that we collected, all that money primarily went into these three sets of people’s pockets. And that is why markets have not delivered returns.

Weakening rupee, volatile oil prices, rising interest rates, slowing growth: What is your biggest worry?

I am worried about the impact of AI on India, whether it will be negative or positive. It is the most important long-term view because at some point of time the war will end and when the war ends, oil will come down. At some point of time, people will not have IPOs. But AI can be a structural trend. And no one knows what the long-term impact of AI will be. People believe that fund managers can correctly guess the long-term impact, but we also don’t know.

There is a talk of India becoming a $20-trillion economy say two decades from now. Are the grounds ready for that?

In the services sector, there are no other countries which are competing with us. In manufacturing, there are multiple countries that are competing, including Vietnam and Thailand. To win in manufacturing is not as easy as winning in services. Is India working to become better every year over the previous year? Yes. But the competition is intense.

I think we need to create manufacturing employment on a very large scale. And that is the solution for growth to increase. And I'm sure that the government is well aware of this issue and will focus on it. But it is not as easy to create a global manufacturing hub in every area as it has been to create a global services hub.

Assuming that the US-Iran war ends, which sectors should investors look at to maximise their returns?

I think banking clearly will benefit a lot because the sector has been hurt by inflation and the rupee has been depreciating. Oil marketing companies should certainly benefit because they are the people who are bearing the brunt of the higher oil prices. If you look at areas like aviation for example, they are going to be benefited. But overall, we have started rate hikes and they may continue if oil is like this. But if the war ends and oil crashes, the requirement for the Reserve Bank of India to keep hiking interest rates also goes down. But we require a good fall in oil. A good fall in oil actually lubricates all parts of the economy, not just a few areas.

These are external factors. On the domestic front, what gives you comfort and what is challenging?

The current account deficit is under control, fiscal deficit is under control. Credit growth is booming. The automotive industry has been booming over the last year. Power demand has been booming.

Some of the challenges include a subpar monsoon. And there is always the worry that El Niño will create more problems.

There are things that any country can do... the RBI realised that it is important to get insurance deposits. So, they floated an FCNR scheme and collected $127 billion of deposits. That takes care of all near-term foreign exchange issues. Having said that, the problem of the war, and the problem of what AI leads to in the future, will remain.

Amid these challenges, does asset allocation become much more important, given we don't know how things are going to shape, and how long the challenges will continue given the nature of them being external rather than internal?

Indians have got this love for equity at this point of time. And equity is inherently not a riskless asset class. That’s why if people start practising asset allocation, they will view volatility as an opportunity and not worry so much. But, if you are only invested in equity or you take positions in derivative markets on leverage, then you are very worried about everything that is happening.

Many investors have 15-20 schemes in their portfolio. Can you simplify and tell us three classes of schemes that investors must possess at all times?

I am of the view that if you create three categories — balanced advantage, balanced hybrid, and flexi cap — you would have covered substantially. Then you don't need to worry day-to-day about what’s happening in the market. You just keep investing in these categories and keep saving and keeping put money in these three categories because our broad approach is very clear.

Can you take our readers through these categories briefly?

Balanced advantage is a very simple model: As the market goes up, you keep selling, and as the market goes down, you keep buying. So in 2023-24 when the market was more overvalued, it had less exposure to equity and higher exposure to debt and arbitrage. Today, because equity has become more fairly valued, it has a higher exposure to equity and a lower exposure to arbitrage and debt. If you look at balanced hybrids, it’s even more simple. It says you can invest between 40% and 60% in debt, and 40% and 60% in equity. It is the quintessential asset allocation product where you're choosing two products, and both the products have to be between 40% and 60%.

The third category is called “flexi” cap because you can invest in all kinds of things. You can invest in large cap, mid cap, small cap, micro cap and, therefore, you are entirely investing in the entire equity market. So we call it the most unconstrained fund.

For people who need gold, I would say multi-asset is the fourth category.

AUDIENCE QUESTIONS

Countries which have AI on their side, like the US, their markets are doing much better. Would you suggest that we try to invest in foreign markets?

Any market which is exuberant and where valuations are high is actually a riskier market. So, at this point of time we tell people to be careful if you are investing in the Nasdaq index because it is the best performing index in the world in the last 10 years.

I am currently investing in mutual funds. My SIP is around Rs 25,000 a month. Should I stop it because for the past two years, whatever I have invested giving negative returns?

We tell people to start a SIP in flexi cap category or balanced advantage category or multi-asset category. Forget closing, we tell people to add now. That is our view.

Actually, that is what we have been trying to promote at this point of time. So, I think you know, for the best benefit of SIP, you actually have to invest when the markets are down.

SCAN THE QR CODE TO WATCH THE VIDEO

HC: Infringement of rights becoming routine for UP Police... shameful

Bhupendra Pandey
Lucknow, November 7

OBSERVING THAT Uttar Pradesh Police “appear to have little regard for the fundamental rights and civil liberties of citizens” and that the existing situation was “shameful”, the Allahabad HC came down heavily on the police for giving “excuses” when asked to produce CCTV footage from a police station.

Hearing a habeas corpus plea alleging illegal detention of a man in police custody in Bijnor district, a bench of Justices Atul Sreedharan and Achal Sachdev in its November 3 order observed, “The situation that exists in the State of Uttar Pradesh relating to the civil liberty is shameful, to say the least. The police appear to have little regard for the fundamental rights and civil liberties of citizens, and the infringement of these rights seems to have become a matter of routine for the UP Police.”

The petition was filed by a rape survivor alleging that her father was illegally detained by the Bijnor police for two days and that his arrest was shown on the third day in a case of extortion.

She alleged that her father was called to the Naagal police station on September 5 but when he arrived there he was dragged out of the car and bundled in a vehicle by police personnel in plainclothes before being taken away.

When a relative accompanying the petitioner’s father tried to record the incident on his phone, he was stopped by the policemen, she claimed.

The relative then informed the police helpline about the incident, but no action was taken, she said. The man's arrest was shown by the police station two days later — on September 7, it was alleged.

After hearing the petitioner's submission, the bench ordered that the footage of CCTV cameras from the police station from September 5 afternoon to September 7 morning be produced.

During the November 3 hearing, the government counsel informed the court that the CCTV footage of the time as required by the court was not available, claiming that the CCTV system malfunctioned due to a thunderstorm on September 5 as water trickled down the LAN cable.

The court observed, “In case after case whenever CCTV footages are called for by this Court, in large majority of the cases, it is the same report which comes stating that CCTV footage is not available on account of one reason or other. The excuse of a CCTV malfunctioning is not available to the police in a case of unlawful detention.

“Any averment is sufficient for this court to hold that the corpus was unlawfully detained and that CCTV footage is deliberately not being provided in order to obfuscate the truth maliciously...”

“As the petitioner’s apprehension leading to her father's formal arrest is based on unlawful detention, he shall be set at liberty forthwith, if not wanted in any other case.

“The petitioners have prayed for cost of the petition which is fixed at Rs 20,000 which shall be paid by the State to the petitioners within seven days from today, failing which the petitioners shall be at liberty to revive this petition for the purpose of compliance,” the bench said.

The court said that the police station in-charge deliberately did not provide the CCTV footage. “This court records its displeasure which shall be entered into the service records of the in-charge and the state government should consider the further continuation on the present post.”



Spreading light

Border Security Force personnel on the eve of Diwali near the India-Bangladesh border in West Bengal’s Dakshin Dinajpur district, Saturday. PTI

Smear campaign, schools harassed: Wangchuk targets Ladakh admin

Naveed Iqbal
Srinagar, November 7

ACTIVIST SONAM Wangchuk on Saturday alleged a smear campaign against him by the Ladakh L-G’s office. He appealed to President Droupadi Murmu to take note of the alleged actions by the “L-G and his team” against him through social media.

In a video posted on X, terming it a “sting operation” by his lawyers, Wangchuk said, “For raising my voice for the youth of the nation and the well being of border areas like Ladakh and Arunachal, I’m being continuously witch-hunted and defamed, and our schools being harassed in every possible way by the L-G Administration in Ladakh.”

Wangchuk and his group of institutions under the Himalayan Institute of Alternatives, Ladakh, (HIAL) have been involved in an ongoing legal dispute with the Union Territory administration over the transfer of a lease deed.

The Ladakh administration had cancelled the lease, citing failure to execute the deed and pay the required premium within the stipulated period, as well as alleged non-compliance with the land’s intended use.

The administration has also directed HIAL to refrain from undertaking further activities related to the functioning of its Desert Flower School.

Wangchuk and his wife Gitanjali J Angmo, HIAL’s co-founder and CEO, have attributed the delay in finalising the land deal to bureaucratic hurdles. They have alleged that the cancellation was part of a politically motivated witch-hunt linked to the campaign for Sixth Schedule safeguards and statehood for Ladakh.

Separately, the labour court in Leh on Saturday reserved its order in a case involving allegations of non-payment of statutory maternity benefits and unfair treatment of a former HIAL employee.

Wangchuk said that through their “probe”, “Much more has come to us from the Raj Niwas/Lok Niwas but we're releasing just some excerpts for now. I tried very much to avoid this, thinking it may damage the nation’s dignity and morale, and hence I first shared the material with the Chief of IB for intervention, but unfortunately, after a few exchanges, he too stopped responding.”

He said, “So, with a heavy heart I am sharing this with the nation as we must stop the L-G from playing like an infant in the ecologically & strategically sensitive border regions of India.”

There was no immediate reaction from the L-G’s office to the allegations. WITH PTI

[FROM PAGE 1]

Interns

on humanitarian grounds but as per institutional norms or rules. Exchange of money is absolutely unacceptable and totally illegal and against norms.”

Pramanick called for strict action against the people involved in such exchanges. “Patient safety must never be compromised at the cost of money.”

Dr Soumyadip Roy, earlier a prominent face of the West Bengal Junior Doctors’ Front, said: “Over the last four to five years, this trend has emerged. The potential impact where clinical doctor shifts are being swapped with dental interns or paramedical staff raises serious concerns.”

The principal of a medical college and hospital said: “Interns sometimes ask friends or colleagues doing similar courses to swap duties, usually if they need help. But no money can be involved in this.”

The Health Department also aims to check the practice of proxy duties to ensure that interns complete their clinical training in person. “Our government intends to eradicate all malpractices from the system that started in the previous government,” Mukhopadhyay said.

An intern, 23, at a medical college and hospital in Kolkata said it was unfair to paint all of them with the same brush. “A few people might be doing paid swaps, but most of us are working tirelessly according to standard protocols. Let an impartial probe take place and whoever is at fault be held accountable.”

The intern added: “The government’s focus should not end at scrutinising us. They need to address the unbearable work pressure and the appalling basic conditions we face daily, from unsanitary washrooms to lack of proper rest areas.”

However, an intern at R G Kar Medical College and Hospital said the swapping of duties is an open secret. “Interns often clock 70 to 90 hours a week. During the three-month Community Medicine posting, this can easily cross 250 hours, while critical ward postings can sometimes mean even higher hours. It is a fact that interns hire proxies for money. If someone isn't interested in a specialty like gynaecology, they might skip the entire rotation and pay a proxy to fill in, paying them up to Rs 30,000 from their stipend of Rs 45,000 monthly. Most interns, however, do this to carve out time to prepare for MD and MS entrance exams,” she said.

Lawrence

Rohit Shetty in February this year.

According to a press note issued by the ATS, Rajasthan, on Saturday, the process to bring Boxer to India is under way. “He had entered the US from Mexico through a dunki route after fleeing Guyana, where the AGTF had tracked him down,” it said.

“The final breakthrough came via the ATS’s foreign network. It had already learned that Boxer had entered the US illegally and was living in California where he reached using a ‘dunki route’ from Mexico. On that information, Interpol notices were sent and the ICE detained him,” it added.

After Lawrence fell out with aides Goldy Brar and Rohit Godara, Boxer was allegedly asked to oversee the gang’s operations in India, police said.

“Currently, he is handling all the operations in India. His growing prominence became visible once again this year in connection with two shootings in Delhi and Haryana. Two audio clips of Boxer — one linked to a shooting at singer Guru Randhawa’s gym in West Delhi’s Paschim Vihar and the other to the murder of gym trainer Kapil Redhu outside his gym in Hansi, Haryana, located nearly 130 km apart — were found during the investigation recently,” an official said.

According to police, Boxer claimed responsibility for both attacks.

Boxer comes from a farming family in Chatarpura village in Kotputli-Behror district of Rajasthan. He graduated from a college in Bansur town and prepared for recruitment exams for the police, the Army and the Staff Selection Commission.

“He also pursued boxing and worked as a coach in Jaipur for some time. After he became involved in criminal activities, his parents disowned him,” a police officer said. He was involved in criminal activities across Rajasthan, Haryana, Punjab, Delhi, MP and Maharashtra, Rajasthan Police said.

According to investigators, Boxer had been absconding since 2022. His departure from India was recorded on April 25, 2023, at Delhi airport. He has been accused in cases involving the assault on a retired IAS officer and a police officer in Rajasthan. His name has also surfaced in connection with a firing incident outside a club in Jaipur.

Boxer first drew international attention in August last year, a day after shots were fired at comedian Kapil Sharma’s café in Canada. An audio clip attributed to Boxer surfaced soon after, in which he allegedly issued threats to Bollywood, warning producers, directors and actors against working with Salman Khan. In the same message, he claimed affiliation with the Lawrence gang.

Earlier this year, three voice notes, purportedly from Boxer, were received by actor Singh’s manager and media handler, Subramanian. In one of the notes, he was purportedly heard demanding Rs 20 crore as extortion. The voice notes were sent a week after shots were fired outside Shetty’s home.

“He is an active member of the extortion racket run by the Lawrence gang and was its key weapon supplier. He would collect extortion money using WhatsApp, Signal and VoIP platforms over VPN, issuing threats to traders in Jaipur. If a trader refused to pay, gang members would open fire at the person or his family,” the press note said.

Multiple attempts were made to trace Boxer. “Pressure for his deportation was built through the CBI’s Interpol desk. In November 2024, the Interpol issued a Red Corner Notice against him. His location was traced to Guyana, and in February 2025 a provisional arrest request was sent, but Boxer fled Guyana, transiting through Mexico, and reached the US,” it said. Rajasthan AGTF continued to pursue him. After obtaining his exact location in California in December 2024 and July 2026, nine more Interpol notices were sent to the US.



Defence Minister Rajnath Singh offers sweets to IAF personnel during his visit to the Bagdogra Air Force Station in West Bengal on Saturday. PTI

Rajnath: Warfare has become more complex, no longer limited to cross-border firing

Press Trust of India
Bagdogra, November 7

DEFENCE MINISTER Rajnath Singh on Saturday said the security landscape had become increasingly complex, with warfare extending beyond conventional cross-border firing to include cyberattacks, drone swarms, proxy wars and information operations.

Singh also reviewed the operational preparedness of Trishakti Corps at Sukna near here in Darjeeling district. He was briefed on infrastructure development along the Line of Actual Control (LAC) and deployment of advanced military equipment and emerging technologies to enhance operational capabilities and combat effectiveness, according to an official release.

Addressing Indian Air Force (IAF) personnel at Bagdogra airfield on the eve of Diwali, Singh said adversaries were increasingly seeking to exploit vulnerabilities without engaging in direct conflict. "Warfare is no longer limited merely to cross-border firing. It has expanded greatly to encompass asymmetric warfare, proxy wars, cyberattacks, drone swarms, information operations, and narrative management," he said.

Through social media, the enemy also attempts to sow seeds of doubt among local populations and soldiers by spreading misleading information, Singh said.

Emphasising the changing responsibilities of armed forces, he said soldiers must remain vigilant not only in their operational domains but also against emerging cyber and information threats. "In such a scenario... You are required to simultaneously maintain domain awareness, cyber resilience, and information integrity," he said.

Underlining the importance of logistics in national security, he described Sukna and its surrounding region as a critical hub for the movement of supplies, weaponry, food, medical provisions and personnel to forward locations. He stated that Sukna serves as a vital link in the security architecture of Eastern India and its geographical sensitivity necessitates round-the-clock operational readiness.

He also advised the personnel to strengthen their ties with civilians. "The more you engage with local civilians, the weaker the adversaries' conspiracies will become," the minister said.

Singh said his visit to the Bagdogra airbase was made with the intent to share his Diwali greetings with the air force personnel and expressed his gratitude to the families of the jawans who remained separated from their loved ones during the festivities.

"I am aware that you must be missing your families during this festive season... I salute your austerity and believe that words will fall short in describing your sacrifice," Singh said.

Singh underscored the strategic importance and sensitivity of the Bagdogra air base, calling it an integral component of India's defence network in overseeing security of the north-eastern region.

"Your deployment at this station means you are actively engaged in maintaining a firm shield to secure the country's eastern frontier. Hence, it is imperative that you keep your combat readiness at the highest level," the defence minister said.

Highlighting the motto of 'Aatmanirbhar Bharat', Singh said that India's start-ups and indigenous industries are now making drones, developing anti-drone tech and manufacturing improved products for soldiers.

Singh also congratulated Air Chief Marshal Ashutosh Dixit for assuming charge of the IAF on October 31, stating this was his first public programme since the appointment.

Bhojpuri director, friend sentenced to life in jail for his wife's murder 5 yrs ago

Manish Sahu
Lucknow, November 7

FIVE YEARS after the murder of his wife in Fatehpur, a 30-year-old Bhojpuri short-film director and scriptwriter and his alleged actress friend were sentenced to life imprisonment Friday.

The victim, Yogmaya Lodhi, 25, who objected to her husband's extramarital affair, was found with her throat slit at her in-laws' home in Gulariyapur village in December 2021. She died around seven years after her marriage to Indra Mohan Lodhi.

On October 30, a local court in Fatehpur convicted Lodhi, 30, and his alleged friend Neha Verma, 24, for the murder, following which they were taken into custody. The two were brought to court as it had fixed Friday to pronounce the sentence. "The court sentenced both convicts to life imprisonment and imposed a fine of Rs 50,000 each. It directed that the fine be transferred to the bank account of Yogmaya's minor son (now 6 years)," said Additional District Government Counsel, Fatehpur, Ravi Datt Dwivedi.

Observing that no amount of money could make up for the loss of his mother, the court said the compensation awarded would not be sufficient to address the child's needs, said Dwivedi, adding that "therefore the court recommended that the state government provide him additional compensation. The court also asked the Secretary of the District Legal Services Authority to take necessary steps to ensure adequate compensation was provided to the child."

Defence counsel Arjun Singh said, "Some time before the incident, Indra Mohan had approached Neha Verma after watching her performance in a short film and offered her a role in one of his productions. Neha is also a singer." He added that Indra Mohan was shooting a short film in his village at the time of the incident, and Neha was staying at his house as she had been cast in the film. "We will challenge the verdict before a higher court," Singh said.

Yogmaya's brother Satya Prakash, a resident of Sultanpur village in Fatehpur, lodged a complaint at Khaga police station accusing Indra Mohan and his friend Neha Verma of murdering his sister. The couple got married on February 10, 2015.

Her family had spent a considerable amount on the wedding and given substantial dowry, he said.

However, soon after the marriage, Indra Mohan began demanding additional dowry and harassing Yogmaya, stated the complainant. "Whenever she visited her parental home, she would break down while recounting the harassment and repeated demands for money. Her family tried to reassure her that things would eventually improve. They also attempted to counsel Indra Mohan, but he continued to harass her and press for more dowry," the complainant alleged.

In Bihar, many education staff took home excess salary, HRA until audit blew the lid

Santosh Singh
Patna, November 7

RANDOM AUDITS by the Bihar education department has uncovered an alleged scam as part of which excess salary, HRA allowances, and dues were withdrawn by misusing the online Human Resource Management System (HRMS).

The department said the scam is estimated to be to the tune of Rs 35 crore, involving 7,202 cases of excess withdrawals from across all 38 Bihar districts. Though mass audit and timely intervention have helped recover most of the amount — around Rs 33 crore — it has put District Education Officers (DEOs) in the dock for their alleged oversight that let the scam go undetected for years.

The districts reporting the maximum such cases include Gopalganj (783), Gaya (628), West Champaran (551), Patna (312), Buxar (260), Rohtas (247), Muzaffarpur (238), and East Champaran (214).

In October, three sample cases of excess withdrawals — one each from Bhagalpur, Nawada, and Patna — were detected, forcing the state education department to order a statewide audit of payments of salary, allowances, rent, and dues through the HRMS system — introduced four years ago.



Vikas Bhavan that houses education department. RAHUL SHARMA

On Thursday, Education Department Director (Administration) Vijay Kumar Pandey issued a show cause notice to all DEOs in the state, asking them to submit a point-wise reply with supporting evidence within seven days. Failure to respond within the stipulated time will lead the disciplinary authority to presume the official concerned has no defence, making them liable for an ex-parte decision, and immediate action.

'Gross failure, criminal omission'

The government termed the unchecked illegal withdrawals a "gross failure in administrative control and criminal omission," adding that the supervisory laxity severely tarnishes the image of the administration.

"This act demonstrates your apathy, gross negligence, and supervisory laxity towards your official duties, which has tarnished the image of the government and the department. This administrative failure and lapse on your part fall under the category of misconduct by a government servant," said Pandey in his letter to all DEOs.

Citing a consolidated departmental audit report submitted to the education department on November 4, the letter to the DEOs said: "In 7,202 fraudulent cases uncovered, carrying a total recoverable amount of Rs 35,27,49,333, the authorities have managed to recover Rs 33,02,36,12. A significant shortfall of Rs 2,24,30,205 remains outstanding." The audit revealed a violation of financial protocols, directly breaching Finance Department circulars, and the Bihar Treasury Code.

Modus operandi

Explaining the modus operandi of the fake withdrawals, the letter said: "...due to the collusion of the Maker, Checker, and Approver working in your district, tampering and forgery were done on the HRMS portal..."

Notably, three levels of approvals are needed for any kind of withdrawal under the HRMS. While a maker is an official who processes salary, the checker ensures that the amount is correct while, approver, usually a district programme officer-level person, gives the final nod.

Calling the lapses a "criminal omission", the letter said: "The direct responsibility for examining the admissibility of salary and allowances of each employee and making payments lies with the concerned disbursing and drawing officer (DDO)-cum-approver (Approver) as the District Programme Officer (Establishment). Nevertheless, as the highest departmental officer and District Admin (HRMS) of the district, the primary responsibility for continuous monitoring and supervision of this entire process rests with you (the DEOs)."

It said, "The occurrence of all types of illegal withdrawals by the maker, checker, and approver (DDO/District Programme Officer, Establishment) working under your administrative control, and your inability to conduct proper monitoring from your level and prevent it in time, clearly reflects gross failure in your administrative control and criminal omission."

Bihar Education Minister Mithilesh Tiwari told *The Indian Express*: "The statewide audit has raised red flags about excess withdrawals. Even though we have made recovery of the maximum amount withdrawn, we will fix accountability for misuse of the HRMS portal. We are conducting a review meeting on this on November 15 to discuss ways to plug the gaps in the online payment system. The department will take stern action against officials responsible for fake withdrawals."

Man held for chopping friend to pieces after drunken brawl

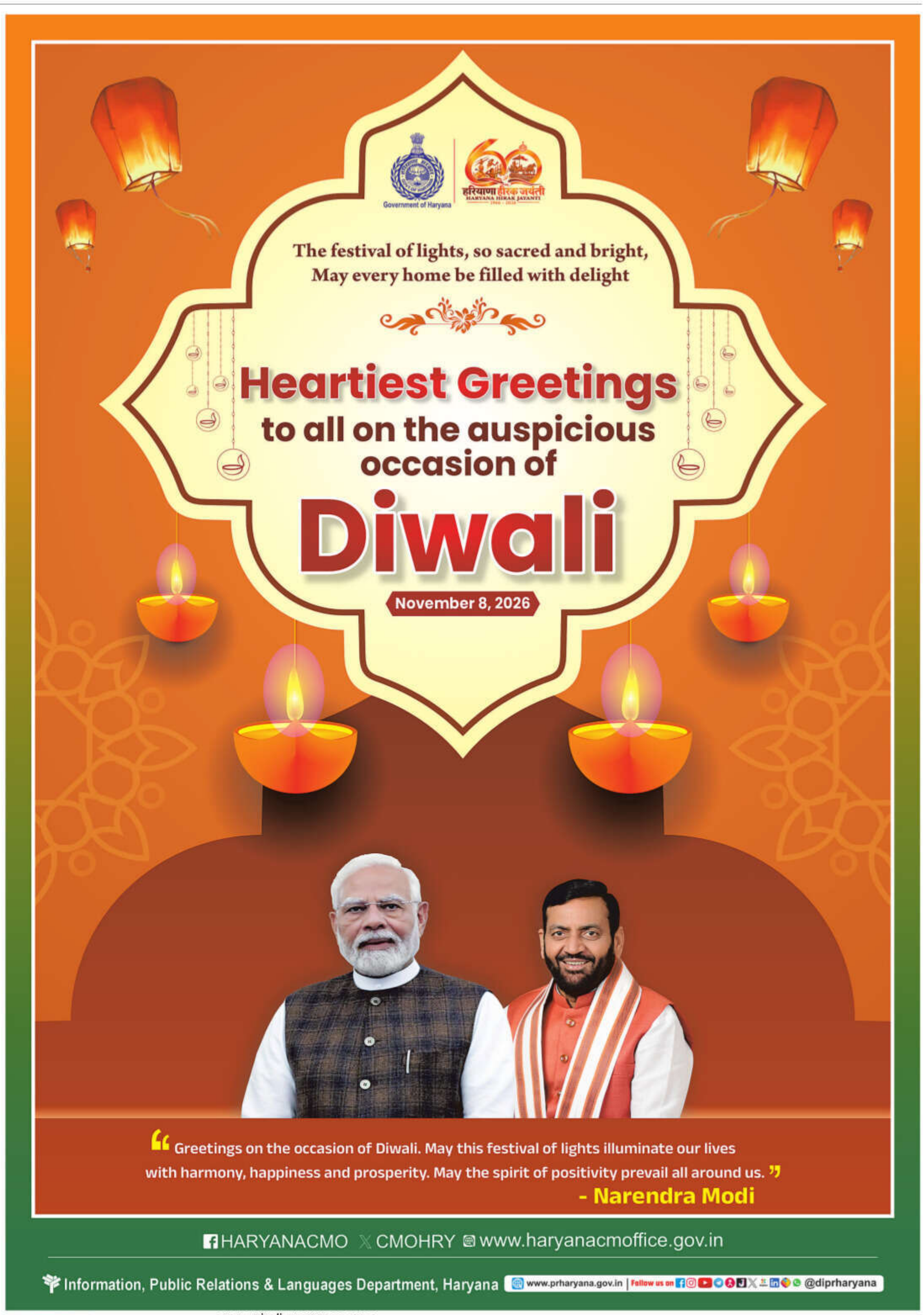
Express News Service
Pune, November 7

TWENTY FOUR hours after a pair of severed human legs was found in garbage in the Pimple Gurav area, police recovered the rest of the body and have made an arrest in connection with the case.

The victim was identified as Anil Khade, 45, and the accused, Vishnu Kumbhar alias Pintya, 43. The latter was arrested on Saturday and booked for murder.

The investigation revealed that both were friends and had gone drinking together on the day of the murder. It is suspected that following some dispute under the influence of liquor, Kumbhar allegedly murdered Khade, chopped his body with a sharp weapon and threw his legs in a gunny bag and into a garbage bin. Police recovered the rest of Khade's body from Kumbhar's house in Vinayak Nagar near Navi Sangvi.

Police zeroed in on Khade after finding in the gunny bag a sim card that belonged to him. They traced his family and confirmed his identity. Further probe also revealed that he was last in contact with Kumbhar.



NSA invoked on whims and fancies, says Kaziranga activist after release

Shinjini Ghosh
New Delhi, November 7



Pranab Doley (third from left) with supporters in Kaziranga. EXPRESS

AFTER SPENDING nearly four months in custody, prominent land rights activist Pranab Doley walked out of jail around 7 pm on Friday. Speaking to *The Indian Express* a day later, the 40-year-old said the court decision that paved the way for his release "is a victory for the people who believe in democracy and want to uphold it".

Speaking over the phone from his hometown in Kaziranga, Doley said the Gauhati High Court's decision to quash his detention under the National Security Act (NSA) was a ray of hope for people who were concerned about institutions upholding fundamental rights.

"It is alarming that serious acts like the NSA are invoked under the whims and fancies of a few people, that too for voicing concerns of the indigenous community who will lose land. No democracy or state should have the right to curtail fundamental rights just because someone has raised genuine concerns. If this continues and people are scared to voice their concerns, how will India continue being a democracy?" Doley said.

After being arrested on July 12 by Golaghat Police in connection with protests against a luxury hotel project near the Kaziranga National Park, Doley was granted bail by a local court on July 29. However, the Assam government invoked the NSA against Doley a day later, stating that his activities were "prejudicial to the maintenance of public order as well as security of the state".

Doley, the convenor of the Greater Kaziranga Land and Human Rights Committee, has been vocal about the potential impact of the project and the displacement of indigenous villagers.

"We are seeing how the entire machinery is being used to clamp down on those protesting... Police are brought in and people arrested in the dead of night," Doley said.

Describing the over 115 days in prison, he said, "It is difficult to describe how inhumane, oppressive and undignifying it is while in custody... You have to keep going through the challenges if you want to stand up for people."

Doley said the past four months have shown that the younger generation is ready to take the lead in fighting for rights. "Even when they are constantly threatened, they are not afraid to voice their concerns and fight for rights and truth. It is a positive and hopeful sight," Doley said.

Apart from his elderly parents, Doley's neighbours, team members and well-wishers were awaiting his homecoming. "A lot of them came to get me from the prison gates. Many others stayed almost the entire night at home as a protective wall to prevent any untoward incident or state action. Somehow people have lost faith," Doley said.

EXPRESS special

Why BJP is cosying up to Sharad Pawar, pushing for NCP merger

BJP insiders say getting strong regional outfits on board could checkmate Cong

Shubhangi Khapre
Mumbai, November 7



NCP (SP) leader Sharad Pawar

WITH FRESH delimitation and women's reservation Bills weighing on its mind, the BJP leadership is looking to mend fences with regional parties, including the Sharad Pawar-led NCP (SP) in Maharashtra.

The BJP high command views Pawar, a veteran politician with vast experience and a wide political network, as a potential ally in securing support for the crucial legislation.

Against this backdrop, BJP insiders explain two recent developments: Prime Minister Narendra Modi's recent phone call to Pawar when he was admitted to a hospital in Pune, and Union Home Minister Amit Shah's meeting with an NCP delegation in Delhi Monday.

Countering Congress

With the Congress increasingly asserting itself politically, the BJP believes regional parties have assumed greater significance. This has also fuelled speculation about a possible merger between the two NCP factions, even as the BJP recognises that the final decision rests with Pawar.

"In politics, nothing is static. The fresh delimitation and women's reservation Bills remain high on the Centre's agenda. To achieve this, every party and MP would count. Issue-based support from ideological opponents also works. This is the loud and clear message the BJP leadership has subtly conveyed to the NCP that its interests will not be compromised," a senior BJP leader said.

Highly placed BJP sources said the NCP (SP), with eight Lok Sabha MPs, remains an important political outfit. They added that, in Maharashtra, strengthening regional parties to counter the Congress's growing assertion has become a "strategic necessity" for the party.

The BJP's counter-campaign, including its "save democracy" protests against the Congress's allegations of irregularities involving the Election Commission's Special Intensive Revision (SIR) and "vote chori", has had limited appeal among voters, sources said.

The BJP central dispensation, they added, has encouraged the party-ruled state governments to reach out to every party, setting aside ideological differences, to consolidate the numbers required to secure the two-thirds majority in Parliament for the proposed legislation. In the special session earlier this year, the BJP failed to secure the requisite numbers, with 298 MPs voting in favour of the legislation and 230 against it in the Lok Sabha.

The BJP's official position is that it is willing to engage with all parties to ensure the passage of the Bills. On the NCP factions' merger possibility, however, the party has maintained, "Ultimately, it is for NCP president Sunetra Pawar and NCP(SP) chief Sharad Pawar to take a final decision," a BJP leader said, indicating that his party would encourage their merger.

Pawar-BJP 'bonhomie'

Beyond the calculations surrounding alliances and a possible merger, BJP managers also point to the long-standing equation between Modi and Pawar.

The PM's proposed visit to Baramati on November 3 to inaugurate the newly developed Prerna Sthal was postponed. Yugendra Pawar of the NCP (SP) has indicated that November 16 is being considered as a possible date, subject to confirmation from the PMO. Despite being on opposing sides of the political divide, Modi and Pawar have maintained cordial relations. Modi's phone call to Pawar in hospital to enquire about his health and advise him to rest was thus not seen in the BJP as unusual.

Supriya Sule factor

What reportedly surprised some BJP leaders, however, was the statement by Vitthal Maniar, a close family friend of Pawar, that the PM had advised Sharad Pawar to rest and said his daughter Supriya Sule would take care of the country.

"Lok Sabha MP Supriya Sule is the political heir of the NCP (SP). It was both natural and factual. She is also her party's working president," a BJP source said.

Sharad Pawar discharged from Mumbai hospital

Express News Service
Mumbai, November 7

NCP (SP) president Sharad Pawar was discharged from Breach Candy Hospital in Mumbai on Saturday.

Pawar had been admitted for treatment for bronchitis and a chest infection. Dr Pratit Samdani said, "Sharad Pawar has been discharged in a stable condition. He will continue his treatment at home. He suffered a bronchitis attack and a chest infection. He is now improving."

The doctor said Pawar had been advised complete rest and given standard precautions to follow. He added that Pawar had been following the treatment and would take good care of himself. ENS

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

New Chief Secy should have been from J&K: Deputy CM

Arun Sharma
Jammu, November 7

JAMMU AND Kashmir's Deputy CM Surinder Choudhary on Saturday asked why the Central government did not give extension to Atal Dulloo, a 1992-batch AGMUT cadre IAS officer, who retired as the Union Territory's Chief Secretary on October 31.

"When officials in other parts of the country had been given extensions, why was the same not granted to Atal Dulloo Sahib?" He asked. "Is it because he belonged to J&K?" he questioned.

"If you wanted a new chief secretary, then you should have appointed someone who hailed from Jammu and Kashmir," he said. "If you did not want to give extension to Atal Dulloo Sahib, then you should have appointed some local, a son of the soil, whether a Hindu or a Muslim, as his successor," Choudhary added.

"But did the BJP say anything about it?" he asked, accusing the ruling party at the Centre and a section of the media of "only trying to make news about the National Conference (NC)".

Dulloo, hailing from Kashmiri Pandit community, has been succeeded by Dr Sajjan Singh Yadav.

NC's dissident leaders have a common demand: Removal of Omar's adviser

Bashaarat Masood
Srinagar, November 7



Nasir Aslam Wani

AS THE ruling National Conference (NC) in Jammu and Kashmir struggles to contain the fallout of discontent among its 18 legislators following the Cabinet expansion, one thing has united the dissident MLAs: the demand for removal of Nasir Aslam Wani as Chief Minister Omar Abdullah's adviser.

These NC legislators resent the proximity of Wani, 60, to the CM and his "overarching influence" on the government's decision making. While they are insisting on his ouster, it would not be an easy decision for Omar.

By conceding to their demand, the CM would risk being seen as capitulating to internal party pressure, setting a precedent that could further embolden dissidents and undermine his authority over a government that still has three years left in office.

Wani's appointment as Omar's adviser since October 2024, when he took charge as the CM, became a source of resentment among a section of the NC leaders and legislators, especially because the 2019 reorganisation of J&K capped the strength of the Cabinet at nine, including the CM.

With limited ministerial berths available, Wani's role as the CM's adviser has left several NC aspirants feeling overlooked and resentful.

In the 2024 Assembly polls, the NC fielded Wani from Kupwara, shifting former minister and senior party leader Saifullah Mir to the newly carved Trehgam constituency. This decision triggered resentment among sections of the party cadre in Kupwara. Wani went on to lose the election to his PDP rival, Fayaz Ahmad Mir by over 10,000 votes. His defeat, particularly at a time when the NC swept the Assembly polls and defeated the PDP across the Valley, did little to diminish Omar's confidence in him. The CM subsequently appointed Wani as his adviser.

Several NC leaders attributed Wani's defeat to the party factionalism in Kupwara, arguing that sections of the party cadre viewed him as an "outsider", given that he had long been based in Srinagar and had previously contested elections from the city.

Wani, however, has his supporters within the party as well, who credit his organisational abilities and leadership with helping the NC rebuild its political base after its electoral debacle in 2014.

Wani began his political journey with the Youth National Conference (YNC), the NC's youth wing, in 1998.

A decade later, he made his electoral debut, contesting the 2008 Assembly elections from Srinagar's Amirakadal constituency on the NC's ticket. He was first inducted into the NC Cabinet in 2009 during Omar's first term as the CM.

• FROM NOV 1 TO 6, OVER 56L TRAVELLED FROM 16 STNs, NEARLY 20L MORE THAN IN SEPT, OCT: RAILWAYS

60% of Diwali passenger outflow from Delhi, Mumbai hubs

Dheeraj Mishra
New Delhi, November 7



People rush to board a train as they leave for their native places ahead of the Diwali at Patna Railway Station, on Saturday. ANI

IN THE run-up to Diwali, five major railway departure hubs — Delhi, Mumbai, Bengaluru, Hyderabad and Surat — emerged as the biggest centres of outward passenger movement, according to the Indian Railways data.

Officials said that over 56 lakh passengers travelled from the 16 stations of these regions between November 1 and 6 — around 20 lakh more than the traffic in September and October (around 37 lakh).

Delhi and Mumbai accounted for the largest share of this festive outflow — 34.77 lakh passengers (61% of the total departures).

Of the 56 lakh, around 30 lakh were reserved passengers (52.5%), while 27 lakh (47.5%) travelled unreserved or in general class.

While reserved-class passengers, i.e. travelling in sleeper and AC classes, were higher than unreserved from Delhi and Mumbai, the unreserved class accounted for a larger share of passenger movement from Bengaluru, Hyderabad, and Surat regions.

Anticipating the festive rush, the Railways had stepped up crowd-control and security arrangements.

Elaborating on them at a press conference on Saturday, Railway Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw said, "Holding areas have been created at around 20 stations to manage the crowd and efficient entry and exit of passengers. The ticket counters have also been set up in these areas. Many more scanning counters were set up so that there are no long queues for passenger security checks."

On security, he said, "Around 700 AI cameras were installed at different stations. At the war room here, we monitor 24 stations, of which 16 stations are on the top priority".

Vaishnaw also said that more special trains are running than last year, and that the maximum rush was observed on Dhanteras (November 6).

Delhi and Mumbai recorded an average of 3.4 lakh and 2.39 lakh daily train passenger departures, respectively, totalling nearly 5.8 lakh boardings every day.

The Bengaluru region ranked third among the five departure hubs, where 9.41 lakh passengers travelled outward, with an average of 1.57 lakh passengers boarding the train every day.

Hyderabad and Surat region was on the fourth and fifth positions, respectively, where 6.99 lakh and 5.54 lakh passengers travelled between November 1 and 6. The five hubs cover 16 stations: New Delhi, Anand Vihar Terminus, Delhi, Hazrat Nizamuddin, Secunderabad, SMVT Bangalore City, MGR Chennai Central, Chennai Egmore, Mumbai Central, Lokmanya Tilak Terminus, Chhatrapati Shivaji Terminus, Ahmedabad, Surat, Udhna, Pune, and Varanasi.

HINGOLI MUNCIPAL COUNCIL, HINGOLI

e-Tender Notice for 2026-27

Hingoli Municipal Council invites e-tender for the work of Proposed construction of shopping Centre at Site No. 100, CTS no.4485,4486 and S.No.94 for Hingoli Municipal Council Hingoli in the State of Maharashtra of Estimated Cost Rs. 410392310.00/-. The e- Tender details are available on **www.mahatenders.gov.in** All relevant dates will be as per the tender published in web portal **www.mahatenders.gov.in**

Date: 06/11/2026

Sd/- (Pranjali Munde) Chief Officer Hingoli Municipal Council

Sd/- (Rekhatai Bangar) President Hingoli Municipal Council

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

(See Section 82 Cr PC/84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Palani Swami S/o Mayaram R/o Y-1735, Mangolpuri Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 140/23 Dt. 08.12.2026 U/s 380/411 IPC 102 CrPC at P.S.: Rani Bahg, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Palani Swami** could not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Palani Swami** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person **Palani Swami of case FIR No. 140/23 Dt. 08.12.2026 U/s 380/411 IPC 102 CrPC of P.S.: Rani Bagh, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 08.12.2026.**

By order
Anuradha Jindal
Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate
North West Court No.101, 1st Floor
Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/15947/OD/2026

North Eastern Railway

E-Tender Notice

Dy Chief Electrical Engineer Construction/N.E.R./Lucknow for and on behalf of President of India invites "Open" e-tender for the following work. **Tender No.: OT.25.2026 Description of Work:** Design, Supply, Erection, Testing & commissioning of (i) 25KV, 50 Hz AC, Single Phase OHE electrification works at Deokali & Jharekhapur Railway Station in connection with conversion of Deokali and Jharekhapur Railway Station in to Three Line Crossing Station with Goods Platform in Sitapur-Mailani Section of Lucknow Division (ii) Construction of ROB Viaduct, LHS, approaches in lieu of level crossing no-182 between KMJ-RDN station in CPA and Kasganj section in Izzatnagar Division (iii) Construction of 02 Lane ROB in lieu of LC No 245/B1 at KM: 630/9631/0 between Mankapur-Jhilahi Railway stations of Lucknow Division. **Approx. Value:** Rs.42611877.35 **Earnest Money:** 852200.00 **Cost of Tender Form :** NIL **Completion Period:** 12 Months **Date & Time of Closing of e-tender:** 30.11.2026 at 15:00 Hrs IST. **Note:-** Manual offers are not accepted against this tender and any such manual offer received, shall be ignored. For full details and submission of bid, kindly visit the official website of Indian Railway i.e. http://www.ireps.gov.in. In case any disparity arises between Hindi and English version of tender notice, English version will hold good and will be followed.

CPRO/Elect-258 Dy.CEE/Con/LJN

DO NOT SMOKE BID/CIGARETTE IN TRAINS

ECONOMIC OFFENCES WING, SRINAGAR
CRIME BRANCH KASHMIR

3rd Floor ERA Building, Exhibition Ground, Srinagar-190001,
Email: sspeowkmr@jkpolice.gov.in, Phone/Fax: 0194-2479030

HUE & CRY NOTICE

Case **FIR No. 47/2018 U/S 420, 467, RPC** is under investigation with Police Station Economic Offences Wing, Crime Branch Kashmir. The individual whose description/particulars are given below, is involved in the said case, is absconding and is evading his arrest to scuttle the due process of law. Please have a sharp look out, if the accused persons is traced/found he be apprehended detained and this agency be informed instantly on phone numbers 01942, 471836/7889405737, for further appropriate action.

The description of the accused absconder is as under:

Particulars of the person.	Sundeep Kour W/O Gurpreet Singh D/O Kashmir Singh, R/o SCF 75, sector -65 Phase-II SAS Nagar Mohali Punjab, / VPO Kular-Khurd District Sangrur Punjab (Director Proprietor of Blu star Emigration services)
Aadhar No.	NK
Pan No.	NK
D/L No.	PB-1320120021228
Date of Birth	10-03-1991
Height	5-4
Hair	Black
Pin code No.	148001



Sd/-
Abdul Waheed Shah
Senior Superintendent of Police,
Economic offences Wing,
Crime Branch Kashmir

DIPK-7472/26, 07 NOV 2026

JAIPUR DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY
Indra Circle, Jawahar Lal Nehru Marg, Jaipur - 302004

No. JDA/EE-C2/059/2026-27/D-384 Dated : 05-11-2026

NOTICE INVITING BID
NIB No.: JDA/EE-C2/31/2026-27

Online Bids are invited up-to 06:00 PM of 27.11.2026 for "Construction of RCC drain & Footpath work at Madhyam Marg Mansarovar Sanganer constituency in Zone-C2, JDA, Jaipur". The last date for Applying Bid and making online payment. on JDA portal is up-to 06:00 PM of 27.11.2026. The estimated cost of NIB is Rs. 1305.69 Lacs. Details may be seen in the Bidding Document at our office or the State Public Procurement Portal website www.sppp.rajasthan.gov.in, www.eproc.rajasthan.gov.in and www.jda.rajasthan.gov.in/jda
UBN No.JDA2627WLOB00407
To participate in the bid, bidder must:
A. Participate in Tender & Deposit Payment on 'Online Tender Participation' Portal of JDA at https://jda.rajasthan.gov.in/jda or by Single-Sign-On at http://service.jaipurjda.org.
B. Submit e-Bid on 'e-Procurement Portal' of GOR at www.eproc.rajasthan.gov.in

Raj.Samwad/C/26/13097 Executive Engineer (C2)

'7th attempt on life': Abhishek says 'BJP hooligans' attacked his house

Atri Mitra
Kolkata, November 7

A MAJOR clash broke out between Trinamool and BJP workers outside the residence of Trinamool's all-India general secretary and Diamond Harbour MP Abhishek Banerjee. Tension spread around 2 am on Saturday after Trinamool supporters gathered outside his Kalighat residence in connection with the MP's birthday celebration.

Abhishek alleged that armed BJP supporters picked up an argument with Trinamool workers over the chanting of 'thief' slogans and attacked his house with the plan to kill him. He said that several workers from his party were seriously injured in the incident.

Abhishek alleged that BJP miscreants threw his party workers to the ground and beat them with bricks and stones. In a video he released, several people can also be seen tearing down banners and posters bearing the MP's name.

After the incident, Abhishek came out of the house and got into a heated exchange with the police. He alleged that the attackers were carrying revolvers and had come with a premeditated plan to kill him.

The Trinamool MP claimed that the entire incident took place in front of the police, yet no proper steps were taken to bring the situation under control.

Abhishek told the media that a party worker, Tapas, lost the part beside the thumb, and doctors suggested plastic surgery to fix the issue. He also alleged that another worker had suffered a fracture beneath the eye.

Later in the day, as more supporters gathered outside his Kalighat house, the police allegedly stopped them from assembling in the area, citing the imposture of Section 163 of the BNS in the street outside his house.

As a commotion broke out, TMC supremo Mamata Banerjee came out of the residence along with her nephew Abhishek, and the duo addressed the supporters and the media on a handheld microphone.

Abhishek had earlier claimed that this was not the first time he had been attacked. He alleged in a post on X that there have been at least seven attempts to kill him in the past six months.

Advani, a mentor whose ideals endure



M VENKAIAH NAIDU

ON THE auspicious occasion of my mentor, Shri Lal Krishna Advani *ji* stepping into his centenary year, I extend my heartfelt greetings and best wishes to him, his admirers and his family members. Advani *ji* is an iconic visionary of India's development, a guiding force in the making of a new India, and a staunch patriot who dedicated his life selflessly to public service. All through his long career devoted to public service, Shri Advani *ji* has led a life of integrity and simplicity, practising what he believed in and setting an example through his actions. As he enters his centenary year, let us draw inspiration from his life and ideals.

Vajrādapi kathorāni mrdūni kusumādapi/Lokottarānām cetāmsi ko hi vijñātum arhati: These lines from *Uttara Ramacharitam* beautifully bring out the nature of great personalities like Shri Advani *ji*, who are transcendent, noble beings. At times, their conduct can be harder than a diamond, while at other times, it can be softer than a flower. These words aptly describe Shri Lal Krishna Advani *ji*, whose life has been a symbol of patriotism, purity of purpose, dedication to work and unwavering determination. If his resolve is harder than a diamond, his personal demeanour is gentler than a flower. From the time he became closely associated with people through the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS) at the age of 15 to the occasion of receiving the Bharat Ratna at the age of over 95, and even thereafter, he has remained a shining example of composure, wisdom and visionary leadership.

A towering personality in Indian politics and an embodiment of value-based public life, Shri Lal Krishna Advani *ji* can truly be described as a Rajarshi — a sage among rulers, in our national politics. Such towering personalities, who combine the wisdom of a sage with the responsibilities of public life, are rare in politics. His commitment to the development of the nation, his relentless dedication to that cause, his sincerity in pursuing his goals until they are achieved, and his unparalleled patriotism stand out as enduring sources of inspiration. Through the principles he demonstrated in practice, he has inspired lakhs of party workers across the country and became a role model for them. I count myself fortunate to have been inspired and blessed by him. He played a key role in shaping the Jana Sangh which evolved into the BJP. I firmly believe that if one takes inspiration from him and works with passion and perseverance, there is nothing that cannot be achieved in life. It was with this very conviction that I began my journey five decades ago. How that journey unfolded and how his inspiration reflected in me at every turn are well known to all.



The writer (to the left of Advani) coordinating the Janadesh Rath Yatra

Personally, Shri Advani *ji* has always been like a guru to me. I can never forget the fatherly affection he has shown me from the very beginning. It is impossible to speak about his life without speaking about India. That is why his autobiography was aptly titled *My Country, My Life*. Elders tell us that great people are selfless, remain undeterred by hardships, always work for the welfare of society, are committed to upholding dharma and tirelessly strive for the well-being of the people. Anyone who has observed Shri Advani *ji* closely would readily acknowledge that he embodies all these qualities. This is also one of the compelling reasons behind my personal bond with him.

> A towering personality in Indian politics and an embodiment of value-based public life, Shri Lal Krishna Advani ji can truly be described as a Rajarshi — a sage among rulers, in our national politics

Shri Advani *ji*'s life, marked by extensive tours across the country to energise party workers and inspire them into action, serves as an example for young politicians. When allegations were levelled against him, he immediately resigned from his post and took a solemn vow that he would not accept the position again until the allegations were proved false. He ultimately emerged from those allegations with his integrity intact, like a pearl cleansed of every blemish. His conduct remains an enduring example for all those engaged in public service.

The Rath Yatra initiated by Shri Advani *ji* for the Ayodhya movement was a landmark chapter in the history of India. At that time, I was serving as the President of the BJP in Andhra Pradesh. It was a momentous period which inspired me to dedicate myself completely to the service of the nation. It was then that the people of India witnessed the strength of his iron resolve.

We know how Mahatma Gandhi's Dandi Salt Satyagraha Yatra awakened the people and inspired them to rise against British colonial rule and break the chains of bondage imposed on Bharat Mata. After that historic journey, it was Shri Advani *ji*'s Rath Yatra that once again brought a powerful wave of national consciousness among the people of India. At a time when society had been divided along caste and class lines for political gain, Shri Advani *ji* undertook the Rath Yatra with the objective of realising *ekatmata* — the unity that represents the true spirit of India. The Yatra laid a strong foundation for a new era in the country. It marked a turning point when nationalism in modern Indian politics gained momentum and emerged as a mass movement.

Shri Advani *ji*'s Rath Yatra brought about a change in the outlook of the youth of the country. People, particularly young people, recognised the need to come together in the cause of Indian identity and national unity. The political awakening it generated inspired many to enter public life and contribute to the nation.

Yathā chittam tathā vācho, yathā vāchastathā kriyāh/Chitte vāchi kriyāyām cha sādhūnām ekarūpatā: This verse conveys that the thoughts, words and actions of noble people are in harmony. Shri Advani *ji* is one such noble personality. In thought, word and deed, he has remained a nationalist, a well-wisher of society and above all, a humanitarian.

Shri Advani *ji* can be compared to the lotus, the election symbol of the Bharatiya Janata Party. The lotus blossoms despite growing in muddy waters. Similarly, Shri Advani *ji* emerged as a distinguished statesman without allowing himself to be tainted by the impurities often associated with politics. A lotus leaf remains untouched by water even when it grows in water. In the same way, Shri Advani *ji* has conducted himself with equanimity, keeping himself free from the influence of attachment, aversion and personal prejudices.

In Sanskrit, the word *adarsha* means an ideal, and it also evokes the image of a mirror. A mirror is something in which we see ourselves and recognise what needs to be corrected. An ideal serves the same purpose in life. Among the people who have profoundly influenced my life, Shri Atal Bihari Vajpayee *ji* and Shri Lal Krishna Advani *ji* occupy the foremost place.

Whenever anyone praised me or spoke about any aspect of my life, I would immediately think of Advani *ji*. I have always looked up with profound respect to his ideals of patriotism, commitment, sincerity, dedication to work, simplicity and equanimity. I firmly believe that his life and ideals will continue to inspire not only me but also everyone in public life and the younger generation aspiring to enter politics.

I sincerely hope that the younger generation will draw inspiration from his extraordinary life as he enters his hundredth year and become active partners in building a Viksit Bharat — a developed India. I pray to the Almighty to bless him with good health and well-being.

The writer is former vice-president of India

Not a very happy Diwali



FIFTH COLUMN

BY TAVLEEN SINGH

BELIEVE ME when I tell you that in this season of fun and festivity I would have liked to write a cheerful piece. Alas, the only good news that came last week was from the United States, where Donald Trump got a well-deserved hammering in the midterm elections. The possibility that we are beginning to see the end of Trumpism brings hope and joy that has spread rapidly across the world because the trouble he caused in trying to 'make America great again' has consequences well beyond American shores.

On the domestic front, much as I have searched for cheery things to write about in this season of fun and feasting, I have failed. In Delhi, the air is so poisonous that I have been unable to step outside without my eyes watering and my throat burning. What is worse is that I had some business to attend to in the old part of this city and was confronted with the horrors caused by unplanned urbanisation. In my childhood, Chandni Chowk was a magical place of old-fashioned shops selling attar and wedding finery. At street corner restaurants, while our mother shopped, my sister and I would stuff ourselves with masses of the most delicious *samosas* and *jalebis*. Today only intrepid foreign tourists venture into the old city. It is smelly, dank and dirty, and has hanging over it huge clumps of wires that blot out the sky.

What was more depressing than the polluted air and this visit to Old Delhi was the political news. Rahul Gandhi's rally in Ramlila Maidan appears to have terrified the Bharatiya Janata Party. So, it unleashed its spokesmen onto every willing news channel to shriek aggressively that the rally was a 'flop'. They said this more stridently than usual, and they are usually strident anyway. To ensure that any message the Congress party was trying to send was dead before it reached ordinary voters, senior ministers were deployed to march around the streets of cities as distant as Hyderabad to 'save democracy and stop anarchy'.

When this seemed to have limited impact, out came that tired, old charge of the 'foreign hand'. When Rahul Gandhi was accused of being propped up by evil foreigners, he threw the charge back at the Prime Minister and challenged him to a debate on the subject at a place of his choosing with a judge of his choice. This made ministers fly into action mode and remind him that such a place already existed and it was called Parliament.

Then the story got darker. Much darker. Leaders of the Cockroach Janta Party were charged with being anarchists with mysterious links to 'handlers' in Pakistan and the United States. These charges have been made ever since the cockroaches started making their presence felt on the national stage, but they have now become more serious because they were made by a senior cabinet minister. The very same Jitendra Singh who, after Dharmendra Pradhan resigned, invited these very same cockroach leaders for some chai and chatting. If he knew they were foreign agents, why did he get so cozy with them?

The more important question is why foreign agents have been able to infiltrate the high walls of national security with such impunity? What has our tough-talking Home Minister been doing while this was happening? And why is he not dealing with these vital matters today instead of tramping around the streets of Hyderabad to 'protect democracy and condemn anarchy'? Surely, this menial task can be done by lesser people in the mighty BJP.

If foreign agents are indeed creating anarchy and chaos in India, it is time that the government made proof of this, public. There has been more than enough time for them to do this since the first charges about foreign funding and 'toolkits' were made after the farmers' agitation all those years ago. We have a Prime Minister who reminds us almost daily that he has done more to strengthen our national security than any who came before him, so how have these foreign agents managed to break through?

As someone who began writing about politics when Indira Gandhi was prime minister, I remember well the number of times she spotted foreign agents under our beds. She raved on about the 'foreign hand' so often that it became a joke among foreign correspondents who came up with some catchy poems about this foreign hand. It was mostly American journalists who were the target because Mrs Gandhi believed that the CIA thought of her as an enemy. Then, as I have said before in this column, a KGB spymaster called Vasili Mitrokhin came out with his memoirs in the nineties in which he said clearly that half of Mrs Gandhi's cabinet ministers were being paid by the Soviet Union.

Today the Russians are on our side, and Donald Trump has ditched his old pal Narendra Modi to cozy up to his 'favourite Field Marshal' in the Islamist Republic next door, so who exactly is the 'foreign hand' now? If the government has details of foreigners financing the cockroaches, details need to be made public soonest because the CJP has huge support among young Indians in the Gen-Z category. These are young people who are dealing with corrupt examinations and soul-destroying unemployment. It might be wiser for the government to address these real problems instead of making reckless charges.

At the kirana store, it is a quiet Diwali



TRISHNA SARKAR

IN MOST Delhi colonies, Diwali used to be announced at the corner kirana. Marigolds and fairy lights would go up all over the shop front, boxes of dry fruit and sweets would be stacked up by the counter, and the *diyas* would spill out onto the road. For the shopkeeper, it was the busiest time of the year by far.

This Diwali season, the lights are on, but the counter is quieter. There is no jostling for space, no children tugging at their parents' sleeves for a box of *phuljhadis,* no Uncle calling out to his helper to fetch another carton from the godown. Instead, a young fella we didn't know was in charge at the kirana in our lane. When I asked after Uncle, he told me, almost apologetically, that Uncle had sold the shop. There were far fewer customers coming in now, he said; most of the old families just order online — milk in the morning, sweets for guests, even the *diyas* for Lakshmi puja.

The social economy of the kirana

The kirana was more than a shop. The owner knew the families in the area: Who had moved in, whose kids were at which school, which house was up for rent. All purchases went into a monthly *khata*, which was settled at the end of the month. If something was out of stock, he would get it by the end of the day. In economic terms, it was retail, informal credit and local information all in one counter, held together by trust.

The kirana shops are part of India's MSME sector, with the vast majority of them being micro units with very thin margins and little capital. They now find themselves in direct competition with well-funded platforms. Blinkit, Zepto, Swiggy Instamart, Flipkart Minutes, Amazon Now, BB Now and JioMart, all deliver groceries (including Diwali essentials) in minutes.

An unequal contest for small enterprises

This isn't a level playing field. A platform with investors behind it can absorb losses for years, can discount heavily and can use data to predict demand. The micro enterprise has to pay rent, pay wages, and pay for stock out of each month's turnover. Its real strengths (service, credit, local knowledge) are genuine but very difficult to use to get lower prices. The real test is how long it can survive as the market resets around it.

There are three reasons why this shift might, in fact, undermine itself. Firstly, customers are also earners. When small business owners give up their businesses, they often re-enter the economy as delivery riders or app-based workers, earning by the task and with no social security. Their incomes are lower and less predictable, and so is their spending. Secondly, low prices are not sustainable. Discounts funded by investor capital can't go on forever. Growth is already tailing off, with quick commerce sequential growth falling below 20 per cent in Q1 FY26 as the platforms have moved on to profitability. Thirdly, local money stops circulating locally. The neighbourhoods lose the activity which had sustained all the other small businesses, and the informal credit of the *khata* is gone with it.

Finding a balance

The answer isn't to resist innovation but to shape it. Kiranas are now taking orders via WhatsApp, delivering to the doorstep, and are part of the government's ONDC network. The way forward is through partnerships between the platforms and the kiranas, with fair competition and better social security for the gig workers.

The writer is assistant professor, Department of Economics, Dr Bhim Rao Ambedkar College, University of Delhi

Why Vajpayee government dropped a terror law clause



HISTORY HEADLINE

BY SHYAMLAL YADAV

THE DIGITAL News Publishers Association (DNPA), comprising 21 publishers, including *The Indian Express,* has approached the Supreme Court and challenged the Digital Personal Data Protection (DPDP) Act, 2023, and the accompanying Rules, 2025, arguing the law could compromise investigative journalism and expose journalists' confidential sources. This harks back to the Prevention of Terrorism Ordinance (POTO) during Atal Bihari Vajpayee's NDA government. At the time, media organisations and the Opposition successfully pressed for the removal of one of its controversial provisions. The core issue was the same — a tension between national security/data protection laws and the confidentiality of journalists' sources.

This time, media companies received assurances from the Centre in an August 2026 meeting that the law would protect press freedom. But the lack of a written carve-out for journalists, as in the European Union, Singapore and Britain, was alarming, the DNPA said in the Supreme Court. A three-judge bench presided over by Chief Justice Surya Kant has issued a notice, seeking a stay on the challenged provisions of the DPDP Act, 2023, and DPDP Rules, 2025. The bench has listed the matter for November 17.

The Prevention of Terrorism Ordinance (POTO) arrived in 2001, as TADA, an earlier law enacted with a similar purpose, lapsed in 1995. It came amid growing terrorist activities — Chittisinghpura, March 20, 2000; Red Fort, December 22, 2000; Kishtwar, May-August 2001; and Jammu-Kashmir assembly, October 1, 2001). POTO was approved by the Cabinet on October 16, 2001, and promulgated on October 24, 2001. Under Clause 3(8) of the ordinance, any person who, without reasonable cause, failed to disclose to the police any information they knew or believed could materially assist in preventing a terrorist act or apprehending a suspect could face imprisonment of up to one year, or a fine, or both. With no exemption for media personnel, the provision raised concerns that journalists could be compelled to disclose information and reveal confidential sources.

Facing protests, the Cabinet decided on December 29, 2001, to omit Clause 3(8) while re-promulgating POTO with amendments. The bill was then passed in the Lok Sabha on March 18, 2002, but was rejected in the Rajya Sabha on March 21, 2002. It was an embarrassment for the Vajpayee government.

Adamant on passing the Bill, the Vajpayee government convened a Joint Sitting of Parliament under Article 108 of Constitution of India on March 26, 2002. It was only the third such occasion since Independence — after the Dowry Prohibition Act of 1961 and the Banking Services Commission (Repeal) Act of 1978. In the Joint Sitting, TDP leader K Yerran Naidu said his party had suggested amendments to POTO, and the Cabinet had accepted them, following which the TDP had supported the Bill "to protect fundamental rights while combating terrorism". LK Advani declared, "Terrorism and more particularly, State-sponsored, cross-border terrorism is a kind of war... We cannot score a decisive victory against terrorism unless special laws of this kind are enacted." Manohar Joshi of the Shiv Sena said that if terrorists were to be stopped, the Home Minister must be given stricter weapons, and that opposition to the law risked national security.

The Opposition, however, demanded the removal of Clause 14, which empowered investigating officers, with prior written approval from an officer of at least the Superintendent of Police rank, to ask individuals and organisations to furnish information — failure to do which carried a penalty of up to three years' imprisonment. Leader of the Opposition Sonia Gandhi warned that the law would create "a separate system of legal procedures, of evidence and of courts... It will not be a system of justice; it will be a system of injustice repugnant to the fundamentals of democracy. POTO poses a larger threat to the freedom of ordinary people than to terrorists." A night-long debate, however, ended in the Bill's passage, 425 votes to 296, and it became law. President KR Narayanan gave it assent on March 28, 2002.

Nearly 11,000, according to an estimate, had been booked under POTA before it was repealed by the Manmohan Singh-led UPA government. After assuming power in June 2004, it promulgated the Prevention of Terrorism (Repeal) Ordinance, 2004. Subsequently, the Prevention of Terrorism (Repeal) Act, 2004, received President APJ Abdul Kalam's assent. The law was deemed to have come into force retrospectively from the date of the old ordinance.

The writer is Senior Associate Editor, The Indian Express

To dress up or dress down?



SHE SAID

BY JYOTI RAINA

LAST MONTH, I received a tidy parcel containing three magnificent sarees. Over the last decades, receiving timeless majestic sarees: cottons, silks, and chinnons; sometimes handloomed at other times hand-woven; has been a regular occurrence. I receive them from my various *mamis, mausis* and *chachis* who have all crossed 75 years of age and in an attempt to become reticent septuagenarians are offloading their life-long elaborate wardrobes. Even my ageing cousins have started passing on their heritage sarees to me.

It oddly does not delight me anymore because the question this benevolent phenomenon begs is: why no one else in the extended family had received such an offering? Why such largesse to me, even though the *mamis, mausis* and *chachis* had daughters and daughters-in-law of their own? I raised this question at a major get-together of the extended family where many women belonging to both the generations were present. The unequivocal response or rather consensus was: because you teach at a women's college!

Of course it baffled me what teaching at a women's college had to do with dressing up in sarees but when I interrogated the collective group, the general response was that the educational institution and especially a woman's college was among the few sites where such dressing up was acceptable.

I hold the reverse view. Before I go on to explicate it, it can be argued that why should what one wears be of any consequence in professional activities? No individual needs to be judged at the workplace based on their clothes. The mandate at work needs to be the discharge of one's professional duties but I do not agree on that either. It is in the matter of dressing up or not dressing up that the personal is the political in a direct way.

That women employed in educational institutions dress up is not a stereotype but much rather a fact. Several teachers dress in sarees that are traditional handlooms, complemented by appropriate jewellery that is rich, to say the least. My occasional comments in favour of dressing less on a regular basis were unwelcome with the critique that the process was part of cultural refinement, mark of respect to the workplace and built self-cheer. Others are more cosmopolitan, donning expensive jewels that they claim demonstrate economic empowerment!

My politics is not to embrace either of the dressing up frameworks. This opposition is on three grounds. First, the social base of students and faculty in higher education institutions in India has expanded, over the last two decades of affirmative action, to include more and more members from the margins of society. If the mainstream material culture, of which everyday clothes are a visible marker, is not simple, or propagates anything that is more than minimal, it turns into an instrument of alienation as well as hegemony; for those who are not in a position to indulge economically. Second, college education is the only time when students of social science aim at recovery of criticality. Coursework framed in critical orientation needs to be experienced beyond the classroom. For instance, while teaching Gandhian Basic Education, I contextualise non-violence through possessing very few clothes. My politics in teaching involves wearing only one or two sets of clothes — a saree or salwar kurta. Dressing up would not be authentic to the critical framework I hope to embrace. Third, college education is a realm of ideas, not material substances. This is best fostered in a simple, dressing down at all levels of personal orientation freeing the mind from burdens of everyday grooming.

Returning to the gifted sarees, I wear them without additional accessories. I also never buy any other clothes and contribute nothing to the neoliberal marketplace within my college microcosm of saree purchases.

The author is a professor at Gargi College (University of Delhi), New Delhi

Editor (Planning & Projects) Shalini Langer curates the fortnightly 'She Said' column

Saudi strikes kill 22 people near Yemen's capital, say Houthis

Associated Press
Cairo, November 7

AIRSTRIKES HIT homes in a village near Yemen's capital, Sanaa, on Saturday, killing at least 22 people and wounding 30 others, mostly women and children, a spokesman for Yemen's Houthi-run Health Ministry said.

Speaking to *AP*, Anees Alasbahi accused Saudi Arabia of carrying out the strikes on al-Shariya. The *AP* could not independently verify the claims, and Saudi Arabia's Information Ministry did not immediately reply to an AP request for comment.

The toll reflected the rapid worsening of Yemen's civil war, where a years-long truce fell apart over the summer. Fighting has escalated between the Iranian-backed Houthis — who control Sanaa, the north and the west of the country — and their Saudi-backed opponents based in the south and east.

On Friday, an airstrike in a market in southern Yemen killed at least 30 people, according to Houthi officials. The Houthis and Yemen's Saudi-backed military each blamed the other for that strike.

Footage from Houthi-run Al-Masirah TV of the aftermath of Saturday's strikes showed staff carrying limp bodies of young children out of ambulances bringing the casualties to a local hospital. One little girl's head had been cleaved open. Other children lay on stretchers, bloodied and bandaged as staff tended to them. Footage from the village showed the rubble of destroyed houses and dust filling the air as people hid in nearby agricultural fields.

WHITE HOUSE'S FIRST WOMAN CHIEF OF STAFF SUSIE WILES REPLACED

Trump names 'hardliner' Miller chief of staff after midterm loss

One of my most trusted advisors, says US President

Reuters
Washington, November 7

US PRESIDENT Donald Trump named longtime aide Stephen Miller as his chief of staff on Friday, giving the architect of some of his toughest domestic policies one of the most powerful jobs in Washington after Republicans lost control of Congress.

Miller, who will replace Susie Wiles, assumes the role as the president prepares to confront a Democratic-led House of Representatives and Senate and a wave of congressional investigations into his administration.

A longtime proponent of expansive presidential authority, Miller takes over at a moment when the Republican Party's defeat in Tuesday's midterm elections could leave Trump more reliant on executive power to advance his domestic agenda.

In a social media post, Trump called Miller "one of my most trusted advisors," and praised Wiles for doing "an outstanding job." Trump said the change would take effect on Monday.

A White House official said Miller's appointment signals that Trump has no intention of rethinking his policies and instead is rewarding his most loyal aides.

"He's not changing course," the official said, despite tens of millions of American voters repudiating Trump's domestic agenda and foreign policy.



Stephen Miller (right) with Trump's Executive Assistant Natalie Harp and Secretary of State Marco Rubio in Maryland on Saturday. REUTERS

Trump said this week he was willing to work with Democrats on Capitol Hill. But elevating Miller, who is known for being caustic and uncompromising, could signal a more confrontational approach and a renewed push to advance the president's agenda on immigration and other issues, several White House officials said.

Trump had been displeased with his political and communications operations in the run-up to Tuesday's election as his public approval ratings fell near record lows. This week, he said the White House needed to be "more aggressive" as Democrats retake congressional power, according to a person briefed on the matter.

"The mission now is more clear than ever," Miller said on X after his appointment. "Fight with all of our soul to support our President and defend this magnificent Republic."

Hakeem Jeffries, who is set to become the new Democratic speaker of the House, responded to the announcement by calling Miller a "reckless extremist" in a posting on X.

Miller, 41, is one of Trump's longest-serving aides and one of only a few who served throughout his first and second terms in office.

He is perhaps best known for driving Trump's aggressive immigration crackdown, setting a goal of 3,000 arrests a day. The efforts to meet that target pushed masked US immigration officers into communities around the country, increasingly arresting people with no criminal records and who had been living in the country for decades.

Vance tries to build his own 2028 brand

Jacob Bogage
Washington, November 7

LATE IN his blitz to salvage Republicans' midterm fortunes, Vice President JD Vance shifted strategy. He talked less about President Donald Trump and more about the issues that define his own political identity.

Vance argued the case for Republicans, who lost control of Congress in Tuesday's vote, almost exclusively through the lens of his policy portfolio, according to a Reuters review of half a dozen speeches since the Republican convention in September.

He bypassed Trump's signature policies including the Iran war and deportations as polls showed the president's sagging popularity dragging down Republican office-seekers.

The change was deliberate, according to two people familiar with the strategy. Vance and his advisers saw the issues he championed — economic nationalism, foreign policy restraint, and public safety — as politically potent subjects he could address with authority. While Trump embraced them as part of his MAGA movement, Vance had emerged as their lead crusader, the people said.

The shift offered an early glimpse of how the 42-year-old vice president could chart his own course as Republicans begin looking beyond Trump.



US Vice President JD Vance

Vance hasn't said whether he will run for president in 2028, and Trump hasn't endorsed him or anyone else. But Vance is viewed as a leading potential contender who some Republican officials say will need to inherit much of Trump's coalition while separating himself from his boss's baggage.

Vance took a more public step on Wednesday toward reinforcing his own political brand with an unusually blunt election postmortem. In a social media post, he blamed the Iran war for Republicans' midterm defeat and laid out a platform for a Republican rebound. He called for a swift end to the conflict and urged Republicans to focus on affordability, reevaluate foreign relations and overhaul the US relationship with Israel. Trump has called Americans' affordability concerns a Democratic "hoax." REUTERS



A city guard runs at the site of shooting near the main market square of Krakow on Saturday. REUTERS

Six people killed by Polish gunman in Krakow city square

At least 15 people have been injured, say authorities

Reuters
Krakow, November 7

A GUNMAN shooting randomly from a car killed six people and wounded 15 in the southern Polish city of Krakow on Saturday, officials said, before police shot and arrested the suspect.

The injured included two police officers who were hurt — one of them seriously — in a shootout with the alleged attacker, who police said wore "military-style" clothes, had military weapons and had opened fire on the city's main square.

Krakow police said on X that the alleged gunman was a Polish citizen, adding: "The only known perpetrator of the incident is in police custody". They did not mention any motive for the shootings, which killed four women and two men.

Police said they started to receive reports at around 3 pm that an assailant had opened fire from a car and had shot randomly at people in the square in Poland's second-largest city, a popular tourist destination.

Unverified footage shared on social media showed people fleeing the scene as shots rang out and police sirens blared. Other video showed two people lying on blood-spattered paving stones and bystanders trying to resuscitate them. A third person lay motionless on the ground nearby.

"I saw shots being fired from the driver's side window, and smoke was coming out. I ran to the police station in the main market square; when I burst inside, it was full of people hiding on the floor," a man who gave his name only as Konrad, and witnessed the shooting, told news website Interia.

Katarzyna Cislo, a local police spokesperson, said: "The shooter was wearing military-like clothes and used military weapons. Many ... weapons and ammunition were found in his vehicle too."

PM Donald Tusk said on X he was being kept informed about the incident in the historic centre of Krakow, a UNESCO World Heritage Site. He later headed to Krakow from the capital Warsaw, a government spokesperson said.

President Karol Nawrocki said his thoughts were with the victims, those affected and their families. Unverified footage on social media showed shooting in the Main Market Square as traditional horse-drawn carriages, popular with tourists, passed through or were parked nearby.

A man could be seen taking cover in one of the many restaurants and cafes that line the elegant square. "Police officers in Krakow intervened, risking their own lives. They acted immediately. Thanks to their heroic conduct, the assailant was quickly apprehended," Interior Minister Marcin Kierwinski said on X.



People stand at the site of a kindergarten hit by a Russian missile attack, in Kyiv on Saturday. REUTERS

Russia pounds power facilities around Kyiv, damages major bridge

Dan Peleschuk
Kyiv, November 7

RUSSIAN FORCES hammered energy infrastructure around Ukraine's capital with missiles and drones overnight, straining Kyiv's power supply and heating systems as temperatures headed towards zero, officials said on Saturday.

Explosions rocked the city as Russia fired multiple waves of ballistic missiles, several of which hit and damaged the Northern Bridge across the Dnipro River, according to Mayor Vitali Klitschko. Strikes on energy facilities outside Kyiv — including systems sending power from two nuclear plants to the city and Ukraine's central regions — caused serious damage, the energy ministry said.

"The capital is facing serious difficulties with its electricity, water, and heat supplies," President Volodymyr Zelenskiy said on X, adding that substations in five other regions were also hit.

He said Russia had launched 36 ballistic missiles, only four of which were intercepted, according to Ukraine's air force. It added that air defences had downed 149 out of 172 drones.

At least two people were killed and around a dozen others wounded across Ukraine in the overnight attacks, which also damaged homes, businesses and non-residential buildings, authorities said.

Moscow's defence ministry said it carried out a massive strike on what it described as targets in Ukraine's military-industrial sector, as well as energy and transport infrastructure in and around Kyiv. REUTERS

China confirms discussions underway on a historic Xi-Trump-Putin meeting

Didi Tang
Washington, November 7

BEIJING HAS confirmed for the first time that it is discussing a historic meeting between Chinese leader Xi Jinping, US President Donald Trump and Russian President Vladimir Putin.Mao Ning, a spokesperson for the Chinese foreign ministry, said at a press briefing this week in Beijing that China "is in communication with relevant parties regarding a meeting between the three heads of state."

Nothing is set, but the three-leader gathering would take place this month on the sidelines of a regional summit in the southern Chinese city of Shenzhen.If it happens, it would be historic.

Experts, however, say the three leaders are unlikely to discuss anything substantive because their interests are at odds, but they would gather for a photo, with China carefully choreographing the meeting.

"I think it will happen. The question is the format and the content," said Sun Yun, director of the China program at the Stimson Center.

"China wants the image but not the costs."Beijing is the host of this year's leaders summit of the Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation, a 21-member grouping that includes the US and Russia.

Trump is expected to travel to Shenzhen to meet Xi for the third time this year, maintaining a fragile trade truce that is set to expire in January. I n a sign that tensions persist, US Trade Representative Jamieson Greer in a Friday video call with Chinese Vice Premier He Lifeng urged Beijing to take "concrete actions to fully implement its past commitments, particularly as they relate to agricultural purchases, rare earths, and other critical minerals," according to a statement from Greer's office.

While he's in China, Trump has said he would be interested in meeting Xi and Putin to discuss nuclear arms controls, though Putin is focused on talking about the war in Ukraine without Kyiv at the table.

"Putin has the most to gain from a leaders' trilateral, and the Russians are clearly behind the push for a meeting, which would be a diplomatic coup," said Danny Russel, a former senior State Department official who served in former President Barack Obama's administration. AP

In Gaza, heavy rain floods tents housing displaced Palestinians as aid shortage hampers response

Reuters
Gaza, Cairo, November 7

HEAVY RAINS have flooded tens of thousands of tents housing displaced Palestinians crammed into encampments across the Gaza Strip, washing away shelters and soaking blankets and mattresses, local authorities said on Saturday.

The Hamas-run Gaza government media office said at least 70,000 tents had been flooded in the past 12 hours, affecting tens of thousands of displaced people and causing injuries although no fatalities had been reported. The territory's civil defence service said it had received 1,500 distress calls from displaced residents. Three abandoned houses collapsed without causing injuries, it added.



A Palestinian man stands in a flooded tent camp in Gaza. REUTERS

At a tent encampment in Gaza City, some people tried to repair their tents, while others used sand to reinforce them and prevent water from entering. Some were busy getting their children out of flooded tents.

Olfat Magdoub, a Gaza resident, tried in vain to sweep water away from her tent.

"This is the first day of rain, and of course we are already flooded. What will happen if it rains again the next day? This is only the first day and we're already overwhelmed," she said.

• NEIGHBOURHOOD WATCH

NEPAL

Protest over press freedom 'violations'

A GROUP of youths and journalists organised a rally in Kathmandu to protest against the alleged press freedom violations.
The protests came after police briefly detained three journalists last week and searched newsrooms of several media organisations. Dozens of protesters, wearing black and carrying placards, organised a rally at Maitighar Mandala. The protesters demanded press freedom, freedom of expression and protection of democratic rights. Activist Puskar Bastola accused the government of targeting the media. PTI

BANGLADESH

Tagore's mural defaced with black ink

A MURAL of Nobel laureate Rabindranath Tagore has been defaced with black ink by unidentified persons in Bangladesh's Khulna, drawing criticism, local media reported on Saturday. Tagore's mural was painted on the boundary wall of Khulna Railway Station alongside portraits of other prominent figures who contributed to the region's art, literature and culture, The Daily Star reported. The wall also features murals depicting the July uprising, the Sundarbans, the Sixty Dome Mosque and the jute industry. PTI

• AS THE DEADLINE FOR COMPLIANCE APPROACHES, LIBRARIANS WILL HAVE TO REVIEW THOUSANDS OF ITEMS IN THEIR COLLECTIONS, MOVE SOME TO A PRIVATE AREA, AND CREATE A VETTING PROCESS TO CHECK AGES

Behind locked shelves: Alberta's librarians brace for a new era of 'book bans'

Vjosa Isai
Edmonton, November 7

STARTING IN January, a new Alberta law will compel librarians to restrict access to books and other material deemed inappropriate for certain ages, a role many say would turn them into censors. Across the Western Canadian province's public libraries, staff members are uneasy.

They will be required to pull from the shelves an indefinite number of books, movies, video games and comics containing "graphic visual depictions of sexual acts," as defined by Alberta's government, and make them available only to library cardholders older than 15.

Those 15 and younger will need a parent's consent to peruse that part of the catalog, which will be kept separate from the general collection. Access to online resources like e-books would face the same restrictions, but the government has acknowledged that there may be technical limitations depending on where the content is hosted.

As the deadline for compliance approaches, librarians will have to review thousands of items in their collections, move some to a private area, and create a vetting process to check ages — or risk consequences including threats to their budgets. The government did not allocate funding for the extra work or for any new physical infrastructure.

"We stand for intellectual freedom and freedom of access," said Sarah Meilleur, CEO of Calgary Public Library, the largest of the province's 221 municipal library boards. "There's a lot of librarian hearts that are hurting in Alberta right now because we find ourselves in a very difficult position."

But among some librarians, a quiet resistance is brewing.

About 250 librarians attended recent virtual calls led by James Turk, director of the Center for Free Expression, based at Toronto Metropolitan University, to share ideas for responding to the new law.



Some librarians are resisting the new law

"Some of them just hope that if they quietly comply, it'll go away," Turk said. "They don't remember the first lesson you learn about schoolyard bullies, and that is, by giving in to them, it doesn't diminish their zeal to go after you."

He evoked the university funding battles waged by President Donald Trump, and book bans in Florida and Texas, including some that name hundreds of titles for removal and threaten serious fines or criminal penalties for noncompliance. While the Alberta government has pointed to a handful of titles that defy its new order, it has not published a list, leaving librarians to locate materials with the specific sexual acts covered by restrictions. The rules also empower inspectors to conduct library checks.

"The way it's being done in Canada, you have an obligation to find everything, whether the government knows about it or not," Turk said. "In a sense, what's happening in the United States is less extensive than what's being tried in Canada."

His organization is preparing to mount a legal challenge arguing that Alberta is infringing on rights of free speech and of equality, since many of the books concern LGBTQ+ people.

The law, passed this spring, is part of a broader suite of policies from Premier Danielle Smith, a conservative. It was championed by the "parental rights" movement, which advocates to assert parents' authority over their children, especially on issues of gender identity and sexuality, in public schools and healthcare. Last November, Smith's government invoked a rarely used constitutional clause to shield Alberta from legal challenges on policies that restrict gender-affirming care for minors, require parents to approve pronoun changes and bar trans youth from competing in women's and girls sports.

Critics of the library rules have accused Smith of manufacturing a need for "restricted" sections in libraries to rile up the more conservative elements of her political base, which was dealt a blow in late October when Albertans voting in a referendum emphatically rejected separating from Canada. NYT

PRODUCTION OF TUNNEL BORING MACHINE TO START IN TAMIL NADU

Chemicals to capital goods: Govt gears up to meet Chinese curbs

Ravi Dutta Mishra & Pratyush Deep
New Delhi, November 7



Government has begun indigenisation of 100 items spanning intermediates and capital goods across sectors. REUTERS

WITH CHINA planning to impose export licensing regime starting this month on capital goods used in key sectors such as solar equipment and heavy capital goods such as tunnel boring machines, the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT) has begun a fresh push to indigenise 100 items spanning intermediates and capital goods across sectors, a senior government official said.

The department has begun talks with respective ministries on ways to boost their domestic production, he said.

The official said plans to begin production of tunnel boring machines, which China's commerce ministry is expected to bring under a licensing mechanism from November 18, are also taking shape, with a plant having "landed" in Tamil Nadu and production set to begin soon. Similar plans to indigenise select petrochemical products, decided in the backdrop of the West Asia crisis, have also begun to move forward.

As China last month proposed restrictions on exports of solar manufacturing technologies, the government has not only announced plans to expand its domestic solar manufacturing capacity and reduce dependence on imports but is also preparing guidelines to recycle solar module waste.

The Indian Express reported last week that the Ministry of New and Renewable Energy has already held stakeholder consultations on module recycling.

Curbs on solar production

The proposed restrictions by China's Ministry of Commerce come as India seeks to expand its domestic solar manufacturing capacity and reduce dependence on imports across the value chain. As per industry estimates, India has around 233 gigawatts (GW) of annual solar module manufacturing capacity, but its solar cell manufacturing capacity remains relatively limited at around 30 GW.

With the country adding about 50 GW of solar power capacity annually, much of its module manufacturing industry continues to depend on imported cells. The gap is even wider further upstream.

India has only around 2 GW of installed ingot and wafer manufacturing capacity, leaving a significant part of this segment dependent on imports. The solar manufacturing value chain begins with polysilicon, which is processed into ingots and sliced into wafers. These wafers are used to manufacture solar cells, which are then assembled into modules.

"China has proposed certain export curbs, and we are expecting final provisions to come out by the end of November. Two things are important from our point of view. One, our cell capacity expansion is already complete, so we don't have any exposure to cell technology imports. Second, the existing operations of the company are not expected to be affected because the proposed restrictions focus mainly on capital goods and technology for new plants. The main challenge is for people setting up new cell and ingot-water plants, but the Chinese capital goods manufacturers are likely to resist these changes as they will severely affect their business," Vinay Rustagi, Chief Business Officer (CBO) at Premier Energies told *The Indian Express*. "There is limited availability of equipment outside of China. The cost of technology is higher, and in many cases, quality is also a compromise. Moving away from China and sourcing capital goods from Europe or Japan, etc can push up costs by 20-40%," Rustagi said.

Petrochemicals dependence

With global trade tensions on the rise, the government has been particularly pushing for production of core petrochemical products because of its use in scores of industries, including textiles, pharma and fertiliser and urea production. Most petrochemicals aimed at domestic manufacturing, including PVC, polyethylene (LDPE, LLDPE), polypropylene, polystyrene, ABS, are the backbone of packaging films, pipes, containers and consumer goods.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

'OVER THE LAST 20 MUHURAT SESSIONS, THE NIFTY HAS CLOSED HIGHER 15 TIMES'

Muhurat trading today: Bull run may continue

Akash Mandal
Mumbai, November 7

THE STOCK market will open briefly on Sunday to hold the special Muhurat trading session, marking the start of a new Hindu calendar year — Samvat 2083. And it is likely to continue its gaining streak for the eighth session, amid the Diwali festivities.

The Nifty 50 and the Sensex have gained around 10% during this run and remain just around 4% lower for the year, having been the worst-performing major market earlier.

What is Muhurat trading?

It is a special truncated session on the occasion of Diwali. Coinciding with Lakshmi Puja, it is considered auspicious and prosperous and marks the beginning of the Vikram Samvat, or the Hindu financial year.

This year, normal trading for the special session will be held during 2:20PM-3:30 PM, just over an hour. The closing auction session will then last for another 20 minutes before overall trading for the day closes at 4 PM.

The benchmark Nifty 50 and Sensex have closed in the green in most of the past Muhurat sessions.

"Over the last 20 Muhurat sessions, the Nifty has closed higher 15 times, including every year from 2018 to 2025. But 19 of those 20 moves were within 1% either way," explained Tanvi Kanchan, associate director at Anand Rathi Share & Stock Brokers. Last year, both benchmark indices gained 0.1%, marking the eighth straight year of ending higher during the special session.

While the special session on the occasion of Diwali usually ends on a positive note, is there any room for further gains during the session, and will the market be able to extend its winning streak?

Expectations this time

Most experts do not see major gains from the session this time round.

"The session is thin, mostly token buying for the new year, so festive sentiment and the recent momentum should keep the bias positive," said Kanchan. "The real test comes when markets reopen on Wednesday, after the Balipratipada holiday on Tuesday, by then, investors will have to absorb two days of moves in US tech and oil. What will matter for Samvat 2083 is whether earnings growth holds and oil stays contained," she added.

Ajit Mishra, AVP of research at Religare Broking, believes that some consolidation after such sharp gains would be "healthy".

"Following the sharp seven-session rally, some consolidation and sectoral rotation would be healthy. The Nifty's ability to sustain above 24,500 will be important to preserve the positive momentum and pave the way towards the 25,200–25,500 zone," Mishra said.

On Friday, the Sensex had gained 2.2% to close at 81,028.02. The Nifty 50 ended 2% higher at 25,030.35.

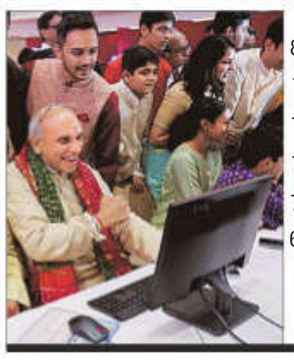
Outlook ahead

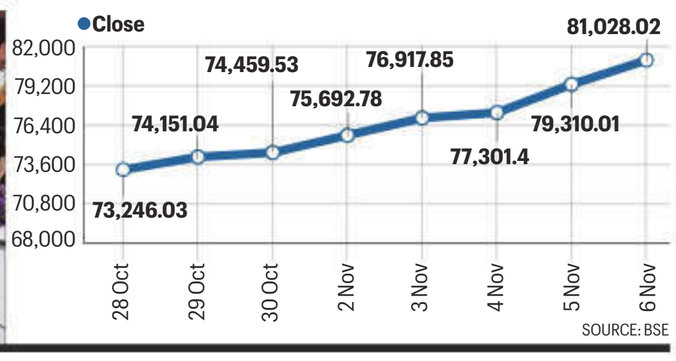
The Indian market looks in good shape while entering the new Hindu business year after some tough times so far in 2026. However, a lot is dependent on crude oil prices, and thus, the situation in West Asia.

"As we usher into a new Samvat 2083, India stands at a point where a resilient domestic economy meets a challenging external backdrop. Samvat 2082 tested investors' patience. Indian equities were weighed down by the West Asia conflict. After the correction (earlier this year), Nifty valuations of 17.5x forward earnings are 16% below the long-term average," said a report by Motilal Oswal Wealth Management.

"Samvat 2083 begins on a cautious note, as an external energy shock overshadows a resilient economy. We perceive FY27 to mark a return to double-digit earnings growth, with Nifty EPS (earnings per share) expected to grow 16%/14% YoY in FY27/FY28 vs 5% in FY26," the report said. Thus, analysts remain positive on the Indian market for the longer run, even if the Muhurat trading session fails to light up the market after the rally. Earnings growth and a robust macroeconomic scenario continue to support the market.

BSE Sensex has been on a 7-session winning run





SOURCE: BSE

HOW MUCH DOES IT COST TO MAKE A DATA CENTRE?

India has become a major hub for data centres. Why? Because it's so cheap to construct one, thanks to lower land, construction, and power costs as well as tax holidays.



- According to Turner & Townsend Data Centre Construction Cost Index 2026, Mumbai is the second-cheapest major data center hub in the world, only after Shanghai. **At $6.83 per watt, building a data center in India costs less than half that in Silicon Valley.**
- But with low local demand for this compute capacity, research firm Rhodium Group thinks India's "non-aligned mantra is misaligned" in the current global circumstances: "a country that hosts foreign compute, deploys foreign models, and sells deployment capacity into foreign enterprises cannot be neutral in this geopolitical climate".

OCT'S 77% SURGE SIGNALS MATURITY FOR ECOSYSTEM

Car market takes a firm electric leap

Vikram Chaudhary
New Delhi, November 7



EV penetration crossed 7% during October. REUTERS

WHEN INDIA'S mass-market electric car sales hit 36,064 units in October 2026 — a 77% surge over October 2025 — in addition to luxury EV sales of 868 units (up 53%), it just didn't signal a festive push or temporary growth due to high fuel prices, but pointed towards a structural transformation.

Driven by crude oil volatility stemming from the West Asian conflict, favourable tax structures (5% GST on EVs versus 18% to 40% on ICE cars), as well as more models, EV sales crossed 30,000 units for the fifth straight month.

In fact, EV penetration crossed 7% during October (36,932 EVs in a total market of a little over 500,000 units, as per Vahan), helped by models like the Tata Punch EV, which became the first EV to cross the 5,000-unit-a-month mark, as well as Mahindra's XEV 9S, which has sold more than 35,000 units during January-October.

"The EV momentum is here to stay. One reason is the sheer number of models entering the market, alongside noticeable improvements in build quality, real-world range, and highway charging infrastructure," Som Kapoor, partner and Future of Mobility leader at EY-Parthenon, told FE.

"On a growing CAGR of overall cars, the EV CAGR will be significantly higher."

October sales show that while Tata and Mahindra have a solid grip on the EV market — both together accounted for 64.4% of all mass-market EVs sold during the month, with Tata selling 14,669 EVs and Mahindra at 8,542 EVs — the mid-tier landscape is becoming competitive. JSW MG Motor India held the third place with 5,940 units, followed by VinFast at 2,571 units, Kia at 1,395 units, and Maruti Suzuki at 1,200 units.

"What we are seeing is the second phase of electrification in India," added an automotive analyst tracking retail dispatches. "The initial phase immediately after Covid-19 was driven by curious early adopters and fleet operators. This year, thanks to the sheer number of models available and charging confidence along major intercity corridors, we are seeing EVs becoming the first car in a family."

On the extreme upper end of the market, luxury EV sales grew 53%, and October's 868 units pushed year-to-date luxury EV sales past 7,000 units – more than full-year CY25 volumes of 5,725 units. BMW dominated the landscape with 462 EVs sold, and Tesla finished second with 291 EVs.

"For high net-worth individuals, luxury EVs have transitioned from secondary garage experiments to primary commute choices," the analyst added. FE

Indian epics get new-age avatars in online gaming

Kunal Doley
New Delhi, November 7

AS INDIA celebrates the triumph of good over evil, a similar battle is unfolding in the virtual world.

Here, ancient Indian epics and mythological characters are being reimagined as immersive gaming experiences, bringing stories that have endured for millennia.

One of the early examples is Raji: An Ancient Epic, developed by Pune-based Nodding Heads Games. Drawing from the Ramayana and the Mahabharata, the game follows Raji, an orphaned circus performer chosen by the gods to defend the human realm against a demonic invasion. Her mission is to rescue her younger brother and confront the demon lord Mahabalasura.

Its sequel, Raji: Kaliyuga, picks up six years later, with Mahabalasura once again threatening the world. As he tears open the gates of heaven and unleashes Kaliyuga — an age in which every choice could unravel the universe — Raji finds herself fighting alongside her younger brother Darsh, or Golu, as she affectionately calls him.

Indian mythology has also found its way into international gaming. Asura's Wrath, developed by Japanese studio CyberConnect2, blends Hindu and Buddhist mythological elements with science fiction.

"Every great mythology on the Earth has had its blockbuster except the biggest one. The audience has been to Camelot, Olympus, Valhalla, feudal Japan and mythological China. Ancient India – five thousand years deep, alive in the daily life of a billion and a half people – has never been built at this scale in a video game," said Nicolas Granatino, executive chairman of Tara Gaming. FE

How NHAI plans to use Bihar's river silt to construct highways, tame floods in the state

Dheeraj Mishra
New Delhi, November 7

THE MINISTRY of Road Transport and Highways (MoRTH) and the Bihar government have signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) for the scientific desilting of water bodies and the utilisation of suitable excavated silt in national highway projects.

It aims to address two key challenges of Bihar and the National Highway Authority of India (NHAI). Rivers like Ganga, Kosi, Gandak, Falgu and Bagmati flow through different regions of Bihar. However, heavy silt accumulation remains a persistent challenge for the state, causing flooding and complicating water management every year.

The NHAI also faces challenges in acquiring key construction materials such as soil and ballast for its highway and expressway projects in the state under Vision 2047, causing inordinate delays. Transporting these raw materials from distant sites consumes time and fuel while increasing project costs.

The new initiative aims to help NHAI contractors source silt free of cost from nearby rivers for highway construction while improving the rivers' carrying capacity through desilting to prevent flooding.

Scope of the initiative

The NHAI is currently executing 39 projects spanning 1,561 km at Rs 58,340 crore in Bihar. Additionally, it has proposed 11 new projects in the state, covering 1,982 km for an estimated outlay of Rs 1,85,200 crore. These projects will require a huge amount of soil or silt for earthwork, embankments and the subgrade.

Officials said that under the MoU, 393 lakh cubic metres of free silt will be utilised across ongoing highway projects in Bihar, with a plan to utilise approximately 1,050 lakh cubic metres of silt in future projects.

NHAI will spearhead the dredging operation using advanced scientific methods. "The excavated silt will be repurposed as a primary material for building the state's expanding National Highway network. Since the silt will be free of cost, it will also help in lowering the construction cost. The scientific desilting will improve water-carrying capacity of Bihar's rivers and reduce seasonal flood risks," an NHAI official told *The Indian Express*.

Currently, contractors procure different waste materials such as fly ash, plastic waste, and construction debris to build structures like embankments and pavements in different national highway projects, subject to their availability, suitability and feasibility of use.

Buldhana pattern

The MoU draws on the methodology adopted in Maharashtra's Buldhana district, which later became known as the 'Buldhana Pattern'. Under this model, soil excavated from ponds and rivers was used in highway construction.

According to Union Minister Nitin Gadkari, the initiative in Maharashtra utilised 225 lakh cubic metres of soil in National Highway construction. The resulting widening and deepening of water bodies increased their water storage capacity by 22,500 thousand cubic metres, at no cost to the state government.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

INDIGO ALREADY OFFERS A TAILOR-MADE BUSINESS CLASS PRODUCT — INDIGO STRETCH — ON SELECT DOMESTIC ROUTES AS WELL AS INTERNATIONAL FLIGHTS

IndiGo bets on premiumisation for its wide-body, long-haul operations

Sukalp Sharma
New Delhi, November 7

INDIA'S LARGEST airline IndiGo, which for long was seen as a classic budget carrier, is betting on premiumisation for its wide-body, long-haul international operations that are expected to begin in 2028.

The airline expects to start receiving the Airbus A350 twin-aisle jets from the June quarter of 2028, and the first 10 of the 60 A350s on order will come in a three-class cabin configuration — business, premium economy, and economy — with 16 lie-flat seats in business class, the carrier's CEO Willie Walsh said last week.

Given the growing demand for premium cabin seats, IndiGo is also deliberating on increasing business class seats on the remainder of its A350s, and offering lie-flat business class seats on its narrow-body Airbus A321 XLR aircraft as well, which it will use on medium-haul and even some long-haul routes.

IndiGo currently operates four A321XLR aircraft and plans to scale this to seven planes next year.

The aircraft — the extra-long-range version of the A321 — is operating flights to Athens and Amsterdam for IndiGo. The XLR fleet will be used to expand further into the Asian region and select European destinations, while the A350s will equip IndiGo to operate deep inside Europe and potentially even North America.

But product premiumisation won't mean that the airline will take its focus away from the high level of cost discipline and efficiency it is known for.

Walsh said that maintaining a lean cost base would be essential to making long-haul operations successful. Maintaining a low-cost structure — which Walsh described as core to the airline's DNA — allows IndiGo to enter long-haul markets with a cost advantage over competitors, according to the IndiGo CEO.

NOT YOUR TYPICAL BUDGET AIRLINE ANYMORE

"I personally believe there's a strong case for that (lie-flat seats in business class) given how we've seen premium demand strengthen right across the world. I'm sure you've heard many of the carriers that are operating long haul have highlighted how robust the demand for premium products is, and even we're seeing that," Walsh said in his first in-person interaction with reporters as IndiGo CEO.



IndiGo is also deliberating on increasing business class seats on the remainder of its A350s. REUTERS

"It was also clear to us that to serve the long-haul international market, we needed to have flatbeds as part of the business class product. That's what the customer expects today...we will have flats in the XLR as we expand it rapidly. So, you know we're responding to what the market wants and I think we've got a very very good niche product," Walsh said.

An aviation industry veteran, Walsh took over the reins at IndiGo early August.

IndiGo already offers a tailor-made business class product — IndiGo Stretch — on select domestic routes as well as international flights operated using the Airbus A321 aircraft. Over the past couple of years, IndiGo has been pivoting away from being a classic low-cost airline to a fit-for-purpose carrier with varied product offerings — including premium cabin products — in line with the demands of specific market segments. A vast majority of its fleet, however, is made up of all-economy Airbus A320 jets that serve its dense domestic network and some short-haul international destinations.

Premium cabin classes offer higher yields and profit margins to airlines than the standard economy class, and airlines across the world are shifting towards product premiumisation. Demand for premium classes has seen a notable jump post the Covid pandemic. By focusing on higher-paying segments over bulk passenger volume, airlines can increase margins, insulate themselves against volatile operating costs, and maximise the revenue from a flight.

"At IndiGo, we are an airline with a low-cost (structure) but we do many things that low-cost airlines don't...So our low cost base is in our DNA. It's something we're very proud of, and it has enabled us to facilitate the growth of aviation in the Indian market," Walsh said.

According to the IndiGo CEO, the airline will not compromise the operational efficiency of its core narrow-body short-haul operations to facilitate wide-body long-haul expansion. Compromising short-haul efficiency to feed long-haul routes is a mistake many airlines have made in the past. As IndiGo already operates a massive, high-frequency domestic network, wide-body flights will be naturally fed by existing flights without requiring costly redesigns of hub airport schedules. FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Classifieds

PERSONAL

I, Adil Khan, S/o Mohd Aqil Khan, R/o M-21/8A, 1st Floor, Sailing Club Road, Batla House, Jamia Nagar, Delhi-110025, have changed my name to Mohammad Adil Khan for all purposes. 0040888168-3

I, Irene Saikia W/o Bijoy Sankar Saikia R/o B12A09, Noornagar, SCC Sapphire, Rajnagar Ext., Ghaziabad have changed my name to Irene Agnes Obrien. 0071070636-1

I,SWARN LATA,W/O-rajeev vaid,R/o-H NO 602-D/7,FLAT NO-1, FIRST FLOOR,KARTAR APARTMENT,WARD NO-3, MEHRAULI,NEW DELHI-110030.Have changed my name to,SWARN VAID,for all purposes. 0040888168-5

I LAKSHAY KUMAR S/O GULSHAN LAL R/O HOUSE NO. 66A, BLOCK FG-1, VIKAS PURI, DISTRICT WEST DELHI - 110018 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME FROM LAKSHAY KUMAR TO LAKSHAY KUMAR GHAWRI FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES. 0071070638-1

I,Udayagiri Sowjanya,D/o-Sh.Chengal Rangaswamy is legally wedded spouse of Udayagiri Rama Krishna,R/o-SMQ.No.224/06,Air Force Station,Arjangarh,New Delhi-110047,have changed my,name from Udayagiri Sowjanya,to Chengal Sowjanya,due to mismatch of name,in service document. 0040888179-1

I hitherto known as,Ayush Kumar,S/o-Anil Kumar,R/o-House No-H-80, First Floor,Kalkaji,Delhi-110019,have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as,Aayush Kumar. 0040888168-7

I, hitherto known as RAHUL S/o SATYVIR SINGH R/o House Number-RZT-157, Jain Colony Part-1, Uttam Nagar, West Delhi-110059 have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as RAHUL SINGH. 0071070642-1

I, Manish Kumar Yadav, S/o Kishan Swaroop Yadav, residing at Flat No.1902, Tower-2, Orange County, Indirapuram, PO: Shipra Sun C, Ghaziabad, U.P-201014, do hereby solemnly affirm and state as under That I hold Indian Passport No.-R1396498 That my wife's name is incorrectly printed as "Nupur Taripathi" in the said passport due to a typographical error. That her correct and legal name is "Nupur Tripathi" for all official, legal, and future purposes. 0071070687-1

I,Gurpreet Singh,S/o-Amarjeet Singh,R/o-Plot No.54,Ravi Nagar, New Delhi-110018,have changed my name to Gurpreet Singh Bhare 0040888168-1

I, Baldev Dua S/o Late Shri Mukand Lal Dua, R/o B-121, Sector-55, Noida, Distt.-Gautam Budh Nagar, U.P.-201307, have changed my name from Baldev Dua to Baldev Sahai Dua. Henceforth, I shall be known as Baldev Sahai Dua for all future purposes. 0071070661-1

I,SARTHAK S/O PRADEEP KUMAR R/O E-139,2ND FLOOR, GALI NO.12-B,PRATAP NAGAR,MAYUR VIHAR PHASE-1,DELHI-110091,have changed my to SARTHAK KAPOOR for all purposes. 0040888185-1

I,U Venkata Laxmi,W/o-Chinna Govindajah is legally Mother of,Udayagiri Rama Krishna,R/o-SMO No.224/06.Air Force Station,Arjangarh,New Delhi-110047,have changed my,name from U Venkata Laxmi to,Udayagiri Venkata Lakshmamma,due to mismatch of name in service document. 0040888179-2

I, MD MANSOOR S/o MUSTAK AHMED, E-12/65 B, Hauz Rani, Malviya Nagar Delhi-17 have changed my name to MASROOR AHMED. 0071070640-1

I,Safia Hafiz W/o Affan Ahmad Beg R/o K-104,Frist Floor,Abul Fazal Enclave-1,Jamis Nagar, South Delhi-110025,have change my name to SAFIA HAFEEZ. 0040888168-6

I, Irene Agnes Obrien R/o B12A09, Noornagar, SCC Sapphire, Rajnagar Ext., Ghaziabad have changed my son name from Aditya Sankar Saikia to Aditya Obrien Saikia. 0071070637-1

I, rajeev kumar vaid, S/O khem raj vaid, R/o H NO 602-D/7, FLAT NO-1, FIRST FLOOR, KARTAR APARTMENT, WARD NO-3, MEHRAULI, NEW DELHI-110030.have changed my name to rajeev vaid, for all purposes. 0040888168-4

I, Satish Kumar, S/o Mohan Lal, R/o H.No.2009 Sector-19, Eldeco County, Sonipat ,Haryana-131001, I have changed my name Satish Kumar Gupta for all purpose 0040888168-2

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COURT NOTICE

In the Court of Sh. Joginder Prakash Nahar, Ld. District Judge-02 Court No. 305, New Building, Third Floor, Shahdara District, Karkardooma Courts, Delhi Regn. No. PC 25/2026

Sh. Akash Gupta S/o Rajeev Kumar R/o F-6/37, Dayalpur, Delhi-110094
.....PETITIONER

VERSUS

1. State Through SDM/Sub Registrar Shahdara DC Office, Nand Nagri, Pocket-1, Near Gagan Cinema, Delhi-110093

2.Sh. Deepak Raj Purohit S/o Late Sunita Devi R/o- H.No. 1/3770-C, Hans Marg Gali No.-1 Ram Nagar Shahdara, North East Delhi-110032

3. Smt. Mamta D/o Late Sunita Devi W/o Sh. Abhishek Sharma R/o Villa No 113 Kingson Green Villa Khasra No-619, Green Residency Chipyana Bujurg, PO: Chipyana, Dist-Gautam Budh Nagar Uttar Pradesh-201009

4. Smt. Dolly D/o Late Sunita Devi W/o Akash Gupta R/o F-6/37, Dayal Pur, Karawal Nagar Road Dayalpur Dist-North East, Delhi-94

5. Ms. Bhawna D/o Late Sunita Devi R/o H.No. 1/3770-C, Hans Marg Gali No-1, Ram Nagar Shahdara, North East, Delhi-110032
.....RESPONDENTS

Citation for publication of Petition under Section 276 of Indian Succession Act for the Probate of the Will of the Late Smt. Sunita Devi.

Whereas the **10.12.2026** has been fixed for hearing of the case, notice is hereby given that person having any interest in the said petition concerned may if he/she desire appear in this court of the said **10.12.2026** and see the proceedings.

GIVEN under my hand and the seal of this court on this **06.11.2026**.

Seal Sd/- **(JUDGE**

PUBLIC NOTICE

PUBLIC NOTICE

This Notice is issued to the general public that my client enter into this Sale Deed Agreement with Shri Rajesh Bansal, S/o Late Shri Fateh Chand Bansal, Add- H1/3 First Floor (Front Potion) Model Town III, Delhi-110009. Any person having any right, title, interest, claim, objection, lien, charge or encumbrance in respect of the aforesaid land or any part thereof is hereby called upon to intimate/file the same, along with supporting documents, with the proposed concerned authority andto the purchaser at the above-mentioned contact number within 15 days from the date of publication of this notice. Any such claim/objection received after the expiry of the aforesaid period shall not be entertained, and the proposed transaction may be proceeded with subject to applicable law.

Issued by: Mr. Ravinder Kumar Aggarwal Through Counsel.

Divij Garg
Advocate
Ph: 9859985907

PUBLIC NOTICE

To be known to all that I, Jasmeet Kaur wife of Shri Nipun Sharma R/o H-63, 2nd Floor, Vikas Puri, New Delhi-110018 Owner of Entire Second Floor without roof Rights out of Freehold Built up Property bearing No. H-63, Plot No. 63, in Block H, admeasuring 104 sq. mtrs., situated in the layout plan of Bodella Residential Scheme, colony known as Vikas Puri, New Delhi-110018 and my original Sale-deed, Registration No. 2287, Book No. 1, Volume No. 423 Pages 54 to 64 on Dated. 21/02/2015 Registered with Sub-Registrar SR-II, Janak Puri, New Delhi has been lost and in this regard FIR/NCR No. 772131/2026 , Dated 03/11/2026 logged in the P.S. Vikas Puri, New Delhi.

Any person (s) claiming any right, interest, having any objection may write/contact with above named person at above address/phone 8929723073 within 15 days from the date of publication of this notice. The person claiming any right, interest, objections with respect to this property can personally inform to the above named person, thereafter any claim and objection will be treated as null and void.

PUBLIC NOTICE

PUBLIC NOTICE

Public at large is hereby informed that M/s Prosper Buildsquare LLP acting for self and as attorney for land owners i.e. Mr. Hari Chand, Mr. Bachu Singh, Mr. Mahinder Singh, Mr. Bijender, Mr. Vedpal, Mr. Brijesh, Mr. Bijender @ Birender, Mr. Sunder Singh, Mr. Ashok, Mr. Satpal, Mr. Rakesh Narwat, Mr. Akshay, Co-Owners of Free hold rights in all units of Project Namely "EPIC HOMES", being developed on land Measuring 3.58125 Acres carved out of Khewat No. 1029, Rect. No. 90, Killa No. 13/1(0-16), 19(8-0), 21(0-0), 22(6-2), 23/1(3-0), Rect. No. 92, Killa No. 2(0-19), 3/2(0-0), Khewat No. 690, Rect. No. 90, Killa NO. 12/2(0-0), 13/2/1(2-10), Khewat No. 476, Rect. No. 90, Killa no. 18/3/2(3 - 14), 8/2/1/2(3-3) Situated within the Revenue Estate of Village Bhupani, Sector- 89, Faridabad, Haryana along with rights in the land beneath, right to use common facilities and rights in construction thereupon i.e. PROPERTY has/had created mortgage over the said PROPERTY in favour of my client Tata Capital Ltd as security for credit facility extended to Xsis Residency LLP & Prosper Buildsquare LLP. The Owners have represented that they have lost original Transfer deed dated 08/01/2021 executed by Ram Singh in favour of Bachu Singh, Mahender Singh & Bijender Singh registered as document no 6089 with Sub Registrar Faridabad. w.r.t above mentioned property, Intimation to this effect has been given to Local Police. Anybody who finds it may please return the same to undersigned. If anyone has any objection in this regard, he/she/they can raise the same within 14 days with the undersigned.

Sd/-
AJAY JASRA
Advocate
Ch. No. T-52, Tehsil Building Compound,
Tis Hazari Courts,
Delhi-110054

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DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS KATHUA

E- mail: sspkathua@jkpolice.gov.in, Fax/Phone No.: 01922-234010

Hue And Cry Notice
Rule No. 712/191

SDPO Basohli vide letter no. Rdr/2026/4121/SDPO dated 27-10-2026 and Police Station Basohli vide letter no. 790/S-1/PSB dated 23-10-2026 has intimated that an unidentified person was identified during the examination of CCTV footage in connection with Case FIR No. 67/2026 U/S 331(4)/305 BNS of Police Station Basohli. The said individual has been evading arrest since the commission of the crime.

During the investigation of said case, best efforts are made by concerned I/O to locate/arrest said accused person which has yielded no result and accused person is still at large.

As such, description roll/photograph of wanted accused is being circulated with the appeal that anybody having information about his whereabouts may inform us on below given Phone Numbers/E-mail ID. The identity of the informer will be kept secret and he will also be rewarded suitably. Anybody found providing shelter to the accused person or concealing his presence will also be booked.

- **Name** Unknown
- **Parentage** Unknown
- **Address** Unknown
- **Age** 25 Years
- **Tehsil** Unknown
- **District** Unknown

1. DPO Kathua- 01922-234010 (Phone/Fax)
2. dpokathua@jkpolice.gov.in (Mail ID)
3. PCR Kathua- 01922-234311(Phone/Fax)
4. SDPO Basohli-9186316011
5. SHO P/S Basohli- 9186316022

Sr. Superintendent of Police, Kathua.

DIP/J-13985/26 – DATE 07 NOV 2026

OFFICE OF THE ENGINEER-IN-CHIEF (CIVIL), ODISHA

34001/1133/2627

NIRMAN SOUDHA, KESHARI NAGAR, UNIT- V, BHUBANESWAR -751 001

1st corrigendum to Bid Identification No.-CE-BRIDGES-18/2026-27

The following changes are made to the Invitation for the work at Sl No.01 "Improvement such as widening and strengthening of Dhenkanal Tarava road from 0.0 to 7.751km in the District of Dhenkanal for the year 2026-27" **vide Bid Identification No. CE-BRIDGES-18/2026-27.**

- The bid documents will be available in the website **www.tendersodisha.gov.in from 10.00 A.M of Dt.07.11.2026 to 05.00 P.M of Dt.26.11.2026** for online bidding.
- The Last date of submission of tender is extended upto **5.00 PM of Dt. 26.11.2026.**
- The Bids received on line shall be opened at **11.30 AM on Dt. 27.11.2026.**

All other terms and conditions remain unchanged

Sd/-
Chief Engineer, Bridges-I
Odisha, Bhubaneswar

OIPR-34001/34174/1/26-27/0041

"IMPORTANT"

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Office of the Superintending Engineer

Bulandshahr Circle, P.W.D, Bulandshahr

E - Procurement Inviting Tender Notice

No.7997 /96M/E-TENDER-BSR CIRCLE/2026-27 **Dated: 31.10.2026**

1. On behalf of Governor of Uttar Pradesh, Superintending Engineer Bulandshahar Circle, U.P.P.W.D., Bulandshahr invites following tenders of percentage rate bid online through **http://etender.up.nic.in** from the eligible and registered in Category (A/B/C Class) Firm/Contractors in the UP PWD, from dt. 18.11.2026 to 26.11.2026 up to 12.00 PM. as per the prescribed T-2. The technical bids will be opened online on dated 26.11.2026 at 12:30 P.M. If the office happens to be closed on the date of opening of the bids as specified, the bids will be opened online on the next working day respectively, at the same time and validity of bid will be considered from the original date. The date and time of opening of the financial bid shall be notified on the website.

2- Details of Work-

Sl. No	Name of Work	Estimated cost (Rs.in Lac)	Bid Security (Rs.in Lac)	Tender document fee including GST	Work Completion	Add. Of Executive Engineer	Add. Of Superintending Engineer	Add. Of Chief Engineer	Contractor Category
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
1	Rehabilitation work of the bridge situated over the Chhoiya Drain at Km 06 of the Babugarh–Buxar Road (NH-24 / City Portion)	37.85	3.79	Tender Cost- Rs. 2300.00+ G.S.T. Rs. 414.0 = 2714.00	02 Months	E.E., P.D., Hapur	S.E., BSR Circle, Bulandshahr	C.E., M.Z., Meerut	Road A/B/C
2	Special repair work of the Bankhanda to Udaipur Road	71.25	5.56	Tender Cost- Rs. 2300.00+ G.S.T. Rs. 414.0 = 2714.00	02 Months	E.E., P.D., Hapur	S.E., BSR Circle, Bulandshahr	C.E., M.Z., Meerut	Road A/B
3	Special repair work of Doymi–Muradpur–Agapur–Hapur–Kithore–Asaura Link Road	38.65	3.87	Tender Cost- Rs. 2300.00+ G.S.T. Rs. 414.0 = 2714.00	02 Months	E.E., P.D., Hapur	S.E., BSR Circle, Bulandshahr	C.E., M.Z., Meerut	Road A/B/C
4	Special repair work Hapur–Bhatiana Road from Chitauli Gate to Ambedkar Gate in District Hapur during the Financial Year 2026–27	43.65	4.18	Tender Cost- Rs. 2300.00+ G.S.T. Rs. 414.0 = 2714.00	02 Months	E.E., P.D., Hapur	S.E., BSR Circle, Bulandshahr	C.E., M.Z., Meerut	Road A/B/C
5	Special repair work from NH-235 to Kurana Road during the Financial Year 2026–27 in District Hapur	46.00	4.30	Tender Cost- Rs. 2300.00+ G.S.T. Rs. 414.0 = 2714.00	02 Months	E.E., P.D., Hapur	S.E., BSR Circle, Bulandshahr	C.E., M.Z., Meerut	Road A/B/C
6	Special repair work from Saudipur–Morpur Road to Dharmpur Bisva Road	36.85	3.70	Tender Cost- Rs. 2300.00+ G.S.T. Rs. 414.0 = 2714.00	02 Months	E.E., P.D., Hapur	S.E., BSR Circle, Bulandshahr	C.E., M.Z., Meerut	Road A/B/C
7	Special repair work in Km 12, 13, 14 and 15 of Athsaini Bridge–Bachhlauta Bridge Road (ODR) during the Financial Year 2026–27	59.40	4.97	Tender Cost- Rs. 2300.00+ G.S.T. Rs. 414.0 = 2714.00	02 Months	E.E., P.D., Hapur	S.E., BSR Circle, Bulandshahr	C.E., M.Z., Meerut	Road A/B/C
8	Special repair work of Babugarh–Buxar Road (Old NH-24 / City Portion) ODR in District Hapur during the Financial Year 2026–27	166.95	10.35	Tender Cost- Rs. 2300.00+ G.S.T. Rs. 414.0 = 2714.00	03 Months	E.E., P.D., Hapur	S.E., BSR Circle, Bulandshahr	C.E., M.Z., Meerut	Road A/B
9	Special repair work of the Mawana–Hapur–Kithore Road to Nanpur via Mudafara and Shyampur Jatt through Dibai Road (ODR) during the Financial Year 2026–27	59.80	4.99	Tender Cost- Rs. 2300.00+ G.S.T. Rs. 414.0 = 2714.00	02 Months	E.E., P.D., Hapur	S.E., BSR Circle, Bulandshahr	C.E., M.Z., Meerut	Road A/B/C
10	Special repair work of the Alamnagar to Sherpur Road	58.65	4.93	Tender Cost- Rs. 2300.00+ G.S.T. Rs. 414.0 = 2714.00	02 Months	E.E., P.D., Hapur	S.E., BSR Circle, Bulandshahr	C.E., M.Z., Meerut	Road A/B/C
11	Special repair work of the Palwara to Alamnagar Road via Paswara Road	41.35	4.07	Tender Cost- Rs. 2300.00+ G.S.T. Rs. 414.0 = 2714.00	02 Months	E.E., P.D., Hapur	S.E., BSR Circle, Bulandshahr	C.E., M.Z., Meerut	Road A/B/C
12	Special repair work from Garh–Bulandshahr Road to Bagadpur Link Road	46.05	4.30	Tender Cost- Rs. 2300.00+ G.S.T. Rs. 414.0 = 2714.00	02 Months	E.E., P.D., Hapur	S.E., BSR Circle, Bulandshahr	C.E., M.Z., Meerut	Road A/B/C
13	Special repair work of Simbhaoli to Todarpur Road during the Financial Year 2026–27	37.70	3.77	Tender Cost- Rs. 2300.00+ G.S.T. Rs. 414.0 = 2714.00	02 Months	E.E., P.D., Hapur	S.E., BSR Circle, Bulandshahr	C.E., M.Z., Meerut	Road A/B/C
14	Special repair work of the NH-24 Sikheda to Muradpur Hajipur Road via Naya Bans Road during the Financial Year 2026–27	41.50	4.08	Tender Cost- Rs. 2300.00+ G.S.T. Rs. 414.0 = 2714.00	02 Months	E.E., P.D., Hapur	S.E., BSR Circle, Bulandshahr	C.E., M.Z., Meerut	Road A/B/C
15	Special repair work from Kuchesar–Mohammadpur Road to Mubarikpur Road	52.20	4.61	Tender Cost- Rs. 2300.00+ G.S.T. Rs. 414.0 = 2714.00	02 Months	E.E., P.D., Hapur	S.E., BSR Circle, Bulandshahr	C.E., M.Z., Meerut	Road A/B/C
16	Special repair work of the Pawati to Haiderpur Road	53.95	4.70	Tender Cost- Rs. 2300.00+ G.S.T. Rs. 414.0 = 2714.00	02 Months	E.E., P.D., Hapur	S.E., BSR Circle, Bulandshahr	C.E., M.Z., Meerut	Road A/B/C
17	Special repair work of the Chapka Link Road	38.20	3.82	Tender Cost- Rs. 2300.00+ G.S.T. Rs. 414.0 = 2714.00	02 Months	E.E., P.D., Hapur	S.E., BSR Circle, Bulandshahr	C.E., M.Z., Meerut	Road A/B/C
18	Special repair work of the remaining portion from Garh–Meerut Road to Mukimpur Road	62.75	5.14	Tender Cost- Rs. 2300.00+ G.S.T. Rs. 414.0 = 2714.00	02 Months	E.E., P.D., Hapur	S.E., BSR Circle, Bulandshahr	C.E., M.Z., Meerut	Road A/B/C
19	Special repair work from Jhadina Bridge to Saidpur Bridge canal patri road	52.90	4.65	Tender Cost- Rs. 2300.00+ G.S.T. Rs. 414.0 = 2714.00	02 Months	E.E., P.D., Hapur	S.E., BSR Circle, Bulandshahr	C.E., M.Z., Meerut	Road A/B/C
20	Special repair work of the double-cell box culvert on the Garh to Garhawali Road	45.25	4.26	Tender Cost- Rs. 2300.00+ G.S.T. Rs. 414.0 = 2714.00	02 Months	E.E., P.D., Hapur	S.E., BSR Circle, Bulandshahr	C.E., M.Z., Meerut	Road A/B/C
21	Special repair work from Buxar Ganga Canal to Vait link road	35.70	3.57	Tender Cost- Rs. 2300.00+ G.S.T. Rs. 414.0 = 2714.00	02 Months	E.E., P.D., Hapur	S.E., BSR Circle, Bulandshahr	C.E., M.Z., Meerut	Road A/B/C
22	Special repair work of the road from Km 18 of Modinagar–Hapur Road, starting from Badnauli Ki Madiya to the Temple Road	37.95	3.80	Tender Cost- Rs. 2300.00+ G.S.T. Rs. 414.0 = 2714.00	02 Months	E.E., P.D., Hapur	S.E., BSR Circle, Bulandshahr	C.E., M.Z., Meerut	Road A/B/C
23	Special repair work from Nidhawali Canal Bridge to Maharaj Garhi Road	44.25	4.21	Tender Cost- Rs. 2300.00+ G.S.T. Rs. 414.0 = 2714.00	02 Months	E.E., P.D., Hapur	S.E., BSR Circle, Bulandshahr	C.E., M.Z., Meerut	Road A/B/C
24	Special repair work from Samana to Jarcha Road to village Kapoopur Road	38.20	3.82	Tender Cost- Rs. 2300.00+ G.S.T. Rs. 414.0 = 2714.00	02 Months	E.E., P.D., Hapur	S.E., BSR Circle, Bulandshahr	C.E., M.Z., Meerut	Road A/B/C

3- The Bid Security and Tender Document Fee must be deposit through Internet Banking.
4- For the above works, it is mandatory to carry out maintenance work for 02 years from the date of completion of the work.
5- All registered contractors have to upload Turnover certified by C.A. of last 5 Year and details of maximum cost work satisfactorily completed in last 5 Years on Chanakya software before Submission of tender.
6- Details of e-tender uploaded on **https://etender.up.nic.in** shall also be uploaded on UPPWD Chanakya software, before last date & time of submission of bid.
7- Bidder has to upload required documents as per Government order No. 879(1) /23-7-2020 P.W. Anubhag-7 Lucknow Dt. 25.08.2020 for "Prahari Application" in Chanakya Software by accessing hyperlink available on **http://roc.uppwd.gov.in** for Tendering Process
8- Terms & Conditions related to bids are available on **https.//etender.up.nic.in**
9- In PWD technical evaluation of tenders is to be done by Prahari Software URL **http://wms.uppwd.gov.in/Prahari/**
10- The Additional performance security must be deposited as per the provisions contained in G.O. No. 86/2026/649/2026/23-7099/106/2025 dated 23.05.2026.

(Er.Shailendra Singh)
Executive Engineer
P.D. PWD Hapur

UPID-260597 Dt. 06/11/2026
www.upidadv.gov.in

(Er. Maneesh Verma)
Superintending Engineer,
Bulandshahr Circle, P.W.D.
Bulandshahr

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82(2)(ii) Cr.Pc

Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Nizam S/o Nisar** R/o D-1/675, JJ Colony Bhalswa, Delhi have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence under **FIR. No. 156/2009 u/s 380/454/34 IPC has been registered at P.S.Maurya Enclave, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said, **Nizam** namely cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, **Nizam** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, **Nizam** of under **FIR. No. 156/2009 u/s 380/454/34 IPC.** Registred at: **P.S. Maurya Enclave, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **09.12.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Anuradha Jindal
ACJM, Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/16136/NW/2026
(court notice)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Neeraj @ Badal, S/o. Sh. Tej Singh, R/o. C-8/396, Sultan Puri, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 261/2024 U/S 411 IPC** registered at **P.S Patel Nagar, Central District, New Delhi** and it has been returned on a warrant of arrest thereupon issued stating that the said accused **Neeraj @ Badal** could not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused **Neeraj @ Badal** is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Neeraj @ Badal**, accused of **FIR No. 261/2024 U/S 411 IPC, P.S Patel Nagar, Central District, New Delhi** is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before **08.12.2026.**

By Order, Ms. Shruti Chaudhary,
Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate
(West), Room No.145,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi.

DP/16133/CD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPc

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Mr. Rajeev Vij S/o Mr. Pawan Kumar Vij R/o C-4D / 47C, 2nd Floor, Janakpuri, New Delhi 110058** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **Ct. Cases/CC NI Act: 23233/16 U/S 138 NI Act, PS Hari Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Mr. Rajeev Vij** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Mr. Rajeev Vij** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Mr. Rajeev Vij** of **Ct. Cases/CC NI Act: 23233/16 U/S 138 NI Act, PS Hari Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **09.12.2026.**

By Order,
Gaurav Singal
Judicial Magistrate First Class (NI Act) - 04
West District, Room No. 4 (ANNEX-I)
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/16107/WD/2026(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

SEE SECTION 84 BHARTIYA NAGARIK SURKSHA SANHITA

Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Anil @ Tony S/o** Dalip **R/o** H.No. A-43, Rajeev Nagar Extn., Begampur, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to has committed) the offence under **FIR No. 386/2015 U/s 392/411/341 IPC.**, has been registered at **PS: Begumpur, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said, **Anil @ Tony** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, **Anil @ Tony** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, **Anil @ Tony** of under **FIR No. 386/2015 U/s 392/411/341 IPC.**, Registered at **PS: Begumpur, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or **08.12.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Anuradha Jindal
North-West, Room No - 101
1st Floor, Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/16056/RD/2026
(Court Notice)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPc / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Jitender @ Jittu S/o Late Khoob Singh R/o H. No. E-32, Gali No. 3, Budh Vihar, Dharambir Market, Badarpur, New Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No. 72/2020 U/S 25/54/59 Arms Act, PS Badarpur, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Jitender @ Jittu** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Jitender @ Jittu** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Jitender @ Jittu** of **FIR No. 72/2020 U/S 25/54/59 Arms Act, PS Badarpur, New Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **18.12.2026.**

By Order,
Shri Vinod Joshi
Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate
South East District Court No. 515,
Saket Courts, New Delhi

DP/15945/SE/2026(Court Matter)

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA

OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER, NORTHERN (R&B) CIRCLE SAMBALPUR

34001/1116/2627

Mail ID: - sepwdsbp@rediffmail.com

e - Procurement

BID IDENTIFICATION No CCENC (R AND B)/08/2026-27
No: 4136 /Dtd. 29.10.2026

1. The **Chief Construction Engineer, Northern (R&B) Circle, Sambalpur** on behalf of Governor of Odisha invites **Percentage Rate** bids in double cover system in **ONLINE MODE** for the construction of **Building Work** as detailed in the DTCN from the eligible class of contractors.
2. No of works = 01 **(ONE) (BUILDING Work)**
3. Tender Cost: **Rs. 10,000/-**
4. Class of contractor: **"B" Class & "A" Class**
5. Date & Time of available in web site & receipt of Bids From **10.11.2026 to 17.00 Hours of 26.11.2026.**
6. Date of opening of Technical Bid **27.11.2026 at 11.00 Hours.**
7. The Bidders have to participate in **ONLINE** bidding only. Further details can be seen from the website **www.tendersodisha.gov.in.**
8. Any corrigendum / Addendum will be displayed in the website **www.tendersodisha.gov.in.**

Sd/-
Chief Construction Engineer
Northern (R&B) Circle, Sambalpur

OIPR-34001/34035/1/26-27/0007

Veermata Jijabai Technological Institute (VJTI), Matunga, Mumbai – 400019

Notice Inviting Tender

"Repair and renovation work for Classrooms AL-002 and AL-003, Ground Floor, Electrical Engineering Department, VJTI, Mumbai." with an estimated cost of **Rs. 22,67,469/-**. from eligible contractors having experience in this type of work.

The blank tender forms are available on the Maha Tender website. https://mahatenders.gov.in

The interested tenderers are requested to download the entire tender document from the Maha Tenders website. The last date of submission of the E-Tender document duly filled in shall be 21st November 2026 up to 5.00 p.m.

For further details, please see the detailed tender notice on the Maha Tender website.

The right to reject any or all tenders without assigning any reason thereof will be with the competent authority of VJTI.

Registrar,
VJTI, Matunga, Mumbai.19

Veermata Jijabai Technological Institute (VJTI), Matunga, Mumbai – 400019

Notice Inviting Tender

"Comprehensive Housekeeping Services for Academic, Hostel, and Overall, Campus Premises of VJTI, Matunga, Mumbai." with an estimated cost of **Rs. 3,48,27,729.09/-**. from eligible contractors having experience in this type of work.

The blank tender forms are available on the Maha Tender website. https://mahatenders.gov.in

The interested tenderers are requested to download the entire tender document from the Maha Tenders website. The last date of submission of the E-Tender document duly filled in shall be 25th November 2026 up to 5.00 p.m.

For further details, please see the detailed tender notice on the Maha Tender website.

The right to reject any or all tenders without assigning any reason thereof will be with the competent authority of VJTI.

Registrar,
VJTI, Matunga, Mumbai.19

INTEGRAL COACH FACTORY

Tender Notice No. ICF/PCMM/EOT/45/2026 Dated: 06.11.2026

The following e-tenders are published in IREPS website. Firms are requested to login to **www.ireps.gov.in** and quote against these tenders. Manual quotations will not be entertained for these tenders. Closing and Opening time for all tenders are **14.15 hrs.** Hindi version of tender notice is available on website **www.icf.indianrailways.gov.in**

Sl. No.	Tender No.	Tender Title	Quantity	Due Date / Time
01	02261938B	KIT ITEMS FOR UNDER FRAME FRAME WORK	8 SETS	13/11/2026
02	03262560	SAFETY WIRE ROPE FOR BRAKE BEAM	17787 NOS	13/11/2026
03	03262530	S.SHEET SIZE 16X2500X3800 MM	30632 KGS	23/11/2026
04	08261412A	S&I CABLE TRAYS 3PH EMU-DHC-BT	7 SETS	23/11/2026
05	06262981	SUPPLY OF VESTIBULE SLIDING DOOR FOR LHB	1506 SETS	23/11/2026
06	06261847	SNI HEAT ARRGT PLUMBING MEMU USB	24 SETS	24/11/2026
07	03262575	TOP BUSH EMU/M	208 NOS	24/11/2026
08	08262078	MONO BLOCK PUMP VB SLEEPER	178 SETS	25/11/2026
09	02262316	C/S OF BODY SHELL ITEMS AND WELDING PARTS ON TROUGH FLOOR	132 SETS	25/11/2026
10	06262376	SUPPLY OF WET ON WET MODIFIED EXTERIOR PAINTING SYSTEM	763 SETS	26/11/2026
11	08261691A	HEAT SHRINKABLE TUBING LHB NON AC	876 SETS	26/11/2026
12	08261939	SET OF CAGE CLAMP TERMINALS RCF CC 72069	4700 NOS	01/12/2026

CORRIGENDUM No. 45

Corrigendum has been issued to the following tender. Please check IREPS website for further details.

Sl. No	Tender No.	Existing value	Modified value
01	02260164	02/11/2026	**17/11/2026**
		Item Description Modified and Additions and Deletions of Drawings and SPEC. Please refer Tender Document for details in IREPS website.	
02	02262083	06/11/2026	17/11/2026
03	03262435	06/11/2026	**13/11/2026**
		Additions and Deletions of Drawings & SPEC and Technical Clarification. Please refer Tender Document for details in IREPS website.	
04	03262333	04/11/2026	**16/11/2026**
05	03261954	05/11/2026	**12/11/2026**
		Additions and Deletions of Drawings & SPEC. Please refer Tender Document for details in IREPS website.	
06	07261935	02/11/2026	11/11/2026

SALUTE THE SOLDIER

BORDER SECURITY FORCE



CONSTABLE MEHAR SINGH, PMG 132 BN BSF 16.10.1969 – 08.11.1998

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Constable Mehar Singh on his Balidan Diwas. On 07th Nov 1998, he sustained fatal bullet injuries while fighting militants in area of Kalakote, Rajouri (J&K) and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty on 08th Nov 1998. His sacrifice and gallant action have been aptly recognized by GOI by awarding him with PMG (Posthumously).



CONSTABLE CHITRANJAN DEBBARMA 107 BN BSF 05.01.1971 – 08.11.1992

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Constable Chitranjan Debbarma on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained fatal bullet injuries in a fierce encounter with militants in Srinagar area, J&K and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty.



CONSTABLE SUDIP SARKAR, KIRTI CHAKRA 169 BN BSF 14.07.1982 – 08.11.2020

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Constable Sudip Sarkar on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained fatal bullet injuries in Counterpart firing in Kupwara area, J&K and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty. His sacrifice and gallant action have been aptly recognized by GOI by awarding him with Kirti Chakra (Posthumously).



CCONSTABLE CHANDER PRAKASH, PMG 172 BN BSF 24.01.1970 – 08.11.1998

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Constable Chander Prakash on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained fatal bullet injuries while fighting militants in Handwara area, J&K and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty. His sacrifice and gallant action have been aptly recognized by GOI by awarding him with PMG (Posthumously).



CONSTABLE SUSHIS BISWAS 73 BN BSF 05.01.1982 – 08.11.2013



CONSTABLE PAPPU KUMAR YADAV 73 BN BSF 10.12.1991 – 08.11.2013

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawans Constables Sushis Biswas and Pappu Kumar Yadav on their Balidan Diwas. On this day, they sustained fatal bullet injuries while fighting militants in area of BOP Kaithakona, Meghalaya and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty.

CENTRAL RESERVE POLICE FORCE



Veer Balidani Head Constable Joginder Singh 33 Bn 15-2-1945 To 8-11-1989

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Head Constable Joginder Singh of 33 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice after sustaining grievous injuries while valiantly countering an attack by terrorists on 8 November 1989 in Tarn Taran district of Punjab. CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

LATE NB SUB KARNAIL SINGH



In proud memory of Nb Sub Karnail Singh of 6th Battalion The Dogra Regiment, who made the supreme sacrifice while serving the Nation at Tangdhar (J&K) under Operation RAKSHAK on 08 Nov 2014. Your act of valour, raw courage & devotion to duty will always remain a source of inspiration and motivation to all of us.

LATE SEP KULDEEP KUMAR



In proud memory of Sep Kuldeep Kumar of 6th Battalion The Dogra Regiment, who made the supreme sacrifice while serving the Nation at Kishtwar (J&K) under Operation RAKSHAK on 08 Nov 2003. Your act of valour, raw courage & devotion to duty will always remain a source of inspiration and motivation to all of us.

"**BRAVES DIE, BUT ONLY ONCE**"

Remembered by Commanding Officer and All Ranks 6 DOGRA.

"IMPORTANT"

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Government of Jammu and Kashmir
Agriculture Production Department
Civil Secretariat, Jammu/Srinagar

Subject: Inviting applications for the position of Vice-Chancellor, Sher-e-Kashmir University of Agricultural Sciences and Technology, Kashmir.

The Hon'ble Lieutenant Governor of Jammu & Kashmir has constituted a Selection Committee for recommending a panel of suitable aspirants for the position of Vice Chancellor, Sher-e-Kashmir University of Agricultural Sciences and Technology, Kashmir (J&K). **The position is to be filled up on tenure basis for a period not exceeding 03 years or attainment of 65 years of age, whichever is earlier. Aspirants for this position should not be more than 62 years of age as on the closing date of application.**

The committee invites applications from eminent agricultural scientists with outstanding credentials and also solicits appropriate nominations from renowned personalities of eligible candidates fulfilling the following criteria:

I. **Essential Qualifications and Experience:**

1. A distinguished scientist or academician with Doctor of Philosophy degree in Agriculture/Veterinary or related fields.
2. More than 10 years of experience in the grade of professor or equivalent position in any academic organization of repute.
3. Administrative experience of atleast 3 years in handling affairs of any university or a national institution as Dean/Joint Director/Director or equivalent.

Or

05 years experience at the level of Head of the Department/Division or equivalent position in any academic organization of repute.

4. Minimum of 20 research publications in peer-reviewed national/international journals including books.
5. Demonstrated experience in leadership.

II. **Desirable Experience:**

1. Good understanding of financial management including revenue generation, planning and fiscal control.
2. Demonstrable success in developing and executing National and International collaborative arrangements.
3. Experience of working in Statutory Authorities of a university such as Board of Studies/Academic Council/ Executive Council/Board of Management.
4. Experience of handling accreditation procedures, quality assessment and guiding students for Masters' and PhD.
5. Experience of international exposure through participation in meetings, workshops, seminars, or conferences held outside the country.

III. **Mode of Application and General Conditions:**

1. Applications received through e-mail only, from eligible candidates shall be entertained and considered for further processing. Such applications should reach by or before **27th November, 2026** to:

Dr. Sahil Jandyal, JKAS
Additional Secretary to the Government,
Agriculture Production Department,
Civil Secretariat, J&K
E-mail : sahiljandyal.kas@jk.gov.in

2. The CV/Bio-data must contain general information (name, present position/ post last held, date of birth, address for correspondence, e-mail ID and contact/mobile number), educational qualifications, area of specialization, service details (including date of appointment as Professor/equivalent), administrative posts held, publications, number of persons guided for Post-Graduation & Ph.D degree along with relevant supporting certificates/documents.
3. Applications received after the last date shall not be entertained.
4. The selection committee reserves the right to call only shortlisted candidates for personal interaction, out of the applicants, based on the suitability of the applicants for the position.
5. The committee reserves the right to withdraw the position or cancel the advertisement without assigning any reason.
6. Canvassing or influencing the members of selection committee will lead to disqualification.
7. Incomplete applications will be summarily rejected.
8. The details are also available on the official website: apd.jk.gov.in for ready reference.

Sd/-
Shailendra Kumar, IAS
Financial Commissioner
(Additional Chief Secretary)
Agriculture Production Department, J&K UT
(Convener, Selection Committee)

No: Agri-SKST/18/2021 (CC. 23973) Dated: 06.11.2026
DIP/J-13968/26-DATE 07 NOV 2026

कार्यालय अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, यांत्रिक मण्डल, उत्तराखण्ड पेयजल संसाधन विकास एवं निर्माण निगम

हरिद्वार उत्तराखण्ड–249401, Ph. No. 01334-292995, E-mail:- semechharidwar@gmail.com

पत्रांक:– 214/निविदा/62 **// ई- निविदा सूचना //** दिनांक:– 05.11.2026

निम्नलिखित कार्यों हेतु अर्ह फर्मों से ई-निविदा पोर्टल www.uktenders.gov.in पर निम्न विवरणानुसार आमंत्रित की जाती है:–

क्र0 सं0	कार्य का विवरण	निविदा प्रपत्र की लागत (रू0 में) जीएसटी0 सहित	धरोहर धनराशि (रू0 में)	कार्य की अवधि
1	जनपद पौड़ी गढ़वाल की बिंडोली पम्पिंग पेयजल योजना के इन्टेक वैल पम्पिंग स्टेशन पर पम्पिंग प्लान्ट की आपूर्ति अधिष्ठापन, कमीशनिंग एवं टेस्टिंग का कार्य।	2360.00	58000.00	03 माह

1. पोर्टल पर ई–निविदा उपलब्ध कराने की तिथि/समय :– 06.11.2026 समय 16:00 बजे तक।
2. ई–निविदा को अपलोड करने की अन्तिम तिथि/समय :– 21.11.2026 समय 17:00 बजे तक।
3. पी–बिड मीटिंग की तिथि/समय:– 12.11.2026 समय 14:00 बजे स्थान:– कार्यालय अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, यांत्रिक मण्डल, उत्तराखण्ड पेयजल निगम, हरिद्वार।
4. EMD सम्बन्धी प्रपत्र जमा करने की अन्तिम तिथि दिनांक –23.11.2026 समय 17:00 बजे तक।
5. तकनीकी बिड खुलने की तिथि/समय :– 25.11.2026 समय 11:00 बजे, स्थान: कार्यालय अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, यांत्रिक मण्डल, उत्तराखण्ड पेयजल निगम, हरिद्वार।

विस्तृत जानकारी के लिए www.uktenders.gov.in पर लॉग–इन करें

अधीक्षण अभियन्ता

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

See Section 82 Cr. P.C. / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Shamim S/o Shaheed R/o Village Bawla, P.S. Tauru, Distt. Nuh, Mewat, Haryana** has Committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 47/2020 U/s 186/353/307/34 IPC & 25/27 Arms Act, P.S. Maidan Garhi, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Shamim** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Shamim** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Shamim** of case **FIR No. 47/2020 U/s 186/353/307/34 IPC & 25/27 Arms Act, P.S. Maidan Garhi, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **18.12.2026.**

By Order
Sh. Samar Vishal
Additional Sessions Judge-02
South, Court No. 303
Saket Courts, New Delhi

DP/16084/SD/2026 (Court Matter)

UP Rajya Vidyut Utpadan Nigam Ltd.

HARDUAGANJ THERMAL POWER STATION KASIMPUR (ALIGARH)

E-GEM Tender Notice Date 07.11.2026

Tender Notice and scope of work

SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER, MATERIAL MANAGEMENT CIRCLE, KASIMPUR

1. **ET-11/MMC/PD-II/HTPS/2026,** Procurement of Corrugated galvanized steel sheets, hard wood blocks and tirpal required during OH of unit 10, TMD ETPS HTPS Kasimpur (Aligarh), Uttar Pradesh, Tender Cost: Rs. 590.00, EMD Rs.13000.00 , Estimated Cost: Rs. 690203.88, E-Tender ID: 2026_RVUNL_1203535_1)

Last Date of uploading Date: 30.11.2026

SE, O&MC-IV, DTPS, Kasimpur

2. **GeM E-Bid No - GEM/2026/B/8244385,** Maintenance of HT and LT Switch Gears Including Electrical Maintenance of ESP of 1x110MW, CTPS, HTPS Kasimpur (Aligarh). Estimated Cost: Rs. 3863137 + GST, EMD-40000.00, GEM TenderID: GEM/2026/B/8244385

Last Date of uploading Date: 17.11.2026

Note- For information regarding Addendum/corrigendum/Rejection of Bids kindly regularly visit website **https://etender.up.nic.in** and **https://gem.nic.in**

पत्रांक: 57/अधी0अभि0(मु0)/विज्ञापन/कैम्प–1(56)/26 Date: 07/11/2026

"Save Electricity for Nation"

DEBTS RECOVERY TRIBUNAL DEHRADUN

Paras Tower, 2nd Floor, Majra Niranjanpur, Saharanpur Road, Dehradun

Notice for Settling a Sale Proclamation under the Recovery of Debts & Bankruptcy Act, 1993

R.C. No. 273/2024 **Date: 21.10.2026**

Central Bank of India V/s Anchal Kumar & Ors.

To,

CD No. 1. Anchal Kumar S/o Sh. Kunwar Pal, R/o H.No. 2C Punjabi Bagh, Saharanpur, Uttar Pradesh- 247001.
CD No. 2. Smt. Sunita Devi D/o Sh. Mahindra Singh C/o Sh. Anchal Kumar, R/o H.No. 2C Punjabi Bagh, Saharanpur, Uttar Pradesh- 247001.
CD No. 3. Smt. Sushil Kumar S/o Sh. Purushottam Singh, R/o 2C/45, Gangapuram Colony, Hakikat Nagar, Saharanpur- 247001, Uttar Pradesh.
CD No. 4. Smt. Shivlesh Devi W/o Sh. Sushil Kumar, R/o H.No. 2C Punjabi Bagh, Saharanpur, Uttar Pradesh- 247001.

Whereas (C.D.) have failed to pay the dues of Rs 39,53,716.56 (Rupees Thirty Nine Lakhs Fifty Three Thousand Seven Hundred Sixteen And Paise Fifty Six Only) as on 10.08.2026 payable by (C.D) in respect of Certificate No. RC/273/2024.

Whereas you the was ordered by the Presiding Officer of DEBTS RECOVERY TRIBUNAL DEHRADUN who had issued the Recovery Certificate dated 07.08.2024 in OA/165/2024 to pay to the Applicant Bank(s)/Financial Institution(s) Central Bank of India, the sum of Rs 30,77,202.42 (Rupees Thirty Lakhs Seventy Seven Thousand Two Hundred Two and Paise Forty Two Only) along with pendent-lite and future interest @ 9.60% simple interest yearly w.e.f. 13.01.2024 till realization and costs of Rs 33,005/- (Rupees Thirty Three Thousand Five Only), and whereas the said has not been paid, the undersigned has ordered the sale of under mentioned immovable / Immoveable property.

You are hereby informed that the 07.01.2027 at 10.30 A.M. has been fixed for drawing up the proclamation of sale and settling the terms thereof. You are requested to bring to the notice of the undersigned any encumbrances, charges, claims or liabilities attached to the said properties or any portion thereof.

Specification of property

Registered mortgage of land admeasuring 96.62 sq. mtrs. situated at Plot No.33, Khata No. 148/3, Shekhpura Kadeem, Dar Abadi Ganga Puram, (Ganga Colony) Saharanpur, Uttar Pradesh.

Given under my hand and the seal of the Tribunal, on this date: 21.10.2026.

Recovery Officer
Debts Recovery Tribunal Dehradun

झारखण्ड सरकार
झारखण्ड खेल प्राधिकरण
(पर्यटन, कला, संस्कृति, खेलकूद एवं युवा कार्य विभाग)
गेट सं०–२३, बिरसा मुण्डा फुटबॉल स्टेडियम, मोराबादी, राँची–834008

Email : - sajha9@gmail.com, Website :- www.sajha.in

आवश्यक सूचना

आ०सू०सं० : 17
दिनांक : 07/11/2026

एतत् द्वारा सूचित किया जाता है कि झारखण्ड खेल प्राधिकरण अन्तर्गत सेंटर ऑफ एक्सीलेन्स (एकलव्य केन्द्र) हेतु Physiotherapist के 07, Nutritionist के 04, Masseur के 09 एवं Warden के 11 पदों पर संविदा आधारित नियुक्ति हेतु प्रकाशित विज्ञापन संख्या –73, दिनांक –30.12.2025 (PR No. -369806) के विरूद्ध योग्य उम्मीदवारों का दस्तावेज सत्यापन एवं साक्षात्कार दिनांक 29.10.2026 एवं 30.10.2026 को आहूत किया गया था। तदोपरान्त उक्त पदों पर साक्षात्कार समिति द्वारा अनुशंसित एवं अंतिम रूप से सफल उम्मीदवारों की सूची झारखण्ड खेल प्राधिकरण के आधिकारिक वेबसाईट www.sajha.in तथा https://jharkhandsports.in पर देखा जा सकता है।

ह०/–
कार्यकारी निदेशक,
झारखण्ड खेल प्राधिकरण

PR 393594Art Culture Sports and Youth Affairs(26-27) D"

Jharkhand Education Project Council
J.S.C.A Stadium Road, Jagannathpur, Sector -3,
Dhurwa, Ranchi - 834004
Phone - 0651-2444502, E-mail: jepcranchi1@gmail.com

Tender Notice

Printing and Supply of Notebooks (copy) for Class I to VIII under School Kit Scheme for 2027-28

Tender No: MRE/33/307/2026-27/4440

Jharkhand Education Project Council (JEPC), Ranchi invites e-bids in two bids system (Technical & Financial) from reputed and eligible printers for the printing and supply of notebooks (copy) for class 1 to 8 for the academic year 2027-28. Important dates/details are as under:

Sl. No.	Activity	Start Date	Time	End Date	Time
1	Online availability of bid document	07.11.2026	11.00 pm	30.11.2026	03.00 pm
2	Pre-Bid Meeting	18.11.2026	03.00 pm	-	-
3	**Online Bid Submission**	07.11.2026	11.00 pm	30.11.2026	03.00 pm
4	Submission of Paper sample	30.11.2026	11.00 am	01.12.2026	01.00 pm
5	Opening of Technical Bid	01.12.2026	03.00 pm	-	-

Interested bidders may view and download bid documents from the website http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in.

Sd/-
(Shashi Ranjan)
State Project Director

PR 393536 Jharkhand Education Project Council(26-27).D

S. E. RAILWAY – TENDER

Tender Notice No.: e-Tender/2026/39. For and on behalf of President of India, the Divisional Railway Manager (Engg.), South Eastern Railway, Kharagpur-721301 invites e-tender for the following works **before 15.00 hrs.** on the date mentioned against items and will be **opened at 15.30 hrs. Sl.No.**-1. **Tender No.: E-KGP-South-44-2026. Description of work:** Provision of drainage arrangement (Balance work) at West side of Balasore station under ADEN/Balasore. **Tender Value:** ₹ 5,96,10,852.39. **Earnest Money:** ₹ 11,92,200. **Date of Opening:** 19.11.2026. **Sl.No.**-2. **Tender No.: E-KGP-East-64-2026. Description of work:** Santragachi-Amta - Closure of four MLCs (HA-5, HA-8, HA-19 & HA-26) & one UMLC (HA-25) by providing a connecting road under Sr. DEN/East/Kharagpur. **Tender Value:** ₹ 8,75,68,983.86. **Earnest Money:** ₹ 17,51,400. **Date of Opening:** 20.11.2026. **Sl.No.**-3. **Tender No.: E-KGP-East-60-2026. Description of work:** Execution of P-Way works Kharagpur Division - FS+TWS+WCMSC - 17 Sets & DS - 8 Sets, WCMSC - 6 Sets & TTR(TSR) - 17 Sets. (2) Santragachi: Removal of defective layout by conversion of 1 in 8.5 X-over to 1 in 12 of Pt. no. 223A & 223B & shifting of X-over no. 207A/B. (3) TWSEJ- 52 nos. & Glued joint - 351 nos. (4) CTR(P)- 1.122 Tkm. (5) Howrah-Kharagpur - TSR(P) - 1.874 Tkm & Howrah-Amta - TSR(P) - 7.681 Tkm. (6) Tikiapara, Santragachi & Bauria: Conversion of Diamond Xings from 52kg to 60 kg. (7) Howrah-Kharagpur - TBR - 16.354 Tkm under the jurisdiction of Sr.DEN/East/Kharagpur (2nd Call). **Tender Value:** ₹ 6,30,53,628. **Earnest Money:** ₹ 12,61,100. **Date of Opening:** 26.11.2026. **Sl.No.**-4. **Tender No.: E-KGP-HQ-58-2026. Description of work:** Execution of the work of Standardization of different type of Engineering Indicators, Boards, Post on track in Panskura-Haldia and Tamluk-Digha section under the jurisdiction of Sr. DEN/HQ/Kharagpur. **Tender Value:** ₹ 2,43,63,768.41. **Earnest Money:** ₹ 4,87,300. **Date of Opening:** 26.11.2026. **Sl.No.**-5. **Tender No.: E-KGP-HQ-59-2026. Description of work:** Miscellaneous repair works to toilets, Doctor's chambers, Wards, upgradation of Physiotherapy unit, Parking Area, Removed Cycle stand area including Doctor's parking space, Acoustic panel Installation in auditorium of Divisional Railway Hospital, Kharagpur and wall paneling work in hall room of S.B. 03, extension of boundary wall besides Bungalow no. 633 under the jurisdiction of ADEN/Settlement/Kharagpur. **Tender Value:** ₹ 84,28,756.99. **Earnest Money:** ₹ 1,68,600. **Date of Opening:** 26.11.2026. **Sl.No.**-6. **Tender No.: E-KGP-HQ-60-2026. Description of work:** Execution of the work of (i) Through Sleeper Renewal (TSR) Primary (P) of 27.353 TKm in Tamluk - Digha section (ii) Through Sleeper Renewal (TSR) Primary (P) of 6.978 TKm in Panskura - Haldia section and (iii) Through Rail Renewal (TRR) Primary (P) of 13.711 TKm in Panskura - Haldia section under the jurisdiction of Sr.DEN/HQ/Kharagpur. **Tender Value:** ₹ 13,16,58,314.29. **Earnest Money:** ₹ 26,33,200. **Date of Opening:** 26.11.2026. **Tender Document Cost:** ₹ 0 (for all). **Completion period of the work:** 12 months (for all). **Bidding start date:** From 05.11.2026 and up to 15.00 hrs. on 19.11.2026 (for Sl.No. 1), from 06.11.2026 and up to 15.00 hrs. on 20.11.2026 (for Sl.No. 2) & from 12.11.2026 and up to 15.00 hrs. on 26.11.2026 (for Sl.No. 3 to 6) . Interested tenderers may visit website **www.ireps.gov.in** for full details/ descriptions/specification of the tenders and submit their bids online. In no case manual tender for these works will be accepted. **N.B.:** Prospective bidders may regularly visit **www.ireps.gov.in** to participate in all tenders. **(PR-988)**

UTTAR PRADESH POWER CORPORATION LIMITED
Shakti Bhawan, 14-Ashok Marg, Lucknow
CIN: U32201UP1999SGC024928

Extracts of Standalone Financial Results

for the quarter ended 30th September, 2026

[Regulation 52 (8), read with Regulation 52 (4), of the SEBI (LODR) Regulations, 2015]

(₹ Crore)

S. NO.	Particulars	Quarter ended 30th Sep, 2026 Un-audited	Quarter ended 30th Sep, 2025 Un-audited	Year ended 31st March, 2026 Audited
1	**Total Income from Operations**	24,158.97	23,316.72	84,438.18
2	Net Profit/(loss) for the period (before Tax, Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	148.62	1,360.74	(8,714.86)
3	Net Profit/ (loss) for the period before tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	148.62	1,360.74	(8,727.29)
4	Net Profit/ (loss) for the period after tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	148.62	1,360.74	(8,727.29)
5	Total comprehensive Income for the period [Comprising Profit/(Loss) for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax))	148.62	1,360.06	(8,723.79)
6	Paid up Equity Share capital (Face value of ₹ 1000/- per share)	163,578.59	149,889.13	157,334.80
7	Other Equity	(126,532.45)	(114,602.67)	(117,023.83)
8	Securities Premium Account	NA	NA	NA
9	Net worth	36,702.45	31,396.89	37,160.93
10	Outstanding Debt	44,471.07	53,075.49	48,091.86
11	Outstanding redeemable preference shares	NA	NA	NA
12	Debt Equity Ratio	1.21	1.69	1.29
13	Earning per share (of ₹ 1000/- each) (for continuing and discontinued operations) Basic / Diluted	0.92 / 0.91	9.12 / 9.02	(57.81) / (57.81)
14	Capital Redemption Reserves	NA	NA	NA
15	Debenture Redemption Reserves	NA	NA	NA
16	Debt Service Coverage Ratio	(0.001)	(0.001)	(0.004)
17	Interest Service Coverage Ratio	0.14	1.02	(1.68)

Note 1 The above results have been reviewed by the audit committee of the Board of Directors in the meeting held on 6th November, 2026 and approved by the Board of Directors in their meeting held on the same day.

Note 2 The above is an extract of the detailed format of Quarterly Financial Results filed with the Stock Exchange (BSE Limited) under Regulation 52 of SEBI (LODR) Regulations, 2015. The detailed format is available on the website of BSE Limited and the company's website at www.uppcl.org

Note 3 Additional information/other line items persuant to Regulation 52(4) of the SEBI (LODR) 2015, have been disclosed in the detailed Quarterly Financial Results filed with the stock exchange (BSE Limited) and can be accessed on the website of BSE Limited and the company's website www.uppcl.org

Note 4 The figures/ratios for the previous periods have been restated, regrouped/reclassified wherever necessary to conform to current period classification.

For & on the behalf of Board of Directors
Sd/-
(Nitin Nijhawan)
Compliance Officer

Date: 06th Nov, 2026
Place: Lucknow

संख्या 20 ज.स./पाकालि./ ज.स./2026, दिनांक 07/11/2026

कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय
पेयजल एवं स्वच्छता प्रमण्डल सं०-1 गिरिडीह
E-mail : eedwsd.giridih1@gmail.com

पत्रांक :– 1292 दिनांक – 04.11.2026

शुद्धि पत्र

एतद् द्वारा सूचित किया जाता है कि पेयजल एवं स्वच्छता प्रमण्डल संख्या–01, गिरिडीह के अंतर्गत आमंत्रित ई–प्रोक्योरमेन्ट निविदा सूचना सं०– DWSD/Cluster/GIRIDIH-1/SBD/24/2026-27 (1st Call) दिनांक 26.10.2026 जिसका PR No- 392548 (Drinking Water and Sanitation) 26-27D है, जिसे अपरिहार्य कारणों से निविदा की तिथियों (कंडिका 2, 3, 4 एवं 5) एवं Tender Reference Call में निम्न प्रकार से संशोधन किया जाता है :–

क्र0	विवरण	पूर्व में प्रकाशित	संशोधित
1	Tender Reference No.	DWSD/Cluster/GIRIDIH-1/SBD/24/2026-27 (1st Call)	DWSD/Cluster/GIRIDIH-1/SBD/24/2026-27 (3rd Call)
2	वेबसाईट पर निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि	30-10-2026 at 02:00 P.M.	18-11-2026 at 02:00 P.M.
3	निविदा प्राप्ति (ऑनलाईन बिडींग) की अंतिम तिथि एवं समय	13-11-2026 at 02:00 P.M.	02-12-2026 at 02:00 P.M.
4	सरकार के सचिव, सूचना प्रौद्योगिकी एवं ई–गवर्नेंस, झारखण्ड मंत्रालय के ज्ञापांक 120 दिनांक 03.10.2023 के आलोक में विपत्र का मूल्य एवं अग्रधन की राशि ऑनलाईन जमा करने की अंतिम तिथि एवं समय	13-11-2026 at 02:00 P.M.	02-12-2026 at 02:00 P.M.
5	बिड खोलने की तिथि/समय	14-11-2026 at 2:00 P.M.	03-12-2026 at 2:00 P.M.
6	प्री–बीड बैठक का स्थान एवं तिथि	क्षेत्रीय मुख्य अभियंता का कार्यालय, पेयजल एवं स्वच्छता विभाग दुमका प्रक्षेत्र, दुमका। दिनांक 06-11-2026 at 12:30 P.M.	क्षेत्रीय मुख्य अभियंता का कार्यालय, पेयजल एवं स्वच्छता विभाग दुमका प्रक्षेत्र, दुमका। दिनांक 25-11-2026 at 12:30 P.M.

नोट :– (1.) निविदा की अन्य कंडिका, नियम एवं शर्तें यथावत रहेंगे।
(2.) यह शुद्धि–पत्र परिमाण विपत्र का भाग होगा।

कार्यपालक अभियंता,
पेयजल एवं स्वच्छता प्रमण्डल
संख्या–01, गिरिडीह

PR 393550 Drinking Water and Sanitation (26-27)_D

BRIDGE

Dealer: West **Vulnerable:** None

NORTH	SOUTH
♠ Q832	♠ AJ1094
❤ 632	❤ AK7
♦ Q10	♦ 942
♣ J852	♣ J852

SOUTH	WEST	NORTH	EAST
	1♦	pass	1❤
dbl	2❤	pass	pass
2♠	3♦	3♠	pass
3NT	pass		

West leads the king, ace and jack of diamonds; East plays the five and then the three. Plan the play. Faced with four sure side-suit losers, South must avoid losing a trump trick. Unless the king of spades is singleton (only a small chance), South must finesse.

The bidding and early play mark East with two diamonds and four hearts. So, South can force an entry to dummy for the trump finesse by discarding a heart from dummy on the third round of diamonds, a loser-on-loser play.

Later, declarer enters dummy with a heart ruff to lead spades.

THE WEST HAND
♠ ❤Q106 ♦ AKJ876 ♣K1043

THE SOUTH HAND
♠ K765 ❤ J854 ♦ 53 ♣ Q95

Care must be taken in finessing trumps to retain the lead twice in dummy in case of a four-zero split. Declarer can lead the eight (playing his own four), then the queen; or, declarer can begin with dummy's queen (playing a middle spade from the closed hand), then the spade eight.

If West leads a fourth round of diamonds, South should ruff in dummy, discarding his losing club unless East overruffs.

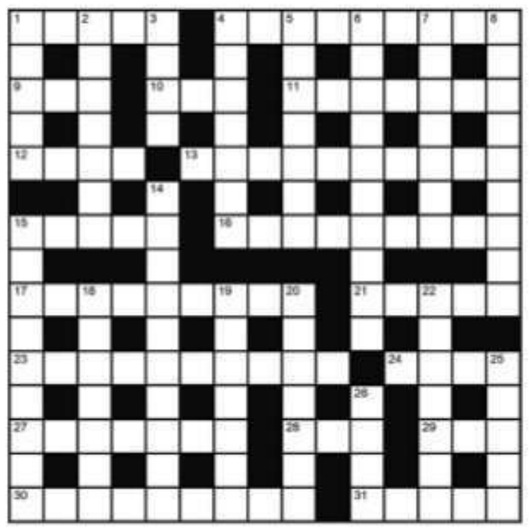
Dealer: South Vulnerable: Both North

NORTH	SOUTH
♠ 642	♠ AQ3
❤ 862	❤ KQJ
♦ K94	♦ A32
♣ KJ109	♣ A742

SOUTH	WEST	NORTH	EAST
1❤	1♠	3❤	pass
4❤	pass	pass	pass

West leads the king of diamonds. Plan the play.

SUNDAY CROSSWORD 2607



QUICK CLUES

ACROSS
1. Legal (5)
4. Just miss a target ? (4,5)
9. Last letter of the alphabet (3)
10. Little bit (3)
11. Delays (5,2)
12. Cry out loudly (4)
13. Enterprise (10)
15. Ski run (5)
16. Consciousness (9)
17. Protein building block (9)
21. Chilly (5)
23. Thrifty (10)
24. Mont Blanc range (4)
27. Court attendant (7)
28. The Big Apple (3)
29. Fiji island (3)
30. With very clear vision (5-4)
31. Deep gruff sound (5)

DOWN
1. Flashy or showy (5)
2. Sieves (7)
3. A great deal (4)
4. Virtuoso passage (7)
5. __ Gandhi : Father of the Nation ? (7)
6. Pledged security (10)
7. Rain __ __ : fair weather or foul ? (2,5)
8. Voiced (9)
14. Decolor (10)
15. Tranquil (9)
18. Pressing to remove the creases ? (7)
19. Primarily (7)
20. Spent (7)
22. Renaissance astronomer (7)
25. Powdered tobacco (5)
26. Flat-bottomed boat (4)

CRYPTIC CLUES

ACROSS
1. Such a vocalist is the source of a storm ? (5)
4. For my sins, that's what I do be doing with these crosswords (9)
9. Half a dozen that belong to Violet (3)
10. The place that gave us deep dish, years ago. (3)
11. One of a group knocked down in an alley (7)
12. Takes something the wrong way (4)
13. Chinese soup ingredients that may include eggs (5,5)
15. Republican blocks unconvincing cause (5)
16. Strength of a hefty blow ? (4,5)
17. Be prone to ambush (3,2,4)
21. Possibly having a drink on them, lacks steadiness (5)
23. Possibly Potterkin getting screened at sea (10)
24. Poker boss (4)
27. Actress seen to rip paper up (7)
28. Girl returned the diamond ! (3)
29. Morning figure for a type of contract (3)
30. Get your paper here! Amphibious creature seizes steamship; a number dead (9)
31. Manufacturer right below form (5)

DOWN
1. Dither - it's hard to say definitely (5)
2. Not having been given good hiding? (7)
3. Result of much distortion, my friend! (4)
4. Prior reservations to show displeasure to royalty ? (7)
5. Lady's admitted on rising of Church council (7)
6. Instrument noted for precision (6,4)
7. One million poses the question he forces people to accept (7)
8. Feeling of anxiety in Germany's Mafia? (9)
14. Hide stones near people (10)
15. Drilling in the early stages or half done (4,5)
18. Cry in pain after setting crate back down (3,4)
19. One state's courts subsuming fifty others (7)
20. Got the message like a branch, perhaps (7)
22. Burglar's stride on a narrow footway ? (3,4)
25. Right code to break to discover the colour scheme (5)
26. Leader of Islam showing some grim amusement (4)

SOLUTIONS TO 2606 **QUICK CLUES ACROSS:** 1 Hurdle, 4 Abounded, 9 Resent, 10 Illinois, 11 Soothe, 12 Pavement, 13 Moo, 14 Inseam, 17 Discuss, 21 Ponder, 25 Def, 26 Made good, 27 Strode, 28 Talisman, 29 Lariat, 30 Rescinds, 31 Lethal **DOWN:** 1 Hardship, 2 Response, 3 Lunkhead, 5 Bilbao, 6 United, 7 Diodes, 8 Desoto, 12 Poached, 15 Mig, 16 Tsp, 18 Software, 19 Admonish, 20 Oriental, 22 Emoter, 23 Adults, 24 Agassi, 25 Donald **CRYPTIC CLUES ACROSS:** 1 Insect, 4 Stitch up, 9 Trolls, 10 Overflow, 11 Resume, 12 Fleabite, 13 OAU, 14 In situ, 17 End runs, 21 Thomas, 25 O'er, 26 Monsoons, 27 Armour, 28 Ulterior, 29 Menton, 30 Neophyte, 31 Adores **DOWN:** 1 Intermix, 2 Scorsese, 3 Cell-mate, 5 Tuvalu, 6 Tartar, 7 Hold it, 8 Powder, 12 Fairies, 15 Uno, 16 TNT, 18 Sharp end, 19 Importer, 20 Tsarinas, 22 Impugn, 23 Anatto, 24 Fourth, 25 On foot

IF IT'S YOUR BIRTHDAY

SUNDAY NOVEMBER 8: This is a slower paced year. It's okay to rest and rejuvenate your energy. Make a point of hanging out with people who are kind and helpful. Concentrate on your needs and what brings you happiness.

MONDAY NOVEMBER 9: Take time to socialise this year — your zest and creativity are at a pinnacle. Let your guard down and loosen up a bit. But don't lose sight of your goals. Old friends might rekindle relationships.

TUESDAY NOVEMBER 10: This year is about creating foundations, both external and internal. Take charge of your health. Stay grounded and levelheaded.

WEDNESDAY NOVEMBER 11: Exciting changes will bring you increased personal freedom this year. Let go of whatever holds you back. Trust your intuition.

THURSDAY NOVEMBER 12: This is a year of service, perhaps service to family. Take care of yourself so you can be a resource to those who turn to you for guidance, comfort and courage.

FRIDAY NOVEMBER 13: This is a year of teaching and learning. Explore philosophies that give you a better self-awareness and get you closer to the meaning of life.

SATURDAY NOVEMBER 14: This year you will reap the rewards of all your hard work. Expect leadership. It's the time for major decisions and accomplishments. Act on opportunities.

YOUR WEEK AHEAD

ARIES (MAR 21 - APR 20): This might be one of the best days of the year to tackle inheritances, taxes, debt and insurance matters. Brace yourself and dig in. This Week: Finances improve.

TAURUS (APR 21 - MAY 21): This New Moon is a wonderful opportunity to improve your closest relationships with more objectivity to evaluate your own style of relating. With a better understanding, you might take a better approach. This Week: Your health improves.

GEMINI (MAY 22 - JUNE 21): This is a fortuitous day, because this New Moon is an opportunity for you to come up with more efficient and effective ways to work. You also might see how to improve your health. This Week: Work becomes more efficient.

CANCER (JUNE 22 - JULY 23): Today's New Moon is your chance to focus on love, children, leisure activities and your creative talents. These are all areas where you might see how you can improve. This Week: Enjoy entertaining.

LEO (JULY 24 - AUG 23): Each New Moon is a chance for us to make improvements. This one is your best chance in the entire year to think about how you can improve a family relationship, as well as your home, so that you are happier about where you live. This Week: Home improvements.

VIRGO (AUG 24 - SEP 23): We are gregarious creatures. We need to be seen and we need to see others. Today's New Moon is the best day all year to observe your communication style. It's important that your needs are met. We all need to be heard. This Week: Life becomes easier.

LIBRA (SEP 24 - OCT 23): You have had a stronger than usual focus on money lately. Sure enough, this current New Moon is the best time all year to objectively view your situation. How are you handling your money? How can you improve things? This Week: Financial delays diminish.

SCORPIO (OCT 24 - NOV 23): This New Moon is in your sign, and that happens only once a year. And it is your best chance all year to take a realistic look in the mirror and ask yourself what you can do to improve yourself. This Week: Mercury retrograde in your sign is over.

SAGITTARIUS (NOV 24 - DEC 22): There's a lot going on behind the scenes. Meanwhile, this New Moon might make you ponder issues you've been avoiding or repressing. Do you undermine yourself about the very things you most want to accomplish? This Week: Friendships are rewarding.

CAPRICORN (DEC 23 - JAN 20): Once a year a New Moon occurs in your House of Friendships, which will prompt you to think about those in your life — the friends you have and ones who are no longer there. You might ask yourself what kind of friend you are. This Week: Authority is cooperative.

AQUARIUS (JAN 21 - FEB 19): This is the only time all year when the New Moon occurs at the top of your chart, giving you an opportunity to question your life direction in general. Are you headed where you want to go? This Week: Plans fall into place.

PISCES (FEB 20 - MAR 20): This current New Moon urges you to think of what further education or travel you want to do to enrich your world and better equip yourself. This Week: Your finances improve.

JUMBLED WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given quip.

Every ___ must have... its own __. - Louis Kahn (8,,4)

GMIOS

BKMNUU

FYILL

EIRBDG

SOLUTIONS: Gismo, Fiily, Bunkum, Bridge
ANSWER: Every **building** must have... its own **soul**. - Louis Kahn

SUDOKU 6496

DIFFICULTY LEVEL 5s INSTRUCTIONS
To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows and in each of the nine boxes.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL
1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy;
3s = Medium; 4s = Hard;
5s = Very Hard;
6s = Genius

	2				4		7	
9					1			8
		3				4		
8	3		4		5			
			7		6		2	9
		6				2		
1			2					7
	7		6				5	

SOLUTION SUDOKU 6495

9	8	2	1	5	3	6	7	4
1	6	4	8	7	2	5	9	3
7	5	3	6	4	9	1	2	8
8	2	7	5	1	4	9	3	6
3	1	5	9	8	6	2	4	7
4	9	6	2	3	7	8	5	1
5	3	1	7	9	8	4	6	2
6	4	9	3	2	1	7	8	5
2	7	8	4	6	5	3	1	9

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER
RURAL WORKS CIRCLE, ANGUL

25001/1479/2627

E-Mail sencrwangul@yahoo.co.in ☎ 06764 - 236404

NOTICE INVITING TENDER FOR BRIDGE WORKS IN ODISHA
Bid Identification No. Bridge Online AGL-27/2026-27

No. 3713 **Dt. 28.10.2026**

1. Name of the work : Bridge works.
2. Total No. of work : 7 Nos.
3. Estimated cost : Rs.266.72 Lakhs to Rs.479.19 Lakhs (Approx.)
4. Class of Contractor : As per annexure.
5. Period of completion : As per annexure.
6. Other details. :

Procurement Officer	Bid Identification No.	Availability of Tender on-line for bidding		Last Date & Time of seeking tender clarification	Date & Time of opening of tender	
		From	To		Technical Bid	Financial Bid
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Chief Construction Engineer, Rural Works Circle, Angul	Bridge Online-AGL-27/2026-27	11.11.26 at 10.00 A.M	30.11.26 up to 5.00 P.M	27.11.26 up to 1.00 P.M	01.12.26 at 10.00 AM	Will be intimated separately

(1) For detailed Notice inviting Tenders, Please visit to the website **www.tendersorissa.gov.in**

Sd/-
Chief Construction Engineer,
Rural Works Circle, Angul.

OIPR-25001/25180/1/26-27/0033

Office of the Superintending Engineer, Moradabad Circle, P.W.D. Moradabad
E-Procurement Inviting Tenders

No. 6710/E-Tender/MBD Circle/2026-27 **Dated:- 31.10.2026**

1. On behalf of the Governor of UP, tenders for following work are invited by the Superintending Engineer, Moradabad Circle, PWD Moradabad online on website **http://etender.up.nic.in** & Prahari website **http://wms.uppwd.gov.in/prahari** from registered contractors from **20-11-2026 at 10.00 am to 27-11-2026 at 12:00 Hrs.** Technical bid /Prequalification of tenders shall be opened on **27-11-2026 at 12:30 Hrs.** in office of undersigned by tender committee in presence of authorised representatives/bidders who wish to be present. Financial bid of the tenders' who qualify in technical bid shall be opened on date and time as specified by a notice in the office of undersigned. In case of Government holiday the required process shall be carried out on next working day. Amount mentioned in column 5 & 7 shall be mandatory deposited by net banking only on E-Tender Portal.

Sl. No	DISTRICT	Name of Work	Estimated cost (Rs.in Lac)	Bid Security (Rs.in Lacs)	Time of completion of the work (Including rainy season)	Cost of tender documents including GST	Category of road contractor eligible
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
1	Moradabad	Special repair work on the Thikri link road from Km 2 of the Got Saktungala road under the financial year 2026-27.	54.25	4.72	02 Month	2354.00	A , B , C (Road Category)
2		Kuri link road from the KDRP road.	115.10	7.76	05 Month	2354.00	A & B (Road Category)
3		Gurer link road from the Moradabad Sambhal road.	46.45	4.33	02 Month	2354.00	A , B , C (Road Category)
4		Special repair work on the Lakhanpur link road from Km 387 of the Tehri Moradabad road under the financial year 2026-27.	38.75	3.88	02 Month	2354.00	A , B , C (Road Category)
5		Special repair work on the Kankarkheda Guldia link road from the Moradabad Tanda road under the financial year 2026-27.	75.70	5.79	02 Month	2354.00	A , B , C (Road Category)
6		Special repair work on the Got Saktungala link road from the Moradabad Tanda road under the financial year 2026-27.	112.50	7.63	05 Month	2354.00	A & B (Road Category)
7		Milk Gangwari via Lalpur link road from the Dingarpur Sambhal road.	43.75	4.19	02 Month	2354.00	A , B , C (Road Category)
8		Nimay-24 to Niamatpur Ikrotia road.	52.85	4.65	02 Month	2354.00	A , B , C (Road Category)
9		NH-509 (Amarpur Kashi) to Ratanpur Road.	44.65	4.24	02 Month	2354.00	A , B , C (Road Category)
10		Naval Seondara link road from Turkheda via Ramnagar Gangpur	83.00	6.15	02 Month	2354.00	A , B , C (Road Category)

The terms and conditions and details of the tender are available on the website **http://etender-up-nic.** In accordance with Government Order No. 879(1)/23-7-2020 dated 25-08-2020 and Chief Engineer (Development) and Head of Department's letter No. 4650/4N-LC/2020 dated 27.08.2020, the bidder will have to upload the necessary documents by logging on to the Prahari URL **http://wms.uppwd.gov.in/prahari/**.

Executive Engineer,
Construction Divison-1 PWD
Moradabad

UPID-260711 Dt. 06.11.2026
www.upidadv.gov.in

(S.P. Singh)
Superintending Engineer
Moradabad Circle, P.W.D Moradabad.
For and on behalf of Governor of UP
Mail ID:- semoradabad14@gmail.com

कार्यालय अधिशासी अभियन्ता
विश्व बैंक खण्ड/निर्माण खण्ड, लो०नि०वि०, मुरादाबाद, उत्तर प्रदेश
(Email: eewbmbd@gmail.com)

पत्रांक-737/ई-निविदा/2026-27 दिनांकः- 30.10.2026

ई-निविदा सूचना

1. महामहिम, राज्यपाल उ०प्र० की ओर से अधिशासी अभियन्ता, विश्व बैंक खण्ड / निर्माण खण्ड, लो०नि०वि० मुरादाबाद द्वारा निम्नलिखित कार्यों हेतु ऑनलाइन निविदायें वेबसाइट **https:etender.up.nic.in** के माध्यम से सुसंगत श्रेणी (पान्टून हेतु कार्यों में अनुभवी) दिनांक 21.11.2026 प्रातः 10.00 बजे से 28.11.2026 अपरान्ह 12.00 बजे तक आमंत्रित की जाती है। कॉलम 5 व 6 में दर्शायी गयी धनराशि **E-Tender Portal** पर **Net Banking** के माध्यम से जमा करना अनिवार्य हेगा। निविदा की प्री-क्वालिफिकेशन/टैक्नीकल बिट दिनांक 28.11.2026 को अपरान्ह 12.30 बजे अधोहस्ताक्षरी के कार्यालय कक्ष में उपस्थित/अधिकृत रजिस्टर्ड फर्म के प्रतिनिधियों के समक्ष गठित समिति के सदस्यों द्वारा ऑनलाइन खोली जायेगी। टेक्निकल बिड में क्वालिफाई पाये गये ठेकेदारों की फाईनेंशियल बिड खोले जाने के दिनांक व समय हेतु पृथक से सूचना इस कार्यालय द्वारा जारी की जायेगी। कार्यालय बन्द होने अथवा छुट्टी होने की दशा में प्री-क्वालिफिकेशन / टैक्नीकल बिड उसी क्रम एवं समयानुसार अगले कार्य दिवस में खोली जायेगी। कार्यों का विवरण निम्नवत है-

क्र सं	जनपद	कार्य का नाम	कार्य की अनुमानित लागत (लाख में)	धरोहर धनराशि (लाख में)	निविदा पत्र का मूल्य (रू० में)	कार्य पूर्ण करने की अवधि (वर्षा ऋतु सहित)	ठेकेदार की पंजीकृत श्रेणी
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
1.	मुरादाबाद	जनपद मुरादाबाद में कांठ से नगर पंचायत अगवानपुर में रामगंगा नदी पर पान्टून पुल के निर्माण एवं अनुरक्षण का कार्य	30.90	3.09	854.00	03 माह	ए, बी, सी, डी सुसंगत श्रेणी

- कार्य पूर्णता के उपरान्त 02 वर्षीय अनुरक्षण अवधि सहित ।
- बिल ऑफ क्वान्टिटी में लगायी गयी दरें सभी करों को जोड़ते हुए तथा जी०एस०टी० को छोड़ते हुए लागयी गयी है।
- निविदा के साथ रजिस्टर्ड पावर वार्च का प्रमाण पत्र/अनुभव प्रमाण पत्र संलग्न करना अनिवार्य है।
- निविदादाता द्वारा निविदा शुल्क एवं धरोहर धनराशि इन्टरनेट बैंकिग के माध्यम से शासनादेश संख्या 1/2018/3070/78-2-2018/42 आई0टी0/2017 (22) दिनांक 03.01.2018 द्वारा जारी निदेशों के अनुसार जमा करना होगा।
- धरोहर धनराशि एवं निविदा शुल्क निविदा शुल्क कॉलम सं0 5 व 6 के अनुसार ऑन लाईन बैंकिंग द्वारा जमा करना होगा।
- अतिरिक्त धरोहर धनराशि शासनादेश सं0 86/2026/649/2026/2026/23-7099/106/2025 दिनॉक 23.05.2026 द्वारा दिये गये निदेशों के अनुसार (नियमानुसार अनुबन्ध गठन के समय) ही ली जायेगी। निविदा से सम्बन्धित अधिक जानकारी वेबसाईट **https:etender.up.nic.in** पर उपलब्ध हैं। निविदा से सम्बन्धित नियम / शर्तें तथा विवरण वेबसाइट **http://etender.up.nic.in** पर उपलब्ध है। शासनादेश संख्या 2020/879/तेईस-7-2020-176 (सा0)/06, लोक निर्माण अनुभाग-7, दिनांक 25.08.2020 एवं प्रमुख अभियन्ता (विकास) एवं विभागाध्यक्ष के पत्रांक 4650/4एन-एल0सी0/2020, दिनांक 27.08.2020 के अनुरूप निविदादाता को प्रहरी यू०आर०एल० **http://wms.uppwd.gov.in/prahari/** पर लॉग इन कर आवश्यक अभिलेख अपलोड करने होंगे।

सहायक अभियन्ता
विश्व बैंक खण्ड/निर्माण खण्ड,
लो०नि०वि०, मुरादाबाद

(मोहित कुमार)
अधिशासी अभियन्ता, विश्व बैंक
खण्ड/निर्माण खण्ड, लो०नि०वि०,
मुरादाबाद (महामहिम राज्यपाल की ओर से)
ई-मेल eewbmbd@gmail.com

UPID-260674 Dt. 06/11/2026
www.upidadv.gov.in

GOVERNMENT OF ASSAM
PUBLIC WORKS ROADS DEPARTMENT
O/O THE CHIEF ENGINEER (EAP)
ARR&TI CAMPUS, FATASIL AMBARI, GUWAHATI-25,
Email-id: as-ce.asbip@assam.gov.in

RFB No. CE/EAP/ARRBP/BR/Z4/T17

REQUEST FOR BIDS (REBID)
E-PROCUREMENT NOTICE - Open Competitive Bidding
(Two-Envelope Bidding Process with e-Procurement)

The Government of Assam through Government of India has received a loan from the World Bank towards the cost of the **Assam Resilient Rural Bridges Program (ARRBP)** and intends to apply part of the proceeds of the loan to the eligible payment under the contract. Bids are invited online from the eligible bidders from India for the **3 (Three) packages in the District of Cachar & Dima Hasao.** Details may be seen at website **http://www.assamtenders.gov.in** and also at the office of the undersigned during office hours.

The bidding documents are available online on **http://www.assamtenders.gov.in** from **10/11/2026 to 23/11/2026.** Bidders will be required to register on the website which is free of cost. For submission of the bids, the bidder is required to have Digital Signature Certificate (DSC). Bids must be submitted online on **http://www.assamtenders.gov.in** on or before 14:00 Hours on **23/11/2026.** Other details can be seen in the bidding document. The method of paying Bid Security, Tender Processing fees as indicated in the table of this e-procurement shall be required to be submitted online on **http://www.assamtenders.gov.in** by selecting "Pay Online" option.

Chief Engineer, (EAP) PWRD
Assam, Fatasil Ambari, Guwahati-25

DIPR/CF/IXP/2311/08-NOV-26

OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER
RURAL WORKS CIRCLE, BARIPADA
E_Mail ID : serwcbaripada@gmail.com |
25001/1485/2627 **Ph-No-06792-261343/261344, Gangraj, Baripada**

"e" Procurement Notice for Building Works
Identification No.- Online Tender- Building N.C.B. No. 438 for 2026-27
Letter No. 5738 Date. 5.11.26

1. **Name of the work** :- Construction of Building Works in the District of Mayurbhanj
2. **Total No. of work** :- 05 Nos (Five)
3. **Estimated Cost** :- Rs.111.65 Lakhs to Rs.151.60 Lakhs (approximately).
4. **Eligible Class of Contractor** :- As Per Annexure
5. **Period of Completion** :- As Per Annexure
6. **Other details** :-

Procurement Officer	Bid Identification No.	Availability of tender On-line for bidding		Last Date & Time of seeking Tender Clarification	Date & Time of Opening of Tender in O/O C.C.E.R.W. Circle, Baripada	
		From	To		Technical Bid	Financial Bid
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Chief Construction Engineer, Rural Works Circle, Baripada	Building On-line N.C.B. No. 438	Dt.10.11.2026 at 11.00 A.M.	Dt.25.11.2026 up to 5.00 P.M.	Dt.23.11.2026 up to 5.00 P.M.	Dt.26.11.2026 at 11.00 A.M.	Will be intimated later

- Further details can be seen from the website: **www.tendersodisha.gov.in**
- Any Corrigendum/ Addendum will be displayed in the above e-tender website only.

Sd/- **Er. A.K Naik**
Chief Construction Engineer,
R.W. Circle, Baripada

OIPR- 25001/25181/1/26-27/0023

कार्यालय निदेशक जे.के. कैंसर संस्थान, कानपुर
OFFICE OF THE DIRECTOR, J.K. CANCER INSTITUTE, KANPUR
(U.P. Govt. Institution)

Phone: +91 512 2970777

सं. 1220-22/जेके/2026 दिनांक 04-11-2026

-विज्ञप्ति-

राजकीय जे. के. कैंसर संस्थान, कानपुर उ०प्र०के विभिन्न विभागों में संविदा के आधार पर आचार्य, सह आचार्य एवं सहायक आचार्य के रिक्त पद पर साक्षात्कार (Walk In Interview) के माध्यम से सेवायोजन हेतु विज्ञप्ति -

उत्तर प्रदेश शासन चिकित्सा शिक्षा अनुभाग-1 के शासनादेश संख्या-148/71-1-24/71-1001/804/2020 दिनांक-14-06-2024 एवं महानिदेशालय के पत्रांक एम0ई0-2/2024/1627, दिनांक 01.07. 2024 के अनुपालन में राजकीय जे०के० कैंसर संस्थान, कानपुर में विभिन्न विभागों में रिक्त आचार्य, सह आचार्य एवं सहायक आचार्य के रिक्त पदों को संविदा के आधार पर भरे जाने हेतु साक्षात्कार (Walk In Interview), विज्ञापन प्रकाशित होने के पश्चात प्रत्येक गुरुवार को संस्थान स्तर से सम्पन्न किया जाना प्रस्तावित है। इच्छुक अभ्यर्थी साक्षात्कार के समय अपने समस्त मूल प्रमाण-पत्रों शैक्षिक/जाति/अनुभव प्रमाण पत्रों/शोध पत्रों आदि तथा उनकी स्वप्रमाणित छायाप्रतियों के 02 सेट के साथ संस्थान के निदेशक कक्ष में प्रातः 10:00 से 12:00 बजे मध्य अवश्य उपस्थित हों। निर्धारित समय के बाद उपस्थित होने वाले अभ्यर्थी का साक्षात्कार (Walk In Interview उस दिन नहीं लिया जायेगा। पदो की अर्हता के सम्बन्ध में शैक्षिक/अनुभव/शोध पत्र प्रकाशन में एन०एम०सी द्वारा निर्गत गाइड लाइन का पालन किया जायेगा। यदि अभ्यर्थी पूर्व में कहीं भी कार्यरत हो तो अनापत्ति प्रमाण-पत्र एवं अनुभव प्रमाण पत्र लाना अनिवार्य होगा। नियक्ति की शर्तों की विस्तृत जानकारी हेतु संस्थान की वेबसाइट www.jkci.org एवं महानिदेशालय, चिकित्सा शिक्षा एवं प्रशिक्षण, उ0प्र ० जवाहर भवन लखनऊ की वेबसाइट www.updgme.up.gov.in देखें ।

क्र०	विशिष्टता का नाम	संविदा चिकित्सा शिक्षकों की रिक्त पदो की संख्या एवं आरक्षण श्रेणी								
		आचार्य			सह आचार्य			सहायक आचार्य		
		पदों की संख्या	आरक्षित श्रेणी	रोस्टर क्रमांक	पदों की संख्या	आरक्षित श्रेणी	रोस्टर क्रमांक	पदों की संख्या	आरक्षित श्रेणी	रोस्टर क्रमांक
01	Pathology	-	-	-	-	-	-	01	अनुसूचित जाति	01
02	Radio diagnosis	-	-	-	01	अनुसूचित जाति	01	-	-	
03	Surgical oncology	-	-	-	01	अनारक्षित	02	01	अन्य पिछड़ा वर्ग	03

नोट - विज्ञापन प्रकाशित होने के पश्चात माह के प्रत्येक गुरुवार को आयोजित साक्षात्कार में यदि लगातार 03 गुरुवार तक उपरोक्त आरक्षित श्रेणी का कोई अभ्यर्थी उपस्थित नहीं होता है तथा पद रिक्त रहता है तो ऐसे पदो पर 04वें गुरुवार को अनारक्षित श्रेणी के अभ्यर्थी का साक्षात्कार लिया जायेगा।

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भवदीय
निदेशक

Hridoy cracks record double ton in 2nd Test against Windies



Towhid Hridoy helped Bangladesh take a 30-run lead in the first innings. X/BCBTIGERS

Associated Press
Sylhet, November 7

BANGLADESH BATTER Towhid Hridoy converted his maiden century into a double century to lift his team into a dominant position in the second and final Test against West Indies on Saturday.

His masterclass helped Bangladesh reach 386, taking a 30-run lead in the first innings from a near-hopeless situation. West Indies was 7 for no loss when bad light forced early stumps. Hridoy was unbeaten on 242 off 359, smashing 22 fours and 11 sixes.

He became the fourth Bangladeshi batter to hit a double century after Mushfiqur Rahim, Shakib Al Hasan and Tamim Iqbal and also passed Mushfiqur's 219 to become the highest individual scorer for the country.

The batter led the side astutely when Bangladesh appeared to concede a big first innings lead after West Indies was bowled out for 356.

"It's unbelievable how he was still able to find boundaries and hit sixes even when he started getting tired," Bangladesh coach Phil Simmons said of Hridoy. "He showed outstanding game awareness. Everything he did in this innings was exceptional."

Resuming at 88-3 on Day 3, Hridoy and Mushfiqur negotiated the West Indies bowlers well before Jomel Warrican dismissed Mushfiqur, ending their 73-run partnership. Warrican and skipper Roston Chase then sparked a collapse as Bangladesh lost three wickets in quick succession to be left at 184-7.

Hridoy then helped the side stage a comeback by adding 117 runs with Taijul Islam in the eighth wicket. He raised his maiden century off 171 balls, taking a single off Chase, which also took the side past 300.

After the century, Hridoy became more adventurous, unleashing a spectacular attack on West Indies bowlers. Ten of his 11 sixes, highest by any Bangladeshi batter and also second highest in cricket history, came in in this period, leaving visiting bowlers shocked.

Warrican, who took 4-104, finally broke through with the wicket of Taijul for 22. But Hridoy was unstoppable, as he shared an 85-run partnership with Taskin Ahmed in the ninth wicket to edge Bangladesh ahead. He raised his double century of 304 balls.

BRIEF SCORES: West Indies 356 & 7/0 trail by 23 runs against Bangladesh 386 (Towhid Hridoy 242 not out; Jomel Warrican 4/104)

CLOSE SHAVE

Rahul shepherds India to win in a low-scoring semi-thriller

Rain ensures the quicks have a say with just 247 runs scored in match

Shankar Narayan
Mumbai, November 7

KL RAHUL would have had his heart in his mouth for a moment off the fifth ball of the 23rd over. Until then, he had been in supreme control of the short ball during his stay in the middle. He had struck Nathan Smith for a boundary and a six off consecutive deliveries in the 16th over. But this time, a top edge off Jacob Duffy sailed over deep square leg for six.

With India precariously placed at 103/5 in their chase of 135, Rahul had to be there at the end. Had that delivery gone to hand instead of over the boundary, India may have fallen short. Eventually, they did not. Rahul, first with Shreyas Iyer and later with the lower order, helped India secure a four-run win by the DLS method and take a 2-0 lead in the series.

ODI cricket has increasingly become a batsman-dominated game over the last decade. Flat pitches, heavier bats and shorter boundaries have tilted the balance in their favour, making it harder for bowlers to contain the scoring and create chances. So, when bowlers get on top on a surface that offers assistance, it makes for compelling viewing.

Just over a month ago, India comfortably chased down 406 against the West Indies in Guwahati. On Saturday, they found themselves on the other side of the equation, chasing a modest target of 135 in the second ODI against New Zealand in Wellington.

The pitch offered considerable assistance to the seamers, with the ball holding its line, moving both ways and generating steep bounce, making batting a difficult proposition throughout the contest.

The New Zealand quicks made the most of the conditions to put India on the back foot early. Jacob Duffy set the tone with the new ball, dismissing Shubman Gill off the first delivery of his innings. The Indian captain edged a length ball outside off to second slip, where Henry Nicholls took a low catch. Duffy struck again in his second over, getting Virat Kohli to play early at a delivery that held up on the surface and sending him back for seven, caught at cover by Will Young.

Rohit Sharma briefly counter-attacked, pulling Kyle Jamieson for six and whipping him over square leg for another maximum. But the New Zealand pacer eventually got his reward. Rohit went hard at a pitched-up delivery outside off and edged it to Nicholls at second slip for 23. At 47/4, the middle order had not faced a test like this in a long time.

Cautious start

Rahul began cautiously, taking nine legal deliveries to get off the mark as New Zealand's seamers kept probing away. Nathan Smith and Matthew Fisher kept him quiet with disciplined lines and lengths, and he even survived a review for a possible edge off Smith. He finally broke free in the 16th over, pulling Smith for successive boundaries — a four rolled off the wrists and a six swatted over deep midwicket. He continued to pick off runs, including a pull for four off Fisher. By the time Shreyas Iyer fell in the 20th over, Rahul had found a measure of the pitch.

Iyer, who had only one fifty in his previous 10 innings, struggled for fluency early on, constantly beaten by the bounce and movement generated by New Zealand's quicks. He survived a close call while attempting a ramp against Duffy but gradually found his rhythm, using the width on offer to cut and drive. Iyer reached 30 off 46 balls and, alongside Rahul, looked set to take India home.

But Jamieson, who had found excellent rhythm through much of the evening, returned to dismiss him with a 136 kmph short ball that jagged back and caught Iyer in a tangle. The ball ballooned off the top edge to Tom Latham, ending the 39-run stand and putting the match in balance again.

His dismissal left Rahul with the task of taking India home alongside an inexperienced lower order. He took on Duffy with a top-edged six and kept the scoreboard moving. Naman Dhir and Anshul Kamboj also fell along the way to heighten the pressure on him.

At 113/7 in 26 overs, with Jamieson bowled out, the match could have gone either way. But with India 22 runs away from the target and New Zealand three wickets away from victory, the heavens opened. India were four runs ahead of the DLS par score of 109. The drizzle persisted, and the umpires eventually called off the match.

Earlier, Gurnoor Brar's career-best figures of 4/30 helped India skittle New Zealand for 134 in 41 overs. The pacer was supported by Anshul Kamboj, who took 2/25, and Auqib Nabi, who took 2/31. Axar Patel also took a couple of wickets in his nine overs.

• Scorecard

NEW ZEALAND vs INDIA
VENUE: HNRY STADIUM, WELLINGTON
TOSS: India, elected to field

NEW ZEALAND

W Young c †Rahul b Nabi	6 (17b, 1x4)
T Seifert c Kamboj b Nabi	0 (5b)
H Nicholls b Kamboj	11 (26b,1x4)
D Mitchell c Kamboj b Patel	55 (104b, 5x4, 2x6)
T Latham c Dhir b Brar	7 (22b)
G Phillips c Kamboj b Brar	0 (4b)
M Santner c †Rahul b Brar	31 (38, 1x4, 2x6b)
N Smith c Sharma b Brar	3 (9b)
K Jamieson b Patel	7 (14b, 1x4)
B Tickner b Kamboj	2 (5b)
J Duffy not out	1 (3b)
EXTRAS (b 2, lb 2, nb 1, w 6)	11
TOTAL (all out; 41 overs)	134

FoW: (Tim Seifert, 1.5 ov), 2-11 (Will Young, 5.4 ov), 3-23 (Henry Nicholls, 8.4 ov), 4-53 (Tom Latham, 19.2 ov), 5-53 (Glenn Phillips, 19.6 ov), 6-112 (Daryl Mitchell, 34.6 ov), 7-119 (Mitchell Santner, 35.5 ov), 8-127 (Kyle Jamieson, 38.2 ov), 9-132 (Nathan Smith, 39.5 ov), 10-134 (Blair Tickner, 40.6 ov)

BOWLING: Arshdeep Singh 7-1-16-0, Auqib Nabi 7-0-31-2,Anshul Kamboj 8-0-25-2, Gurnoor Brar 10-2-30-4, Axar Patel 9-1-28-2

INDIA (target: 135 runs/DLS)

R Sharma c Nicholls b Jamieson	23 (28b, 2x4, 2x6)
S Gill (c) c Nicholls b Duffy	0 (1b)
V Kohli c Young b Duffy	7 (7b, 1x4)
S Iyer c Latham b Jamieson	30 (46b, 4x4, 1x6)
A Patel c Duffy b Fisher	7 (17b, 1x4)
KL Rahul † not out	26 (38b, 2x4, 2x6)
N Dhir c Seifert b Duffy	12 (16b, 2x4)
A Kamboj c Duffy b Jamieson	1 (3b)
A Nabi not out	1 (1b)
EXTRAS (lb 1, nb 1, w 4)	6
TOTAL (113/7 wicket; 26 overs)	

FoW: 1-4 (S Gill, 1.1 ov), 2-17 (Virat Kohli, 3.4 ov), 3-39 (Rohit Sharma, 8.4 ov), 4-47 (Axar Patel, 12.5 ov), 5-86 (Shreyas Iyer, 19.6 ov), 6-108 (Naman Dhir, 24.4 ov), 7-111 (Anshul Kamboj, 25.3 ov)

BOWLING: K Jamieson 10-1-35-3, Jacob Duffy 7-1-35-3, Nathan Smith 5-1-19-0, Matthew Fisher 4-0-23-1.

21

Gurnoor Brar has taken 21 wickets since his ODI debut. In the same period, only one bowler (Rashid Khan) from a Test-playing nation has more wickets than Brar.



KL Rahul scored an unbeaten 26 off 38 balls to take India to safety after a wobbly start. CREIMAS

Nabi and Brar show two different ways to trouble New Zealand





Auqib Nabi (L) and Gurnoor Brar were on song in the 2nd ODI. CREIMAS

Shankar Narayan
Mumbai, November 7

Auqib Nabi showed what he could do when he got it right. He bowled fuller, drew the batsmen forward and made better use of the movement on offer at the Hnry Stadium.

AUQIB NABI had more than just a point to prove with the ball in Wellington on Saturday. Playing his third ODI, the Jammu and Kashmir pacer was still waiting for his first international wicket. He had conceded 84 runs on debut against the West Indies in Guwahati and had gone wicketless in Auckland, where he was the only Indian pacer not to take a wicket despite a helpful surface.

Nabi showed what he could do when he got it right. He bowled fuller, drew the batsmen forward and made better use of the movement on offer at the Hnry Stadium. The result was two wickets inside the first six overs of the rain-curtailed second ODI and the early upper hand India were looking for.

His first wicket came in the second over. Having kept Tim Seifert quiet for the first four balls, Nabi pitched one up on off stump. Seifert was slightly early into his drive and chipped the ball towards mid-on, where Anshul Kamboj dived forward to take the catch and give Nabi his maiden ODI scalp.

He struck again in his third over. Will Young, who had looked tentative in the middle, pushed at a delivery outside off and edged it behind, with KL Rahul diving to his right to take the catch.

The difference between Auckland and Wellington was not just the length Nabi bowled. He made the batsmen play at the ball a bit more and tested them with movement. He got one to nip back sharply at Seifert and another to move away. Against left-hander Henry Nicholls, he brought the ball in before getting another to shape away.

Nabi also made Daryl Mitchell work for his runs. He kept the New Zealand batsman quiet with deliveries on a good length outside off, forcing him to defend or play with soft hands into the off-side. Mitchell eventually looked to break free in the ninth over. He got to the pitch of a delivery and lofted it over mid-on for six. Two balls earlier, he had attempted a big slog but got a thick outside edge that flew over the slips for four.

Gurnoor Brar's success came from a different method. While Nabi relied on a fuller length with the new ball, Brar used pace and bounce to trouble the batsmen.

Mitchell found it difficult to get away. Brar mixed short-of-a-length deliveries with the occasional fuller ball, keeping the batsman on the back foot.

He had to defend several deliveries and struggled to find gaps. In the 17th over, one delivery nipped back and struck his boot as he tried to defend. Another climbed sharply and caught the splice of his bat.

Tom Latham was kept quiet too. Brar kept him tied down, making it difficult to find gaps or rotate the strike. The left-hander managed only a few singles, mostly by working the ball towards the leg-side or dropping it into the off-side. In the 20th over, Brar shortened his length again. Latham went for the pull but mistimed his shot towards deep square leg, where Naman Dhir took the catch.

Brar then dismissed Glenn Phillips off the final ball of the over. A short ball at 141 kmph climbed sharply as Phillips tried to pull. He got a top edge, and Kamboj judged the swirling ball well at fine leg to complete the catch. Brar had beaten Phillips with a 140 kmph delivery earlier in the over, while another had nipped back and passed close to the off stump.

After dismissing the spine of the batting order, Brar returned to send back Nathan Smith again with a short-of-a-length delivery that took the outside edge, and Rohit Sharma made no mistake at slip. He had claimed figures of 10-0-30-4, and New Zealand simply had no answers to what he had to offer.

The two bowlers had given India control in different ways. Nabi made better use of the new ball in Wellington than in Auckland, going fuller and picking up both openers. Brar used pace and bounce to keep the other batsmen in check and picked up two wickets for eight runs in six overs. Their methods were different, but both made it difficult for New Zealand to set a platform in their innings.

'All of us' involved in sandpaper scandal: Khawaja

Express News Service
New Delhi, November 7

FORMER AUSTRALIA batter Usman Khawaja made explosive revelations about the 'Sandpapergate' scandal during the 2018 South Africa tour in his new memoir, titled 'Sabr'.

In extracts of the book published in *The Sydney Morning Herald*, Khawaja claimed that the entire Australian contingent knew about the ball-tampering ploy employed by the team during the third Test against South Africa in Cape Town.

Although the eventual casualties were then captain Steve Smith, vice-captain David Warner and Cameron Bancroft, Khawaja revealed that discussions around the sandpaper tactic had begun during the previous Test in Port Elizabeth.

"It was all of us. Not the batters, not the bowlers, not the staff. All of us," Khawaja said.

Khawaja said that the second Test in Port Elizabeth led to Australia's "discovery of sandpaper as an effective agent" after "open" discussions were held in the dressing room at St George's Park.

"At this point Smith essentially threw his hands in the air and said he didn't want to know," Khawaja wrote.

The Australia team were caught in a massive controversy when television cameras zoomed in on Bancroft using sandpaper on the ball to generate reverse swing in Cape Town. "In an ideal world, I don't want to do this. I don't want to be the one who comes out and talks about the truth," he said. "The issue is that I genuinely thought after eight years the truth would have been out by now."

While the batting trio received a year-long ban from international cricket, Australia's bowling quartet of Pat Cummins, Mitchell Starc, Josh Hazlewood and Nathan Lyon maintained that they were unaware of the incident.



Usman Khawaja retired from international cricket after the Ashes series in January. REUTERS

> **"It was all of us. Not the batters, not the bowlers, not the staff. All of us... In an ideal world, I don't want to do this. The issue is that I genuinely thought after eight years the truth would have been out by now."**
>
> **USMAN KHAWAJA,** ON THE BALL-TAMPERING CONTROVERSY IN 2018.

In an interview with *The Guardian* in 2021, Bancroft said that it was "probably self-explanatory" in a response to a question on the bowlers.

Cummins, Starc, Hazlewood and Lyon released a joint-statement days after Bancroft's interview and stated: "We did not know a foreign substance was taken on to the field to alter the condition of the ball until we saw the images on the big screen at Newlands.

"And to those who, despite the absence of evidence, insist that 'we must have known' about the use of a foreign substance simply because we are bowlers, we say this: The umpires during that Test match, Nigel Llong and Richard Illingworth, both very respected and experienced umpires, inspected the ball after the images surfaced on the TV coverage and did not change it because there was no sign of damage. "We respectfully request an end to the rumour-mongering and innuendo. It has gone on too long and it is time to move on."

Khawaja claimed that he said that he wanted the entire team to accountability of the incident in the dressing room.

"I said: 'Take this as a team. We did this as a team. We knew what was going on, and we have to take it as a team'.

"Obviously, it didn't work that way, and those three guys got crucified," he wrote.

• SPRINTING TO SUCCESS

Harita, a girl who grew up in Ghatkopar's traffic snarls, learns to fly on the track

Shivani Naik
Mumbai, November 7

IN MUMBAI'S cheese-whiz county Ghatkopar, butter has run quicker through Achija pav bhaji, than water out of a tap. But how did Harita Bhadra, the suburb's running champion, realise she could sprint all the way to an Asian Games 200m bronze amid that concentrated urban bustle?

The story of Mumbai's unexpected sprinter medallist is even more circuitous. It started at Kanjur Marg, and in the traffic snarls on the way to Udayachal school at Vikhroli, where PT teacher Bala Sir noticed her prodigious speed and told her parents (father a businessman) that she needed to run track.

"Nobody had done sport in my home, but my father ran marathons, mom did yoga, and sister was a classical dancer," Harita recalls. She grew up waking up to strains of classical music, and the whole year was mapped out around the Tennis Grand Slams, with Rafael Nadal the family favourite. "We watched him a lot and I grew up admiring his strong approach to training hard," says the 22-year-old double medallist from Nagoya, who took 200m bronze in 23.20s and a mixed relay bronze.

The Mumbaikar became the first Indian after Dutee Chand to medal in sprints.

MSSA, that age-old Mumbai inter-school institution that dates back to 1893 and gave India Sachin Tendulkar and Vinod Kambli in Harris Shield, had given Harita her first athletics medal, in long jump. She remembers competing at University ground, Priyadarshini Park and Kandivali SAI tracks, after starting in the 100 and long jump. These are sub-optimal tracks in a city that is not athletics-friendly. "I mean," she laughs kindly, "they can definitely get better."

Harita comes from privilege, but no funding purse can gloss over a false start. "My biggest memory of Junior competitions was a false start. Now, we travel with teams," she explains. Back then, only her parents consoled her. "They were always there cheering for me." They even moved residence to Ghatkopar as she moved to Somaiya University, Vidyavihar, a facility where she is still welcome to train anytime.

She preferred the Nationals to state meets. "Because only two from Maharashtra would be there. Winning a state meet in sprints is tougher than Nationals. Competition is insane in Maharashtra, always neck to neck" she explains. In Class 10, she made up her mind to pursue sports, and at the first opportunity headed to Loughborough University in the UK. "I didn't win much in juniors and in my last year at 19, I was injured," she recalls.



Harita Bhadra (C) claimed a bronze medal at the Asian Games. PTI

Back in Mumbai, she reached out to Reliance's Jio HPC at Navi Mumbai, where she formed a partnership with coach Rohit Mane. "The facility had everything needed. I'm grateful because coach knows how my body reacts to every session. But it's not just him planning my schedule. It's decided mutually so even I feel equally accountable for my training," she says.

Prior to the Asian Games, her off-season preparation had been near-perfect. "Conditioning, increasing strength, explosivity in the building phase besides speed sessions," she says.

At Nagoya, they were comfortably housed in a hotel and coordinating bus schedules was the only thing not to mess up. Still, it was her first international event. "Nobody knew me before my Indoor wins. But more than others, I had more expectations from myself so I had to mentally prepare," she says.

She qualified in heats, leaving something to spare for finals. "It's not exactly a risk to hold back, though you decide during the race. But yes, never get overconfident," she stresses about taking a Q for granted.

Harita makes good time because her technique on the curve of the 200 is solid. "The curve is my favourite part. The last 100 you just go all out ensuring the form is maintained. Just keep going," she simplifies.

It had been a tight finish, and Harita had been staring at the wrong big screen awaiting the results. Her best buddy and close competitor, Unnati, yelled for her to turn around as her name was announced for bronze. "Felt unreal. It was the whole goal of the season. At the victory ceremony I was so emotional. Even if it was third place, to see the flag go up...."

Unnati Aiyappa, daughter of former heptathlete Pramila, trains at the same facility. "Even if we do same events, we are friends. Both of us are good on the track, so we push each other and are happy for the other's success," she says.

Besides creating jewellery that complements her sister's fashion-design business, Harita crochets and paints. On the track though, her choice of music is "upbeat," even as she trains to qualify for the 2027 World Championships.

What does a perfect sprint feel like? "When you make the right ground contact it's so smooth. I try remember that feeling always," she says.

So, how did a Ghatkopar, Mumbai girl surrounded by traffic snarls learn to fly on the track? "In Mumbai everybody is living their dream with that unknowing attitude of 'ho jaaega'," she says. Harita made it happen.

India look to settle scores with Pakistan in Under-19 clash



Aaryavir Sehwag scored 70* against Nepal U-19. X/ACCMEDIA1

Press Trust of India
Al-Amerat, November 7

INDIA AND Pakistan will renew their rivalry in a marquee Under-19 One-day Asia Cup Group A encounter on Sunday, with both sides coming into the contest on the back of convincing wins and looking to build momentum in the tournament.

India swept aside Nepal by 10 wickets on Friday, chasing down a modest target of 128 in just 19.1 overs.

Pakistan, meanwhile, made light work of hosts UAE, registering a nine-wicket win after overhauling a target of 225 in 37.3 overs.

As this is the penultimate round-robin league fixture for both sides, the stakes are high, with the result set to have a direct bearing on the Group A standings.

A victory will not only put the winning team in a strong position to finish as group toppers but also guarantee a place in the top two and a berth in the semi-finals.

With one league game still to follow, both sides will be keen to secure qualification while keeping the prospect of finishing at the top of the group alive.

With both teams having made winning starts, Sunday's contest promises to be a more demanding test, particularly for the bowlers, against batting line-ups that have already shown their ability to score freely.

For India, much of the batting interest will centre on Aaryavir Sehwag, son of former India star opener Virender Sehwag, who announced himself with an unbeaten 70 off just 52 balls against Nepal.

He struck seven fours and four sixes, showing an attacking approach that bore shades of his father's batting template.

Skipper Lakshya Raichandani was equally assured at the other end, making an unbeaten 53 off 63 balls as the pair completed the chase without being separated.

Their opening partnership gave India a comfortable finish, although Pakistan's bowling attack will present a considerably tougher examination.

The Indian squad also features Anvay Dravid, son of former India captain Rahul Dravid. He did not get an opportunity to bat against Nepal but was seen taking up wicket-keeping duties.

Pakistan, led by Farhan Yousaf, will be particularly confident after their emphatic victory over UAE.

Yousaf also captained the side in the previous edition, when Pakistan defeated India by 191 runs . That result gives the contest an added edge, with India keen to produce a different outcome this time.

INDIA U19 VS PAKISTAN U19: Live on Sony Sports Network from 10:30 AM.

LOVER WITH A FIGHTER'S HEART

Shami: The artist who made fast bowling look like a calling

Rolling in with a grin, a rubbery wrist and a seam held upright, he gave India a Test career that numbers cannot explain

Sandip G
New Delhi, November 7



Mohammed Shami took 229 wickets in his 64-match Test career. PTI

THE LINES are poetic, like a shayari that captures love and longing in equal measure. "*Safed jersey se vida le raha hoon, lekin usse judi yaadon se kabhi nahi.*" I am parting with the white jersey, but not with the memories attached to it, he said in an Instagram post on Friday, 13 years to the day since his Test debut. The words carried contentment, yet longing and regret filled the moment of parting.

He was a lover with a fighter's heart. He fought for the whites. He left his hometown Sahaspur in western Uttar Pradesh, ploughed on the sun-parched decks of Kolkata maidans, listened to his inner junoon, glazed his gifts to perfection, god-given he always emphasised, and fulfilled his dream of representing his country with his artful craft.

He fought again, against injuries and accusations, criticism of the vilest kind, defeated them, and fought again. He lost the last battle, the fight to wear the whites once more. He swallowed his ego, crisscrossed the dusty domestic fields, and reaped wickets like bundles of rice in harvest season. He finally gave up, not because his desire had wavered but because perhaps he knew it would remain unrequited. He couldn't suffer the pain of rejection any longer.

A warm memory

He might strive for the coloured clothes until the squad for next year's World Cup in South Africa is announced. But Test cricket will remain a warm, defining memory. He would dwell not so much on the numbers (229 wickets at 27.71 is an incredible body of work, if an understatement of his talents) as on the satisfaction it brought him, the moments he stirred, and the sheer kick he derived from bowling.

A sense that he underachieved persists, but he enthralled viewers like few others in Indian cricket. He is one of only six Indian seamers to cross 200 Test wickets, but was arguably the most artistic among them. There are spells that rush to the mind. The 5/28 in Johannesburg, the 5/44 in Centurion, the career-best 6/56 in Perth.

When the elements aligned in the right measures (the limbs, mood and rhythm), there were few more illuminating sights in Test cricket than Shami rolling into his run-up with a faint grin and a shine in his eyes, short strides working up a delectably furious tempo, every nerve in his body pointing straight ahead. He painted the ugly, painful business of fast bowling with a generous coating of artistry. For him, bowling was not a chore or an occupation but a divine calling. He once explained: "When you get deeply involved in something, a kind of junoon [obsession] sets in. Anything you want to achieve, you need to have that junoon." To him, bowling was junoon.

The eye could not dwell too long on the run-up, for it would miss the synchronisation of wrists and fingers at release, the soul of his bowling. The fingers are thick and not too long, but uncannily rubbery, presenting the seam as proudly upright to the batsman. "I always try to release the ball along the seam (even when I am just toying with it)," he once told this daily.

He seamed the ball, sometimes viciously, both ways. He made the ball bounce off the length as well as skid, a rare gift. He brought theatre with nip-backers that left stumps flipping back like a gymnast. He coaxed wilful obedience from the ball, new, old, or semi-old.

Deception began with love. "My love was always the ball. You have to care," he told this daily. He never threw any ball away but treasured it at home, because "each had a distinct trait. I knew how much harkat (movement) the ball does, how much it swings, how much it reverses. So I never felt like throwing any ball away," he said.

Dazzling duet

In between balls he talked to himself, felt the ball like a parent would, carved out imaginary angles with his hands, as if the game itself was being generated in his mind. He relished teasing batsmen cerebrally, more than beating them with pace and movement. With Bumrah, he formed one half of the most dazzling fast-bowling duet in Indian cricket. Together, they featured in 25 Tests and stacked 202 wickets. He was too simple a man to let ego tear him. At a dropped catch, he held his hands on his head with a wry smile.

> **"My love was always the ball. You have to care. Each had a distinct trait. I knew how much *harkat* (movement) the ball does, how much it swings, how much it reverses. So I never felt like throwing any ball away."**
>
> **MOHAMMED SHAMI,** ON HIS FASCINATION WITH CRICKET BALLS.

The outcomes did not weigh too heavily on him. Wickets were merely byproducts of the act he relished doing the most.

He was a bowler born for bowling's sake, his love unconditional. Only such a puresouled bowler could write such a shayari-like farewell note.

Indian cricket would miss his skills, maybe feel a pang of guilt in its inability to fully optimise his talents; but cricket itself would feel the void of a soul as pure as the whites he wore, now folded into memory. As the memories attached to the whites would live forever in Shami's heart, so would Shami in the audience's mind. He was a fighter with a lover's heart.

Serie A ceases to be boring, finds its fun via goals

Sandip G
New Delhi, November 7



Gennaro Gattuso's Lazio have scored 24 goals in 10 games. AP

WHEN THE final whistle blew at the Stadio Olimpico, Gennaro Gattuso slumped to the ground and kissed the turf of his once sworn enemies. His Lazio, a side he despised in his playing days as AC Milan's snarling enforcer, clung on to an 83rd-minute goal against a persevering Cagliari and continued their redemption song. After his doomed stint with the national side that bottled World Cup qualification for the third time, Gattuso says he sees every victory as a "salvation."

Lazio's renaissance came out of nowhere, but was in tune with the frenetic nature of the league, stuffed with drama, goals and free-flowing football, a label that is becoming anachronistic in a contemporary game strangled by structural fixations. Elsewhere in a blockbuster week, AC Milan stunned holders and derby rivals Inter and Juventus defeated Napoli. The title race is already heating up. Just five points separate the top four teams.

The glory days have long receded into a blur of forgetfulness, but Serie A has rediscovered its licence to thrill.

Ten rounds in, only two games have ended in goalless draws. It took 54 games for the first, the longest such streak in 80 years. Neither of those stalemates, Como against Roma and Parma against Udinese, was short on chances or drama. Stands have been packed and running wild, except at the Stadio Olimpico, where a feud between the club's owners and the ultra groups has intensified. Lazio's fans, though, stack the arenas for away games, no matter if they fall on weekdays or are far from Rome, to revel in the team's finest start in two decades. The show of defiance could be a lesson to fans elsewhere disgruntled at their owners' apathy.

Games between the traditional superpowers have been engrossing. Juventus and Milan played out a 1-1 draw; Lazio and Milan ended 2-2, as did Roma and Inter. Napoli and Roma blazed to a rope-a-dope 3-3 thriller. The average goals per game has been 3.02. The EPL's is 2.74, La Liga's 2.98.

A disclaimer: its watchability does not amount to a revival. The game is slower than in England and Spain, and the star quotient is non-existent. The most expensive player is Inter Milan's Lautaro Martinez at €80 million. The most expensively assembled squad in Serie A is champions Inter's, costing roughly €750 million. Manchester City's is almost twice as pricey (€1.361 billion). The last Italian side to feel the shower of confetti on the Champions League stage were Jose Mourinho's treble-winning Inter in 2010.

The players on average cover less ground than those in England and Spain. Hence Italian sides fail to match the intensity of even Bournemouth, in their first European season, who hammered ten-man AC Milan 3-0 in the Europa League last week. "I'm going to repeat myself, but I insist, in Serie A we play at too slow a pace," Fabio Capello said last season. The country is largely the refuge of rejects, discards and semi-retirees. No home-grown talent has yet taken wings into global consciousness. Martinez was the lone Serie A player on the Ballon d'Or shortlist.

It might take years, perhaps a decade, of sustained planning and progress for Serie A to recreate its halcyon days, the quality and star quotient that once shone. Until then, it will draw solace from entertaining the audience.

• BRIEFLY



Vaishnavi Adkar (R) and Rutuja Bhosale won 6-2, 2-6, 10-8. PTI

CHENNAI OPEN

Adkar-Bhosale become first Indian pair to reach WTA Tour doubles final

INDIA'S VAISHNAVI Adkar and Rutuja Bhosale created history by becoming the first all-Indian pair to reach a WTA Tour-level doubles final, beating second seeds Weronika Falkowska of Poland and Alana Smith of the USA in a thrilling semifinal at the Chennai Open on Saturday. The Indian duo recovered from a mid-match slump to prevail 6-2, 2-6, 10-8, keeping their composure in the deciding super tie-break after the Polish-American combination had threatened to snatch the contest away. The achievement is significant for Indian women's tennis, with no all-Indian combination having previously reached a final at the main WTA Tour level.

PTI

Gagan, Vijender among 4 elected unopposed

OLYMPIC MEDALLISTS Gagan Narang, Vijender Singh and Yogeshwar Dutt as well as former table tennis player Kamlesh Mehta were on Saturday elected unopposed as four male Sportspersons of Merit (SOMs) after eight former athletes withdrew their candidature, ahead of Indian Olympic Association's (IOA) December 5 polls. Electoral Officer Sanjay Kumar Srivastava said that there was no need for the election to be held on Monday for the four male SOMs as only four are left in the fray after the deadline of withdrawal of candidature which was set at 2pm Saturday. PTI

SC Delhi cruise to 3-0 win over Inter Kashi

SC DELHI registered a commanding 3-0 victory over Inter Kashi in the Indian Super League in Pune on Saturday. Carlos Fortes gave the visitors an early lead in the sixth minute before Juan Pena doubled their advantage in the 74th minute. Rodriguinho added a third in the latter stages of the game to cap an impressive performance, as the Phoenixes secured all three points. Inter Kashi created opportunities to get back into the contest, including a header from Pratik Chaudhari that struck the post just before half-time, but were unable to find a breakthrough. PTI

Pranavi tied 57th after third round in China

INDIAN GOLFER Pranavi Urs carded another even-par 73 to remain one-over after three rounds and lie tied 57th at the 2026 Aramco China Championship in Shenzhen. The Asian Games gold medallist has now returned cards of 73, 72 and 73. Pranavi's round featured two birdies and two bogeys. She picked up her first birdie on the fifth but dropped a shot on the ninth. Another bogey on the 16th was offset by a birdie on the 18th as she finished the day at even par on the par-73 course. PTI

Monfils named France's Davis Cup captain

GAEL MONFILS will stay in tennis as captain of France's Davis Cup team, the national federation said. The 40-year-old Monfils retired last month as one of the most popular personalities in the sport. He had been expected to finish his career at the Paris Masters this week until it was announced that his marriage to Ukrainian star Elina Svitolina was ending. He played in the 2014 Davis Cup final and beat Roger Federer to win France's only point in a 3-1 loss at home to Switzerland. AP

Gatha eases into Youth Olympics pre-quarters

INDIA'S LONE archer Gatha Khadake made a confident start to her campaign at the Youth Olympics, cruising into the pre-quarterfinals of the women's recurve under-18 event with a straight-set 6-0 win over Ivory Coast's Sita Sore, in Dakar on Saturday. The third-seeded Gatha was in complete control throughout the first round contest, winning 28-21, 28-24, 28-19 to wrap up the match without dropping a sweat. Gatha will next face Bulgaria's 14th seed Neda Kenderova in the round of 16 on Monday. PTI

World C'ships: Raiza-Mairaj finish fourth

INDIA'S DISAPPOINTING campaign at the ISSF World Championships continued as both its skeet mixed teams returned empty-handed, with Raiza Dhillon and seasoned campaigner Mairaj Ahmad Khan coming ending up fourth in the four-team final in Doha. The Indian pair had raised hopes of ending the country's barren run in skeet after qualifying for the medal round with an impressive performance. However, they failed to carry that momentum into the final. PTI

• ENGLISH PREMIER LEAGUE

Okafor's strike secures Leeds United's win over Spurs

Associated Press
Leeds, November 7



Noah Okafor (R) scored the winner in the 79th minute. AP

SUBSTITUTE NOAH Okafor had an immediate impact as he sent Leeds to a 1-0 win over Tottenham on Saturday in a Premier League match marked by controversy.

Okafor had been on the field for only 97 seconds when he gave Leeds the lead in the 79th minute. A throw-in was headed on by Dominic Calvert-Lewin and Harry Wilson pushed the ball into Okafor's path to drive home.

It was Leeds' first victory since a 4-1 rout of Newcastle almost two months ago and lifted the team into eighth, two points above Spurs — which had been looking for its fourth straight win after none from their first six matches.

Tottenham will feel Leeds should have played the second half with 10 men after a nasty challenge by Jayden Bogle on Mathys Tel in the 34th minute. It wasn't malicious but the late tackle saw Bogle's studs land on the trailing ankle of Tel, leaving the Tottenham forward writhing in agony.

A long VAR check for a possible red card for Bogle ended with no action deemed necessary. Tel tried to continue but had to come off a few minutes later.

Elsewhere, Arsenal defeated Hull City 1-0 to extend their lead at the top of the table. Skipper Martin Odegaard scored the winner in the 72nd minute.

Meanwhile, Second-place Manchester City was visiting relegation-threatened Nottingham Forest.



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THE SUNDAY EXPRESS MAGAZINE

EYE

NOVEMBER 8, 2026



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Lost in the Mountains

Vinod Kapri on putting a love story at the centre of his film *Pyre* and how the 'ghost villages' of Uttarakhand highlight issues of migration

BOOKS | PAGE 2

The Booker Prize 2026 Special



PHOTOS: GETTY IMAGES



ALL THAT GLITTERS
(Above) Honouring wealth during Diwali; a silver coin with Goddess Lakshmi and Lord Ganesha

Coins of Faith

A family's collection of old coins is more than an heirloom; it's an ode to the goddess of wealth

Anusree K C

LAKSHMI PUJA is at the heart of Diwali celebration. That evening, people welcome the goddess of wealth into their homes. Ganesha, too, is worshipped. But, 71-year-old Gopal Seth and his family in Delhi continue yet another tradition. They venerate *sakshat Lakshmi* (the living embodiment of Lakshmi) through silver coins that have passed down their family for generations.

Seth's great-grandfather, Lala Mahesh Das, was a wealthy merchant and part of the first general committee of the Delhi Municipal Corporation in the early 1860s. "Since the coins have been with us for nearly 100-150 years, there is a variety of them, including silver ones. There is a bare-headed bust of King Edward VII, minted in India between 1903 and 1910," says Seth. He talks about the oldest coin, which is embossed with the image of the Ram *darbar* (Lord Ram's court). Seth's family used to add a coin every year on Dhanteras. He adds, "I have coins that belong to the early 1940s."



Seth grew up in Delhi's Chandni Chowk and now lives on Hailey Road. Today, along with guarding the coins, he runs the family's charitable trusts and schools in Chandni Chowk.

The idea behind worshipping the coins is like that of worshipping the sun, says Seth. "People do *surya arghya*, a morning ritual that involves offering water to the rising sun (Lord Surya). The sun is in *sakshat* form, visible in its physical form," he says. Similarly, coins are the physical representation of wealth and prosperity, thus representing Goddess Lakshmi. "We bring the coins out on the day of chhoti Diwali, one day before Diwali. On Diwali, they are cleaned with water first then bathed in *panchamrit,* a mixture that includes milk, curd, honey, ghee and sugar." Then they are washed again and offered vermilion and a sacred thread. "Since the puja used to be done at the house of the eldest, it was given to them for safe keeping," he says, but now there is no hierarchy to it.

Seth recalls how celebrating Diwali itself has changed over the years. Earlier, relatives would gather in one house at the time of worship. "Now it is just immediate family. Back then, exchanging gifts was limited. It included some sweets and each of us received a gold coin or two," he says.

GETTY IMAGES



A Diwali of DIFFERENT LAMPS

Is it about Ram returning home to Ayodhya? Is it about Krishna killing Narakasura or raising Govardhana? Is it about Lakshmi being churned out of the ocean of milk? Diwali can be all of these, depending on which part of India you come from

Devdutt

THE LAMPS of Diwali are lit for the living and the dead at once. Is it about Ram returning home to Ayodhya? Is it about Krishna killing Narakasura or raising Govardhana? Is it about Lakshmi being churned out of the ocean of milk? Is it about ghosts and ancestors returning to the land of the dead? It can be all of these, depending on which part of India you come from. Contrary to popular understanding, there is no one reason for celebrating the festival of lights.

In Maharashtra and Goa, the day before Diwali belongs to Krishna and the death of Narakasura. Men are oiled and bathed before dawn, then they crush a small bitter fruit, the karit, under the heel, as if crushing the demon. Goa builds giant Narakasura effigies and burns them in the dark. In the Telugu country, it is Satyabhama who kills the demon while Krishna holds the reins. The day before, Diwali is about metal wealth (Dhan-teras). A day before that, on the twelfth day of the waning moon, it is about cattle wealth (Vasu-barsa).

In Bengal, Diwali night is Kali's night. No moon in the sky. The night before is Bhoot Chaturdashi, when fourteen lamps are lit, and the dead are close. In Odisha, families burn jute stalks and call out to the ancestors, lighting their road back. Black sesame, the food of the dead, turns up again and again in these rites. The lamps guide the ancestors out. The crackers drive away whatever ghosts linger near the house.

The crackers, though, are young. Gunpowder fireworks show up in Indian accounts only around the 15th and 16th centuries, in the Vijayanagara period. Before that, the noise came from the kitchen. Empty pots and winnowing fans were beaten to chase away Alakshmi, Lakshmi's sister.

That sister matters. The household makes two things: food and garbage. Lakshmi is the food, the grain, the wealth. Alakshmi is the waste, the peel, the ash, the rot. Both are daughters of the same house, both born of the same cooking fire. One is invited inside. The other is asked, loudly, to stay outside. And yet in many homes a lamp is placed near the rubbish heap too, because she is also of the house. Rejected, but not denied. Where there is food there will be refuse, and pretending otherwise is a lie.



ILLUSTRATION: DEVDUTT

In Gujarat, the trader sees Lakshmi rising from the ocean of milk and opens new account books. The day after, Bali, the generous *asura* king pushed into the netherworld by Vishnu's foot, returns for a day to see his people. The day after that, Yama comes to visit his sister and check all accounts. In Braj, mountains of food are heaped before Govardhan for Annakut. It indicates prosperity.

So the festival holds Ram and Krishna and Satyabhama, Lakshmi and her sister and Kali, a dying demon and a homecoming one, of ghosts and ancestors. For some it is a festival of 'pure' vegetarian sweets and savoury food. For others, it is a time to cook mutton and feast with Kali and the ghosts.

But all that is about space. Diwali also needs to be located in time.

Diwali sits near the end of Chaturmas, the four months when Vishnu sleeps, from Ashadhi Ekadashi to Prabodhini Ekadashi in Kartik. These were the rainy months when nobody travelled. Mud roads, flash floods, traders and monks staying put. People stayed home and at home, they made festivals.

THE FESTIVAL HOLDS RAM AND KRISHNA AND SATYABHAMA, LAKSHMI AND HER SISTER AND KALI, A DYING DEMON AND A HOMECOMING ONE, OF GHOSTS AND ANCESTORS. FOR SOME, IT IS A 'PURE' VEGETARIAN FESTIVAL, FOR OTHERS, ABOUT MUTTON AND FEAST WITH KALI

The rain floods the snake holes, so Nag Panchami. In Shravan, women keep the Varalakshmi *vrata* in the south, and Mangala Gauri in Maharashtra, the goddess is worshipped inside the house. Krishna is born in Bhadrapad. Northern women keep Teej across three fortnights. Ganesha comes for 10 days, clay and green leaves, a god of the field. He leaves, and the ancestors arrive: Pitru Paksha, 15 days of rice balls and sesame. Then Navaratri, the goddess fighting the buffalo demon, then Dussehra. Or, if you prefer, Ram fighting Ravana.

Watch the goddess. After battle comes Kojagiri Purnima, when the warrior cools and is worshipped as Lakshmi. Fifteen days later, on the new moon, she is Kali. Durga becomes Lakshmi, who then becomes Kali. One month, three faces. Karva Chauth, for husbands, slips in between. Chhath, for children, follows Diwali at the riverbank. These are household festivals — not about epic heroes. Then Vishnu wakes and marries Tulsi, and the wedding season opens. On Kartik Purnima, Dev Diwali, the gods light lamps on the ghats of Kashi because Shiva has burnt the three flying cities of the *asuras*. Life restarts.

Diwali is the hinge. Rains end, harvest comes in, the dead are sent home, the goddess turns from warrior to wealth to wild night, the sleeping god stirs.

And notice what is missing. No Vedic fire altar. No *soma*. No hymn from the Rig Veda holds any of this up. Diwali is built from courtyards, kitchens and threshing floors, from women's *vratas*, peasants' calendars and traders' ledgers. Perhaps, it was a pre-Vedic festival, once celebrated by the merchants of the Harappan cities. In its ruins, people have found clay lamps, cotton wicks and sesame oil. We can only speculate.

Devdutt is an author and mythologist

EXPRESS ARCHIVE



Why Sikhs light *diyas* on Diwali

It has to do with Guru Hargobind and 52 kings

Suanshu Khurana

DIWALI HAS different mythological narratives across India. In north and central India, it is associated with the return of Lord Ram to Ayodhya; in the east, with Kali Puja; and in the south, with the defeat of the demon king Narakasura by Krishna and Satyabhama. For Sikhs, however, Diwali carries the story of homecoming and liberation. It's about the story of Guru Hargobind, the sixth of the 10 Sikh Gurus, who walked from imprisonment to freedom.

Gurdwaras and Sikh homes across the country and in other parts of the world are illuminated with lights, earthen lamps and candles. This day that coincides with Diwali holds a distinct historical and religious significance as the community observes Bandi Chhor Divas (Day of Liberation).

It commemorates the release of the Guru from Gwalior Fort in 17th century. He was imprisoned, along with 52 kings and princes, by Mughal emperor Jahangir .

When Jahangir agreed to release the Guru, he refused to leave without the others. This is when the emperor put a condition that only those kings who held on to the Guru's robe could leave with him. He then had a robe made with 52 tassels that each king could hold on to, allowing them to be free alongside him.

And Amritsar gave Guru Hargobind the warmest welcome, with the city lit with thousands of lamps, accompanied by *kirtans* and *ardaas* to celebrate his homecoming.

Today, at Gurdwara Data Bandi Chhor Sahib, located within the Gwalior fort complex, devotees gather for prayers and special celebrations, while the lit up Golden Temple in Amritsar has always been the defining image on the occasion.

Even though centuries apart, Diwali and Bandi Chhor Diwas honour the memory of a homecoming, but they celebrate very different histories.

The she-ghosts who steal fish on Kali Puja

Of petnis *who crave fish,* shakchunnis *who haunt kitchens and women whose appetites survived even after the world declared them dead*

Rinku Ghosh

THESE WOMEN have eternal cravings. One loves pabda curry, tender freshwater fish simmered in a light mustard paste gravy. The second loves fish too, but likes fluffy luchis and aloo posto, potato cubes delicately wrapped in poppy seed paste, even more. And the third loves mishti doi and nolen gurer paayesh, the soft rice pudding made with date palm jaggery. Except they are all women from the spirit world, reclaiming their agency after death and stealing what they loved from the earthly world that had little place or value for them. Certainly, death could not take away their appetite for shorshe ilish.

And they return on Bhoot Choturdoshi, a day or two before the night of Kali Puja (equivalent to Dhanteras), to their former homes, families and unfinished desires. Folklore describes Bhoot Choturdoshi as a time of year when the boundary between the living and the dead become unusually thin, allowing spirits to cross over into human domain. Depending on the tradition, they may be welcomed, remembered, appeased or kept at a respectful distance. They wait beside a pond, lurk under a tamarind tree or appear near a kitchen, apparently attracted by the smell of freshly fried fish and spreads, something they do not mind using their fabled powers to steal. They are even believed to take human form but the smell of turmeric paste lining doorways repels them. So, they may sit on the tallest trees and prey on passersby carrying these goodies.

Metaphorically, female ghosts carry stories of interrupted lives. The fish-loving *petni,* believed to be the soul of an unmarried woman who died with unfulfilled desires, and the luchi-loving *shakchunni*, the spirit of a married woman recognisable by her conch-shell bangles, are more than supernatural curiosities. They represent women whose lives were constrained by the expectations of marriage, domesticity and social respectability. In a society that had little patience for women who wanted too much, becoming a ghost was almost a form of liberation.

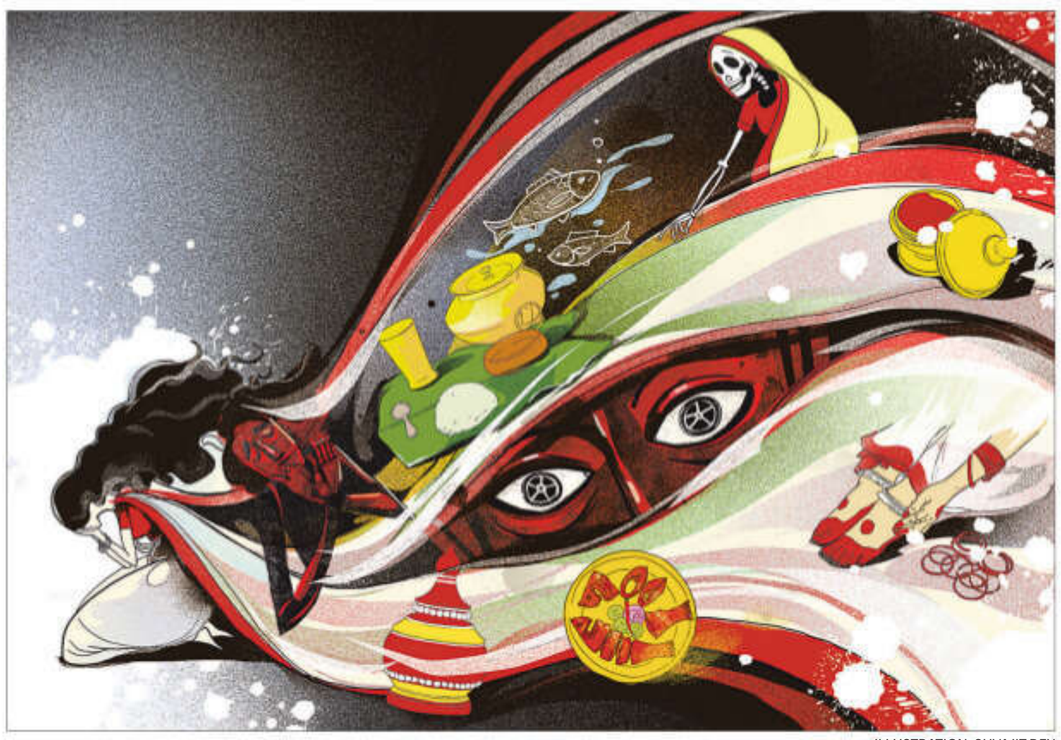


ILLUSTRATION: SUVAJIT DEY

Fish and rice are more than staples; they represent home, nourishment, belonging and cultural identity. Perhaps the *petni* craves them because she was denied the freedom to choose her own pleasures. The *shakchunni* is a more complicated figure. Traditionally imagined as the ghost of a married woman, she wears jewellery. Her love for luchi, aloo posto, khichuri or a bowl of payesh stems from the domestic intimacy she misses as the queen of her kitchen.

Their collective appetite is almost a rebellion against the expectation that women should be modest, self-sacrificing and endlessly accommodating. And it's because they are recognisably human that women ghosts feature in children's tales, most notably in *Thakurmar Jhuli* (Grandmother's Bag of Tales), written by Dakshinaranjan Mitra Majumdar, which was first published in 1907. Grandmothers would tame pesky kids, saying, "There is a *petni* there, she will eat your fish curry."

Poet laureate Rabindranath Tagore turned the supernatural into a way of exploring women's psychological and social imprisonment in his short stories. In *Jibito O Mrito* (The Living and the Dead), Kadambini discovers that the living cannot accommodate her existence. In *Monihara* (The Lost Jewels), Manimalika's attachment to her jewellery box isn't vanity. In a society where women had limited control over property, that wealth was her own.

These women are not frightening apparitions. They are women returning to narrate the lives that society refused to hear. And they refuse to stop wanting more.

A Trick Question

In Rebecca Perry's debut novel, May We Feed the King, *a puzzle that unsettles*

Pooja Pillai

THE PHYSICAL slightness of poet Rebecca Perry's debut novel betrays little of its ambition. It opens with an unnamed narrator of unspecified gender, a curator who dresses rooms in historic buildings with period-appropriate objects so that visitors may be immersed in another time. We meet them just as they're overcoming a personal tragedy and are taking on a new project in a medieval palace.

Here, the novel introduces the other central character, an unwilling king who ascends to the throne only because his two older brothers died. We are told he is oppressed by the feeling that the present is "a banshee wailing in his ear", and resents his transformation from private subject to royal object so much that sometimes, he "feels he must sleep just to be alone". We do not know his name or any other details that may help identify him.

Reading this clever, unsettling book is like encountering a stereogram for the first time: Any frustration over the lack of specificity is overcome by a sense of something larger, a picture that can only emerge when one cuts through the fuss of who, when and where to get to the what. Relax your gaze, as you would when viewing an optical illusion, and you begin to see why Perry, who started writing the two stories separately, merged them into a novel.



MAY WE FEED THE KING
REBECCA PERRY
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272 pages
₹599

The question animating the narrator's desire to recreate rooms in such a way that it appears as if "the person or people have just left the room" is similar to what drives readers to historical fiction: Is it possible, truly, to understand another life and see ourselves in them even though we can never truly experience their lives? If reading is an act of radical empathy, so is the narrator's work, which requires them to reach into another consciousness in order to set a scene — here, that scene gestures to the story of a reluctant monarch, the record of whose reign makes the narrator cry because it is such a "reduction of a life."

But don't relax your gaze so much that you overlook the ingenuity with which Perry has built her puzzle. Because a puzzle it is, posing the most vexing questions: why do we try so hard to recreate the past? What is this need we have to see the full picture? The king's story, which occupies the entire middle section of the novel, comes through everyone but the king himself: Courtiers' gossip, a young attendant's observations, the chief advisor's ire over a recalcitrant ruler. More than most books, this one rewards rereading. There are hints about what the king may do that you only catch later, as well as clues that point in a whole other direction, suggesting that the story might have nothing at all to do with real events. What are we to trust: An archivist's records, altered over centuries? The narrator's opaque motives and fabrications? Or Perry's spare, allusive prose, which is only one tool with which she beguiles the reader?

Between Us, a Gulf

A teacher's private despair becomes a luminous study of loneliness and compassion

Paromita Chakrabarti

WHY DON'T people ever say anything real?" Artie Dam asks his wife Evie after yet another insipid party. He would arrive at the answer almost at the end of his life, perchance, and yet, not quite, for hadn't he known it in a subliminal way all along? "Because to say anything real was to say things that nobody wanted to know... It was a private thing, to be alive."

To enter Pulitzer Prize-winning Elizabeth Strout's canon with *The Things We Never Say* feels at the outset to be a bit of an overreach. Her fiction is known for its expansive social worlds. Both her *Lucy Barton* and *Olive Kitteridge* series have interconnected lives and richly imagined communities. *The Things We Never Say* is an outlier with a whole new cast of characters, but none the worse for it. Strout brings to it the same acuity, the same compassion for the quiet revelations of everyday life.

Artie Dam is a 57-year-old high school History teacher in a coastal town in Massachusetts, cherished by his students, colleagues, wife and son. From the outside, he is a man to be envied — the quintessential American Dream, someone who has made a life for himself from a stuttering start. On the inside, however, Dam is coming undone, assailed by a profound sense of loneliness, of carrying around a secret that upends the most stable parts of his universe. Strout takes us into the liminal space between the two Arties — the one the world encounters and the one in his head — and what she finds is someone familiar. After all, who hasn't gone about their day as though nothing were amiss, even as a sense of void lurked beneath?



THE THINGS WE NEVER SAY
ELIZABETH STROUT
Viking
208 pages
₹1,099

That is, in fact, what forms the core of Strout's novel: the loneliness that lives alongside love. It sits in marriages and friendships, in staff rooms and kitchens, among people who care for one another, but cannot find the words for it. The novel builds a portrait of a community bonded and burdened by the heft of the quotidian. Strout never judges Dam, and never lets the reader do so either. She treats his foibles and his despair with the same gentleness that she reserves for his warmth and goodness. It is a generous way to write, this invitation to understand rather than to critique, and it brings to the act of reading a fellowship that is comfortable even in its silences.

The novel is also unmistakably of its moment. It unfolds against the turmoil of the 2024 US presidential election. Politics seeps into the book as it does in life: as dread at the dinner table, as an unspoken niggle between friends, in the classroom and at dinner parties. The aggressive turn demands confrontations that Dam is loath to offer. He is fuelled by the egalitarian ethics that is his inheritance as the son of an immigrant: "Do not ever feel that you are superior to someone else," he tells his students after an abrasive classroom encounter. Strout makes it apparent where Dam stands — he is a man who would have rejoiced at the recent US midterm results. Yet the novel's larger insight is not partisan. A divided country, Strout suggests, is eventually one whose people no longer know how to speak honestly and patiently to one other. That it is only empathy that may eventually and imperfectly forge a way back.

In any other writer this might have come across as glib, but in Strout, it is a largesse and a consolation. She knows that kindness is mostly a form of attention; that to be paid attention to is to be told that one matters. A smile, an open door, a stranger who holds out a hand when most would walk past — these are what hold a life together. Nothing extraordinary takes place in the novel. Yet by the end of it, one feels both the ache and the warmth of having lived an ordinary life as best as one can.

When the Abyss Stares Back

Set against the precarious realities of queer life in Jamaica, Marlon James's The Disappearers *is an unflinching examination of violence, memory and the limits of redemption*

Kaushik Das Gupta



GETTYIMAGES

MARLON JAMES'S *The Disappearers* is a no-holds-barred take on brutality and it is not an easy read. There is little room for respite as James moves between memory and the present to investigate the social conditions that produce violence and the histories that sustain it. The book is a *tour de force* nevertheless. Its intensity is not merely stylistic. James is intent on making the reader experience the exhaustion of dehumanisation.

From *The Book of Night Women* (2009), his searing account of slavery and rebellion in Jamaica, to *A Brief History of Seven Killings* (2014), the polyphonic work that revisited the attempted assassination of Bob Marley in the 1970s, James's fiction has explored power, oppression and the complicated ways in which the marginalised negotiate their histories. In *The Disappearers*, he turns his attention to queer life in Jamaica, beginning in the late 1980s when homosexuality is stigmatised, AIDS feared, and gay men are forced to negotiate a precarious existence.

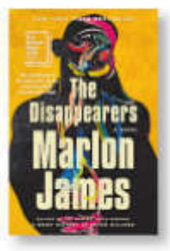


The book begins on a note of anticipation. In Kingston in 1988, eight amateur artists, strangers from different social backgrounds, have come together to rehearse John Herbert's *Fortune and Men's Eyes*, a play set in a men's prison that explores sexuality, power and exploitation. The production is directed by Havelock Titus, an Oxford-educated Jamaican who has returned home after years abroad. Among the cast are Edmond Porteous, or Eddy, an 18-year-old university student from a relatively privileged family; Jordan Brown, sharp-tongued and intelligent, struggling to survive after being rejected by his family; Matt Chin, a handsome and enigmatic advertising professional who attracts Eddy's attention; and Orrin Turner, whose flamboyance conceals considerable insecurity. The rehearsals offer the artists a temporary community in which they can be themselves. But the *joie de vivre* is shortlived.

The gathering is brutally attacked: One member is killed, another blinded. The survivors are left with serious injuries and scars; identities and sexual orientations change. The threat of more homophobia looms and the disappearance of several members of the theatrical circle becomes central to the plot.

Eddy survives, and with Jordan, becomes pivotal to the search for the missing men. The 18-year-old is haunted by survivor's guilt, while Jordan's flamboyance, sexual confidence and abrasive humour appear to be forms of resistance, but they also conceal wounds he cannot easily confront.

The novel also moves back into Havelock's past, including his years at Oxford, where his sexuality made him vulnerable to the condescension and exploitation of privileged men. His genteel behaviour owes as much to his passage through elite circles as to a carefully cultivated persona in which refinement is a response to humiliation. But Havelock is neither a conventional mentor nor a moral authority. An early AIDS patient, he is assailed by his memories of England and the regret of having fled the scene of the attack, leaving his cast to the mob's mercy.



THE DISAPPEARERS
MARLON JAMES
RIVERHEAD BOOKS
640 pages
₹999

Ahead of the winner announcement tomorrow, a review of the shortlisted titles

THE BOOKER 6

For the assault's perpetrators — among them, a reggae singer, a religious preacher, a police officer and even a gay man — homophobia is virtually a self-sustaining moral universe, in which cruelty is justified by the very prejudices that generate it.

Does the emotional force of *The Disappearers* then exemplify the Nietzschean aphorism about the abyss — "If you gaze long into the abyss, the abyss gazes back at you"? James's restless prose mirrors the unsettled consciousness of people struggling to make sense of their lives. As he moves between diaries, interviews, letters and shifting perspectives, the reader has to forsake the comfort of a conventional narrative. *The Disappearers* is not a neat story of victimhood and recovery. James doesn't descend into Nietzschean fatalism either. His characters are angry, vain, ambitious, contradictory, capable of tenderness and introspection. The novel's tragedy lies in the ways they struggle to earmark their own identities from the trauma that has overtaken their lives. James offers no redemption. Self-reflection, even compassion, does not erase suffering. The effort to feel the pain of colleagues, instead, becomes a means to reclaim humanity, a fragile one, albeit.

Bag and Baggage

In Black Bag, *Luke Kennard offers a hilarious take on capitalism, masculinity and identity*

Rohan Manoj

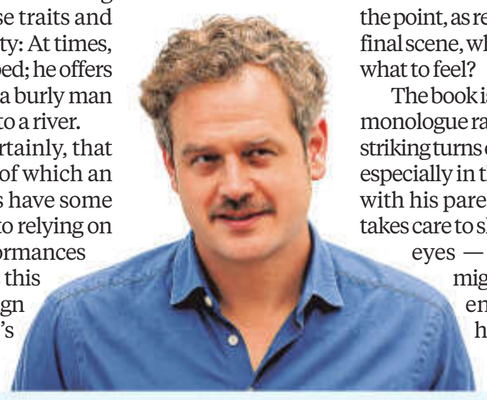
WHAT IS the collective noun for a congregation of bons mots? Hopefully not a murder, although an excess can be lethally sharp. In some cases, the right term might be *cri de coeur*. The French may be pardoned because Luke Kennard's *Black Bag* has a tasteful sprinkling of Gallicisms, Latinisms, literary references and other things of that nature to season the lols. It's all mordant wit, homing in on many of today's social pathologies, and with a little more pathos, on the allure of total self-effacement in the face of these assaults.



BLACK BAG
LUKE KENNARD
John Murray Press (Hachette)
388 pages
₹699

Whose cry is it? Ironically, black bag (appropriately, it's never capitalised in the text) has a social location in the Britain of the 2020s: the elder millennial; the downwardly mobile theatre student; White and without the good sense to have been born posh, though he affects it somewhat; hopes and the imagined stage of those hopes, erected with fatal complacency in the more certain world of the 1990s, now crumbling under attack from today's economy and its philistinism. It is also the cry, in a time of self-conscious hypermasculinity, of the male who doesn't conform — sexually submissive, even self-abnegating, financially unsuccessful, small and physically helpless. Becoming black bag only brings out these traits and gives them a certain inevitability: At times, he must be led around and helped; he offers precisely zero resistance when a burly man picks him up and tosses him into a river.

What's it crying about? Certainly, that same philistinism, as a result of which an actor in his late 30s, who does have some pride in his talents, is reduced to relying on parts in murder-mystery performances at corporate dinner parties. It's this desperation that leads him to sign up for a Psychology professor's experiment, in which he must wear a black bag that covers his face and body and remain silent while attending lectures in order to gauge students' reactions. But there have always been hungry actors eking out a living and praying for their big break; what's interesting is how this is situated in, and entangled with, the absurdities of late-stage capitalism. Nothing embodies this better than the protagonist's best friend, Claudio, a professional video-game streamer (of course, much better off than a struggling actor) and hallucinogen enthusiast who finds ways to monetise black bag: NFT art, Bag Coin, you name it.



If the novel pokes and prods at systemic crises through humour, it does not attempt to present any structural solutions — that would be too earnest for such a playful work, and perhaps even for the present moment in history. Rather, there's only the prospect of individual relief in the form of the aforementioned monetisation, grifting with the rest in the age of grift.

Is the answer that there is no answer? That would be in keeping with the negation that black bag is all about. It offers negation of fear and embarrassment — it's a way to retreat from the world, like hiding one's head in the sand. There's negation of desire — the protagonist, as black bag, becomes a plaything for a woman who wants to have sexual relations with nothing; he enjoys it and starts to fall in love with her. Ultimately, it's about negation of the self, of identity, and he accomplishes that thoroughly, or perhaps he doesn't — he grows attached, jealously so, to his new identity as black bag. Does it defeat the point, as reflected in the ambiguity of the final scene, where black bag is not quite sure what to feel?

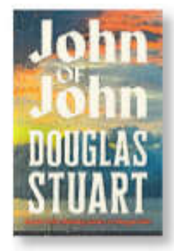
The book is consistently funny, the inner monologue rarely bores and there are many striking turns of phrase. There's warmth, too, especially in the protagonist's relationships with his parents — whose specificities he takes care to shield from the reader's prying eyes — and Claudio. And yet, one might be forgiven for getting to the end and feeling nothing. Perhaps that, too, is the point.

The Slow Ruin of Love

In Douglas Stuart's new novel, desire, shame and the tyranny of duty turn the intimacies of family into quiet devastation

Aakash Joshi

THERE IS a truth, often unsaid, about putrefied desire and how its smell of decay worms its way into every kind of love — between siblings and friends, children and parents, even the parts of yourself that would otherwise flourish. At the end of Douglas Stuart's *John of John*, it becomes clear that what we in the Subcontinent call "*majboori*" can become a habit of the soul, that the claustrophobia of helplessness is something we can all become comfortable with, till it erupts in destruction or withers away in an unremarkable death.



JOHN OF JOHN
DOUGLAS STUART
Picador
416 pages
₹999

John-Calum (Cal) Macleod, gay, unemployed and seemingly unemployable in '90s Scotland is called home John Senior. In the dying Islandtown, there is nothing but the stern, Presbyterian father, the sheep, weaving and a grandmother both tender and ailing. The relationship between father and son is mediated by religion, a sense of the family name, and Cal's duty to both. Take one of the first things John says when the prodigal son returns: "You look like a cross-dresser that's thrown on a coat because he's run out of milk."

Cal tries to rekindle a childhood friendship and adolescant sexual relationship with Doll. Like the returning NRI, he seems to believe that the outward immutability of the imposing cliffs in Scottish Hebrides, the unchanging cycle of the lambing and shearing seasons mean that the people, too, are still lifes. Doll rejects his advances.

John of John, though, is not really Cal's story. It is the father, and his long, furtive and even tender relationship with his neighbour Innis that is at the heartbreaking centre of the novel. The long years of lies, of stolen moments and that odd mix of violence and tenderness that defines sexual love are all amplified, often in their worst parts, when those at its centre believe the religious and social lies about what their desire signifies. Stuart gives us a sense of that guilt, as though desire is an addiction and self-hatred a moment of clarity.

Stuart was at the centre of the Anglophone literary conversation six years ago when *Shuggie Bain*, his debut novel, won the Booker Prize. To an Indian reader, there was something familiar —the difference in how Scottish characters spoke and thought notwithstanding — in the tale of the alcoholic, charming, abused Agnes Bain. Shuggie, in his devotion, is all but Shravan Kumar, his story at least as tragic from the parable from Ramayana. The intimacy of that first novel, and much of his work, including short stories, since, may be because they are seemingly autobiographical.

John of John takes place far from Galsgow, and there is a vast gap, on the face of it, between Shuggie and Cal, between Shravan Kumar and the Prodigal Son. But a line connects Glasgow in the '80s and the fictional Falabay in what seems like the '90s. The voice first discovered six years ago is becoming more masterful, more itself even as it expands in themes, relationships, style. Agnes was a mother who loved and could be loved, vulnerability and darkness all in one. John is the father and lover who, really, doesn't know how to be either. Between them, and whatever comes next, Stuart is a writer that must be read.

After the End, Who Tells the Story?

In The End of Everything, *M John Harrison searches for meaning in a world where the very nature of reality is shifting*

Shalini Langer

WILL WE know if the world is ending, what will we know, who will be left to tell the story of the end, and how will they tell it?

M John Harrison's T*he End of Everything*, shortlisted for Booker 2026, is a bleak account of such a post-apocalyptic England, which is now more than ever an isolated island. Here, death has seeped into everything, living and non-living, settled into bones, painted the world in a pallor whose grey is almost physical, even as a new life form is taking root.

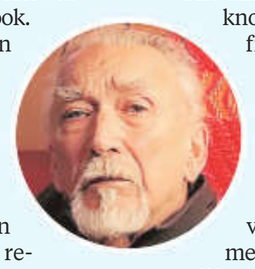
As the world constantly arranges and rearranges around its old and stubborn inhabitants and new and malleable occupants, you can't tell what is real and what is increasingly not.

To its own question of who are the iGhetti, the alien-like entities who arrived with the "Event", and where had they come from, the book says: "They had seemed at first like neither a thing, nor a picture of a thing: they seemed to be extruded from a space that wasn't quite in the world... More popularly, they were seen as having 'come out of the Internet'."

Which side lies humanity, however, is hard to tell, especially in the treatment of the biological "artefacts" iGhetti discarded after their arrival, which now keep washing ashore and are traded by beachcombers as throwaway objects, such as by one of the book's main protagonists, Phillip Tennant. Before he decides to adopt one of them — an artefact who would eventually become a version of him — he sees a mob tearing it apart and proceeding to eat it slice by slice. "The contemporary fear was that we might have brought all this – whatever it was – upon ourselves," says the book.



THE END OF EVERYTHING
M JOHN HARRISON
Hachette
208 pages
₹381



Harrison comments on how iGhetti arrive in a world "tainted by leisure chemicals, aspirations, the downwash of celebrity culture, the narcissistic sense of self which had trickled out from university postmodernism in the generation before", but remains vague about its timeline, except that Covid was a phenomenon of Tennant's childhood.

If the desire to understand persists, it is futile or beyond reach, Harrison suggests. In Tennant's case, recalls his aunt Marnie (the book's other protagonist): "What had begun as his desire to see and understand the end of the world had decayed first into a kind of adventure sport, then a profession, and at the last, a burden."

At the same time, the artefact has been growing, and growing, into "a mine of information", remarkable for an organism that emerged so recently from the sea, Marnie muses, not unlike the quantum learning of a large language model.

The answers the artefact does not know — like where he has come from — he searches in the same wastelands as Marnie and the others.

In the very name iGhetti, in fact, Harrison mirrors a world where its most valuable brand has a subservient 'I' as its signature statement. As we stand at the brink of a life to apparently be determined by Artificial Intelligence, which side really lies the artifice?

The End of Everything has no answers, leaving too much up to the readers' interpretation. That can be dissatisfying. But, honestly, does anyone have the answers, or more precisely, do we really want to hear them?



A still from *Pyre;* (below) Vinod Kapri

Two Lives, Lost in the Mountains

Vinod Kapri on putting a love story at the centre of his film Pyre, *choosing non-actors as his leads and how the 'ghost villages' of Uttarakhand highlight the issue of migration across India*

Devyani Onial

AT THE screening of the film *Pyre* at a mall in east Delhi, a crowd builds around its lead actors. The actors, Hira Devi and Padam Singh, pose for selfies and smile into the flashing light bulbs.

Neither of them has faced a camera before. His only role before this, says 80-year-old Singh, was of Sita's friend in a Ramlila decades ago. But with *Pyre*, the two are leading the life of actors — from travelling abroad for the first time to Estonia, where the film premiered in 2024, to attending screenings across India. The film released in theatres last week. "All OTT platforms rejected the film without even watching it, because it had no known faces headlining it," says writer-director Vinod Kapri.

Set in the Kumaon region of Uttarakhand, with the spectacular Himalayas as a background, the film is a poignant exploration of love and longing, companionship and isolation as an elderly couple, Padam Singh (who plays himself) and Tulsi (played by Hira Devi), struggle to fill their present with meaning and carve out hope for the future as their village slowly empties out. Their son left the village 28 years ago on a journey many made before him and many after him, never to return.

"It is essentially a love story," says Kapri, who left TV journalism around 2013 and turned to filmmaking. "I was already thinking of quitting TV when one morning I got a call from Rajkumar Hirani to congratulate me for a documentary I had made on Anna Hazare. He advised me to make films," he says. Kapri made his debut film, *Miss Tanakpur Haazir Ho* in 2015.

The idea for *Pyre* came to Kapri in 2018, when he met a couple while he was out trekking in Munsiyari. They lived alone in the hills and the way they were around each other stayed with him. "They had about 40-50 goats. When I asked the man why they kept so many, he said each time he needs help to take his wife to the hospital, he gives a goat to the villagers who help him," says Kapri. "I asked him what he will do when he runs out of goats and he said perhaps they both would be gone before that!"

But the old man's constant worry was that if he died before his wife, how would she build a pyre for him?

"When I met them, I thought hardships are part of everyone's lives but the way they were talking to each other, smoking beedis together, fascinated me. I felt one should age together like this. *Jiske saath aapne zindagi mein baal kaalein kiye hain, unhi ke saath aapke bal safed hon*," says Kapri.

This meeting was the seed of an idea that developed into *Pyre,* but to build the characters, Kapri needed inspiration. He found it in the relationship of his chachi Tulsi (after whom he named the character) and chacha Padam Singh, a retired Army man.

Initially, he had approached Naseeruddin Shah and Ratna Pathak Shah for the role but decided to look closer home on Shah's advice. And then, at his father's 80th birthday party, his uncle did an impromptu audition and he found his lead.

"Every time I would visit our village in Berinag (Pithoragarh) in the summers, I would see my uncle and aunt bickering endlessly. But beneath that, there was a real companionship and affection," says Kapri, who belongs to the region but grew up wherever his father's Army postings took him.

"My uncle would get a monthly quota of alcohol from the canteen. He and my aunt would wipe it off in a week. Every time they drank, they fought with each other and then with the others," laughs Kapri.

In the film, Padam Singh takes his daily swigs while Tulsi takes frequent puffs on her beedis as they argue vociferously and grumble softly, but loudly enough for the other to hear.

Kapri thought of casting his aunt too but when it didn't work out, he began looking elsewhere. Scouting in the mountains, he zeroed in on a woman carrying a bundle of wood on her head. As he approached her, she mistook him for a forest official and fearing a penalty, dropped the wood and broke into a run. As the village perched above watched the commotion below, a 60-something Hira Devi asked them what the fuss was about. "They are from *Bambai,* they are looking for a heroine," explained a girl. "I can be a heroine," laughed Hira Devi. Her spunk got her the role. "I am known in my village for cracking jokes but I didn't know that they would take my joke seriously. I felt very shy but my children persuaded me," says Hira Devi.

She made her living cooking in a nearby school after the death of her husband. Today, she lives alone in the village with her four children having migrated to the plains below.

Pyre may be a love story but migration runs like a leitmotif. As one after another, young men trickle down the mountains for jobs and better opportunities, a haunting silence descends and settles on the village they have left behind. A silence broken only by thunder and the relentless rain that hollows out already abandoned houses. There is fear and anxiety in Padam Singh's eyes as he pleads a young boy to stay on at least for another year. The solitude that envelops the village like a shroud, when everybody but the couple is gone, could well belong to a horror story.

"Migration was not actually my story, but of course, I wanted to highlight the issue," says Kapri. He had earlier spotlighted the issue in a book *1232 km* and documentary, in which he followed seven migrant labourers as they made their way home from Ghaziabad to Bihar during the lockdown in 2020.

"You know they say *ek baar pahad mein taala lag jaata hai toh woh dobara nahi khulta* (once a house is locked in the hills, it remains shut)," says Kapri. Over a thousand villages in Uttarakhand have been dubbed 'ghost villages' with their entire population emptied out, prompting the government to explore strategies to stem migration out of the hills. But *Pyre* could well be the story of any remote region. "Recently someone called me from Karnataka saying this is the story of our hills too," says Kapri.

From a girl who told him after a screening in Chicago how the film prompted her to video call her grandparents whom she hadn't spoken to in five months to emotional scenes in cinema halls, Kapri says *Pyre* seems to have struck a chord.

As for his actors, they are happy travelling to new places and meeting new people but look forward to returning to their home in the hills. "The only thing I feel sad about is that I had to sell my buffalo since I had to travel and there was no one to look after her. Earlier, when I went to Estonia, I worried about her the whole trip. I will really miss her now," says Hira Devi, before she turns to a group of people waiting impatiently to get a photograph with her.

> *Jiske saath aapne zindagi mein baal kaalein kiye hain, unhi ke saath aapke bal safed hon*
> (You want to grow old with those whom you spend your best days with)
> **VINOD KAPRI**
> *Writer-Director*



PHOTO: ABHINAV SAHA

Thunder and the Imagination

Kunal Kapoor on his role as Indra in Ramayana, *working with Nitesh Tiwari and Sai Pallavi and how power comes with vulnerability*



REIGNING IT IN
Kunal Kapoor as Indra in *Ramayana*

Devansh Sharma

WHEN THE initial trailer of Nitesh Tiwari's *Ramayana* showed a glimpse of Airavat, the divine flying elephant, the audience wondered who would play Indra. Who would be the rain god perched atop his mighty *vahana* in the battle against the chief antagonist Ravana, played by Yash. The international trailer revealed it would be Kunal Kapoor.

"We have all looked at movies in the West and said, 'Wow, that's incredible!' But secretly, we've hoped and said, 'Why can't we make a film like that?'," says Kunal. He discovered that was the exact film co-producer Namit Malhotra of Prime Focus and director Nitesh Tiwari are aiming for with *Ramayana*. "They have put so much passion, effort and resources into it for over six to seven years now. So, there was no question of not wanting to be a part of it," he says, "It was the first set I was on, in my 25 years, where everybody knew exactly what was going on." It was not only the director, actors and assistant directors, but also the spot boys and the lighting staff, who were in sync with every scene.

He attributed this to Tiwari. "Nitesh sir is a great guy to work with. Anybody else who is making a film of this magnitude would be stressed. But with him, he's absolutely relaxed and great fun to work with," says Kunal.

THE THING WITH THE GREEN SCREEN IS THERE'S NOTHING AVAILABLE TO YOU. THERE'S NO REAL PALACE OR SUNRISE. EVERYTHING IS OUT OF YOUR IMAGINATION

His conversations with Tiwari helped him shape the character of Indra. "The most interesting characters are those who are powerful on the outside, but have some kind of fragility inside. Indra is a personification of that. He commands rains, thunder and armies but there's some vulnerability within him. I find that fascinating — not just the power, but what that power is trying to protect inside. Even though he's a god, that makes him deeply human and accessible," says Kunal, who was last seen in *Udta Teer* (2026).

Since his role demanded many mounted action sequences, he shot extensively with the green screen. This was a first for Kunal in his career. "The thing with the green screen is there's nothing available to you. There's no real palace or sunrise. Everything is out of your imagination. But that can be a lot of fun as well because it takes you back to the most important thing as an actor — your imagination," he says.

He also hailed the technical insight provided by action director Terry Notary, best known for serving as a movement coach on Hollywood's blockbuster action epics like the *Planet of the Apes* franchise, *X2* (2003, from the *X-Men* franchise), *Superman Returns* (2006), *The Hobbit* franchise, and Russo Brothers' upcoming Marvel movie *Avengers: Doomsday*.

"We got lucky because we had somebody like Terry. He trained all the actors in the *Planet of the Apes* to imbibe that body language. He was not just an action director, but a body language expert directing action. That's very different from working with an action director," says Kunal.

Out of the lead actors of Ramayana, he had scenes with *KGF* star Yash, who plays the chief antagonist Ravana. "Yash is great, grounded and easy. He's obviously a huge star across the country but you don't get that feeling when you work with him," said Kunal. While he didn't have any scenes with Ranbir Kapoor or Sai Pallavi, Kunal recalls his recent pairing with her. It was earlier this year in Sunil Pandey's romantic comedy *Ek Din*, which was also Sai Pallavi's Bollywood debut. "She has the ability to take something very simple and elevate it. She's fantastic; she's such a good actor," says Kunal.

Making room for the imperfect

With Student of the Year: After Dark, *director Reema Maya looks beyond the glamour to explore the pressures of competition on young minds*

Alaka Sahani

FOR FILMMAKER Reema Maya, stepping into the world of *Student of the Year* (*SOTY*) was as much an exercise in challenging herself as it was an opportunity to reimagine a popular franchise. Until now, her creative journey had largely unfolded through independent short films, music videos and advertising projects. With the six-episode *Student of the Year: After Dark* — produced by Dharmatic Entertainment and releasing on JioHotstar on November 13 — Maya marks her foray into mainstream, long-form storytelling.

"It was scary, to be honest. The longest project I've worked on before this series was a 28-minute short film (*Nocturnal Burger*). So obviously, directing *Student of the Year: After Dark* was a little nerve-racking since I had to step out of my comfort zone," says Maya. Recalling the creative transition as the show's creator and director, she admits that working on the spin-off of *SOTY*, which has a darker theme and deals with the death of a student, was a conscious choice.

"I wanted to use this opportunity to understand and enjoy all the excitement that comes with longer screen time, more characters and a larger canvas to develop characters," says Maya. Coming from an independent filmmaking background, she was also curious about understanding the grammar of commercial cinema. What made her transition smooth is the creative freedom she received from producer Karan Johar and Somen Mishra, head of creative development and producer at Dharma Productions.

Recalling her first conversations with Johar, Maya says his brief was simple: "I want you to take it (*SOTY*) and make it your own." Johar produced and directed the first *Student of the Year* (2012). The second instalment though produced under his banner was directed by Punit Malhotra.

While conceptualising the series, the most visible departure is perhaps in its treatment of the world of St Teresa's. While the school and its setting remain familiar, Maya wanted to look beyond its glossy surface. For her, the starting point was the intense competition that defines the lives of young people today. "There is competition for attention, likes, clicks and shares. There's competition for marks. There's competition for jobs. We are constantly competing and made to feel that there isn't enough for all of us," she says.

Instead of reproducing the familiar archetypes of the franchise, she wanted to understand the emotional and psychological experiences that shape these characters. "I wanted to talk about good kids stuck in bad situations and what this competitive mindset does to young minds," she says. The darker undertones of the series, therefore, are not an attempt to create edginess. "It's not all glossy and perfect. We live in an imperfect world with imperfect people," she says.





(Left) Director Reema Maya; with the cast of *Student of the Year: After Dark*

Born and raised in Mumbai, Maya studied at Dhirubhai Ambani International School and graduated in Contemporary Media Practice from the University of Westminster. Her interest in experimenting with form and storytelling, however, can be traced to her early years. She knew she wanted to become a filmmaker when she was around 12. After graduation, when she returned to India in 2013, at the age of 23, she started CATNIP Culture, a company that initially focused on music-oriented video content. Among her projects were music videos for Ritviz and Divine's Baazigar. She also worked on advertising campaigns, including 'Propah Lady' for Puma.

While she enjoyed the work, Maya wanted to move towards storytelling that had deeper social resonance. She returned to an old script and made *Counterfeit Kunkoo* (2017). The short film premiered at the Sundance Film Festival and was screened at nearly 120 festivals. Her second short, *Nocturnal Burger* (2023), also, premiered at Sundance and later qualified for the Oscars.

Maya's transition to a mainstream franchise does not signify a departure from her independent sensibilities. "Just because you are an independent filmmaker doesn't mean you can't do commercial films," she says.

Speaking about Shanaya Kapoor, who plays two different roles in the series, Maya says, "I really enjoyed how Shanaya became the character she plays. She spoke like Aditi, and even when we were talking off-camera, she had that Aditi expression." In the coming years, Maya wants to be versatile as a filmmaker. "I don't want to be boxed into doing only one kind of work. I want to be prolific and never stop experimenting. I want to make more young adult content. I have a lot to say about a lot of subjects, and I want to say them all."

Living a full life

Chef Akash Deshpande of Mumbai's Luv brings curiosity, art , fashion and storytelling on a plate

CHEF AT HOME

Heena Khandelwal



ANURAG AHIRE

SHADES OF THE COAST
Chef Akash Deshpande at his residence in Bandra West



COCONUT WADI

INGREDIENTS

Freshly grated coconut - 700 g, sugar - 250 g, ghee - 25 g, cardamom powder - 2-3g, water - approx 100 ml

METHOD

- Grease a flat plate or shallow tray with ghee and keep aside
- Heat sugar and water in a heavy-bottomed pan, stirring until dissolved. Cook until the syrup reaches a one-string consistency
- Add the grated coconut and mix well. Cook on medium-low heat, stirring continuously
- Add cardamom powder and ghee. Continue stirring until the mixture thickens, comes together and starts leaving the sides of the pan
- Immediately transfer to the greased plate. Spread evenly and smooth the surface with a greased spatula. Allow to cool and cut into squares or diamonds

I T WAS a grudge that led Akash Deshpande to enter the world of culinary arts. He was all of 16 when he had his first heartbreak. "She wanted to become a chef. So, in anger, I was like, I am going to become an even bigger chef than you," he says, laughing now at the silliness of it. He even enrolled in the same college as her — Niagara College, Ontario, Canada, where he studied Culinary Management. But somewhere along the way, he started enjoying cooking.

"I was selected to work in the college restaurant, Benchmark. It was a fine-dining restaurant from which Canada's Culinary Olympic team was selected." His colleagues went on to become members of the team, and he found himself soaking up their rigorous training. He couldn't join the team because he wasn't Canadian but the experience left a lasting impression.

Today, Deshpande runs Luv, a restaurant he launched with his brother Luv in Lokhandwala, Andheri West, Mumbai, in 2024, serving European, Pan-Asian and coastal Indian food from an open kitchen.

Think kokum-infused coconut curry prawns, inspired by his mother's Konkani recipe, topped with her prawn pickle and delicate prawn crackers; a generously stuffed pork bun served with a broth, his take on bun maska or an eight-hour braised lamb shoulder tucked into soft tortillas with house-made chimichurri. His tiny kitchen offers diners a front-row seat to the action, from the cooking to the plating.

But for our readers, he is making a family favourite that finds its way to their table during every festival, including Diwali — coconut wadi. "We keep going back to it," says Deshpande, who has also prepared chapati, white vatanyachi usal and corn cutlets. Unlike the elaborate desserts at his restaurant — where Deshpande recreates Vincent van Gogh's *Starry Night* as an edible artwork to be scooped up from a canvas, or fashions a veiled woman out of chocolate — this family favourite is decidedly humble. It needs just four ingredients: freshly grated coconut, ghee, cardamom and sugar.

We are sitting in his drawing room in a cosy, rented one-bedroom apartment in Khar. The house is filled with artworks, all of them his own. A painting of his cat, Kenji, rests on an easel, while his first painting — of a sailing ship — is framed above a cupboard in his bedroom.

Painting has been a part of his life since childhood, thanks to his maternal aunt, Shaila Rane, a professional artist and JJ School alumna. "She used to teach me during the holidays. I must have been four or five. She would give us paper, sketch pens, crayons and, as we grew older, paints." He has never considered turning it into a profession. "It's a hobby, and let's keep it a hobby. My work is chaotic, but when I paint, I get a very calm feeling. I feel life is great. Plus, I get ideas about food."

After his stint in Canada, he returned to Mumbai and joined Khar Social, where he learnt what Indian diners enjoyed. He subsequently moved to Toast & Tonic under chef Manu Chandra. A stint in Doha followed, before he returned to India during the pandemic.

His biggest creative playground, however, was Nava, the Bandra restaurant he helmed for Anushka Pathak, which opened in 2021. It was his first opportunity to showcase his culinary style. The idea was to take local ingredients and familiar flavours and present them in newer ways. He developed the menu with his team, encouraging them to contribute ideas as well.

Nava shut after about a year, with the economics of sustaining an ambitious restaurant proving difficult. But its ideas found a more accessible expression at Luv, where he and some of his former team members retained the techniques and flavours while simplifying the presentation.

The menu is deliberately difficult to pin down. Deshpande knows French cooking, his sous-chef knows Japanese, and the team brings its individual influences to the table. A lamb taco, for instance, brings together French-style lamb, an Indian roti and Mexican chimichurri. "Three things look brilliant together," he says.

The Starry Night dessert, which originated at Nava, began as something he made for fun and posted on Instagram. Today, he has a chocolate version with five layers.

His creative pursuits extend beyond food, to painting and fashion

He hopes to explore more art-inspired desserts at his next restaurant and move Luv to Bandra by February next year.

His creative pursuits extend beyond food and painting. His fashion posts on Instagram show his experiments with layering and skirts.

Recently, he spent 15 days in Amsterdam learning the art of croissants and laminated dough from French pastry chef, Alexandre Scour, founder of Layers. "I was an intern. I was mopping the floor. I wanted to learn. I didn't have that knowledge; he did. After a really long time, I got to say, 'Yes, chef.' It felt good," says Deshpande.

Although people have appreciated his food, he hasn't been recognised by any award list. Does he crave it? "I do want more people to come and try my food because I know what I have is more than good. But I don't necessarily crave an award. I only knew Michelin when I was growing up. I also know that the awards will come. Right now, I get to do what I want. I go to work, I cook, I get to do my art. This is life."

Colour of Home

A bit of clay, a bit of gold and a celebration built on light and memory



TINTS AND TONES
Samant Chauhan's gharonda bag

Samant Chauhan

I HAVE a cross-cultural family. We have our origins in Rajasthan and migrated to Bihar, generations ago. I grew up in Bhagalpur, where my understanding of craft began with seeing the silk weavers there. My work with ahimsa silk has gone beyond just weaves to re-engineering processes for modern luxury. We now use this craft and transform it into highly sculpted forms, architectural tailoring and layered eveningwear.

Two memories from Bhagalpur's Diwali celebrations inform my work, especially the just-launched "Where is My Home?" collection. One of them is the simple clay *gharonda*, a miniature house, traditionally made by women during Diwali. It has stayed with me as an expression of how deeply the idea of home is woven into our celebrations and everyday lives. This memory inspired my first-ever attempt at accessorisation with what I call 'gharonda bags'. The gold accents in my jewellery are my tribute to the golden fort of Jaisalmer and my Rajasthani heritage.

The other Diwali memory is lighting the fire pit, again dug out in clay. The men would light jute stalks with the clay lamps that the women lit around the house and kindle the fire in the pit. The idea was to usher in Lakshmi or good fortune with the purifying agni. In fact, the clay imagery gets reflected in the earth tones and the licking fire in the tints and embellishments in my collection. Home is not always one place. Sometimes it is the coming together of everything we carry with us.

AS TOLD TO RINKU GHOSH

ADVERTORIAL



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Where Diwali Travels With You

Happy Diwali! Today is Sunday, 8th November, Diwali itself, and for most Indian families the question of where to spend it was settled long ago. At home. The cleaning, the rangoli, the lamps at the door, the boxes of sweets arriving from relatives, the first diya lit at dusk for this evening's Lakshmi Puja, all of it belongs to a particular house in a particular city, and nobody sensible wants to be anywhere else.

I understand that completely, and I am not arguing against it. But there is a quieter fact about this festival that does not get mentioned often enough. Diwali has been travelling for a very long time. Wherever Indians went, as traders, as indentured labourers, as families looking for work, the lamps went with them. Today, besides India, it is an official public holiday in Fiji, Guyana, Malaysia, Mauritius, Myanmar, Nepal, Singapore, Sri Lanka, Suriname, and Trinidad and Tobago, among others. That means there are countries where an entire population pauses for a festival most of us think of as our own.

This piece is about a few of those places, and about a simple argument. Celebrating Diwali abroad is not leaving the festival behind. It is seeing how far it has travelled.

Singapore: A Street That Becomes a Festival

Start with the easiest. Every year, Serangoon Road in Singapore's Little India is strung with lights for weeks before Deepavali, with illuminated arches overhead. This year, the street light-up was switched on in early October, and the Deepavali Festival Village on Campbell Lane, an evening bazaar of traditional clothing, festive snacks, handicrafts and decorations, has been running since 10th October. It closes tonight, on Deepavali itself. The lights come on at around seven every evening and stay lit until midnight, and the Sri Veeramakaliamman Temple sits on the same road, a few minutes' walk from the lights.

What makes Singapore a good first Diwali abroad is how gentle it is. It is well connected to Indian cities, the streets are walkable, English is widely spoken, and the festival is staged for everyone who turns up. You can arrive as a complete outsider and still feel that the evening was meant for you.

Nepal: Five Days, and the Dogs Get Garlands

Nepal calls its festival of lights Tihar, and it is quite unlike the one most of us grew up with. It runs for five days, beginning this year on 7th November, and each day honours a different part of life. Crows come first, treated as messengers. Then dogs, who are given garlands, a tika on the forehead, and a proper meal for the day. Unusually, this year Kukur Tihar, the day of the dogs, falls on the same day as Lakshmi Puja, which is today. Tonight, homes across the country will be lit with lamps and decorated with rangoli to welcome Lakshmi. Cows, symbols of prosperity, have their turn too. On 10th November come the oxen and, in the Newar community of the Kathmandu Valley, a ritual of self-worship called Mha Puja. The final day, Bhai Tika, on 11th November, belongs to brothers and sisters, when sisters place a multicoloured tika on their brothers' foreheads.

Tihar is Nepal's second-biggest festival after Dashain, and it fills Kathmandu with marigolds, lamps and music. Groups of singers go from house to house performing songs called Deusi and Bhailo, traditionally sung by boys and girls respectively. For an Indian traveller, it is a reminder that a festival you know well can still surprise you in the very next country.

Mauritius: The Island That Lights Every Doorstep

In Mauritius, the festival is called Divali, and it falls today, Sunday, 8th November. The government has also declared tomorrow, Monday, 9th November, a public holiday. Roughly two-thirds of the island's people are of Indian origin, descended largely from indentured labourers brought over in the nineteenth century, and Hindus make up nearly half the population. Just six days ago, on 2nd November, the country marked its annual public holiday commemorating the arrival of indentured labourers. Tonight, clay lamps will be placed in front of homes, and the island will take on a glow that visitors tend to remember long afterwards.

What stands out is who joins in. Neighbours of other faiths help with the decorations, many families who are not Hindu light a lamp or two of their own, and the holiday belongs to the whole country rather than to a single community. It is a good example of a festival that has outgrown the people who first carried it.



Further Afield

The same story repeats elsewhere. Fiji has a large Indo-Fijian community and marks Diwali with a public holiday, which this year falls on Monday, 9th November. Guyana, Suriname, and Trinidad and Tobago, where the descendants of indentured workers have kept the lamps burning for generations, observe it as a public holiday too. Malaysia observes Deepavali as a public holiday in every state except Sarawak, and Sri Lanka and Myanmar recognise it as well. Each tells the same story from a different shore. People carried something small, a lamp, a recipe, a prayer, and it took root.

The Case for Being a Guest

There is something else worth saying, and it is easy to miss. At home, Diwali is also work. Someone is cleaning, someone is cooking, someone is hosting, someone is keeping track of who has visited and who has not. Someone is up late frying chakli and karanjis. The festival is wonderful, and it is also a long list.

Abroad, the list disappears. You are a guest at a festival that is being kept by other people, and for once you can simply watch the lamps being lit, taste the sweets, and notice details you would normally be too busy to see. A street in Little India after dark, a doorway in Kathmandu with a lamp on every step, a doorstep in Mauritius lined with clay diyas. You see the festival the way a child sees it, as light and food and noise and people, with none of the logistics attached.

None of this replaces the Diwali at home. It simply gives you a second way of looking at it. I suspect that anyone who has watched the festival from the outside comes home with a slightly fuller picture of what it means.

How to Do It Well

If today's lamps have planted an idea, a few things are worth keeping in mind before you book for next year.

Book early: Diwali week is one of the busiest periods for Indian travel, and flights and rooms tighten as the date approaches. Next year, the festival falls in late October, so it pays to plan well ahead. Arriving a few days early is worth the effort, because the preparation is half the festival. Lights go up, markets fill, and the shopping begins long before the main night.

Confirm the local date: The festival spans several days, and countries and communities mark different ones. Diwali falls today in India, Singapore and Mauritius, but Nepal's Tihar runs from 7th to 11th November, Singapore and Mauritius add a holiday on Monday, and in Fiji the official holiday falls only on Monday. Check locally before you plan around a single evening.

Go as a guest, not as a spectator: Dress modestly and remove your footwear at temples, ask before photographing a family puja, and accept an invitation if one comes. The people celebrating are not putting on a show. They are keeping a festival alive far from where it began, and they will notice whether you came to watch or to join.

Carry something small: A box of sweets from home travels well and makes a good gift if you are invited into a house. It is a small gesture, but it goes a long way, and it often starts a conversation about how both families celebrate.

A Festival Is Not a Place

For most of us, Diwali will always be a house, a doorstep, a set of familiar faces. That is as it should be. But the festival has proved, over nearly two centuries of migration, that it does not need an address to survive. It needs a lamp and someone willing to light it.

Which is why celebrating Diwali abroad is less of a departure than it sounds. Tonight, as you light the diya at your own door, someone in Port Louis, Kathmandu, Singapore, Suva and Georgetown is lighting one too. The lamp is the same. Only the street is different.

Know the Unknown

Ever since we launched flight bookings on Veena World, I have been falling down rabbit holes about airports. And since this week's piece includes Mauritius, here is the story of the airport that greets everyone who arrives there for Divali.

The island's main international gateway is Sir Seewoosagur Ramgoolam International Airport, and until 1987 it was known simply as Plaisance Airport. Its story goes back to 1942, during the Second World War, when Mauritius was a British colony and work began on a military airfield at Plaisance, near Mahébourg. The first aircraft to land there, a Royal Air Force Dakota, touched down on 24th November 1943, and civilian operations began shortly after the war ended.

In 1987, the airport was renamed after the man regarded as the father of the nation. Seewoosagur Ramgoolam was the son of a migrant who had left Bihar for Mauritius as a teenager in 1896. He studied medicine in London and returned to the island as a doctor in 1935. He spent his career working for the island's labouring majority, largely the descendants of indentured Indian labourers, became Mauritius's first prime minister, and led the country to independence on 12th March 1968.

So the story of the festival in this piece and the story of the airport turn out to be the same one. The labourers who carried Divali across the ocean in the nineteenth century are the ancestors of a large part of the island's population today, and the gateway every visitor passes through carries the name of the man who led their descendants into nationhood. The new passenger terminal, inaugurated in 2013, was designed after the traveller's palm, a tropical plant that grows on the island, which feels like the right image for a country built by people who travelled.

Land there on a Divali evening, and the first thing you pass through is a monument to that journey.

Wherever you are celebrating, the festivities are only just beginning, with Padwa and Bhai Dooj still to come in the days ahead. May the lamps you light tonight bring warmth to your home, and may the week ahead be full of good food, laughter and happy reunions. Wishing you and your family a very happy Diwali.

See you next week…

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